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EXPRESS investigation

Police camera 'caught' murder, rape accused at Jantar Mantar protest — at least 25 of them were in jail, records show

Delhi Police assures SC no action without verification. Scrutiny of records of 205 accused of serious charges reveals why this verification is crucial



Facial Recognition System (FRS) in a Delhi Police van parked near the Jantar Mantar protest site in July-end. ABHINAV SAHA

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, September 3

ON TUESDAY, when the Supreme Court quashed all FIRs related to the exam leak protests by students, it let the Government proceed against the 2,873 people who the Delhi Police claimed had criminal records and were identified by its facial recognition software at the main protest site in Jantar Mantar between July 20 and 26. For their part, the police have made it clear that any action

will be taken only after "field verification", not merely on facial recognition.

Their task is cut out.

An investigation of those with serious charges, murder, attempted murder and rape, and child abuse, shows that at least 25 people on the list, identified by the Facial Recognition System (FRS) at Jantar Mantar, were in jail as per police, jail and court records.

Of the 2,873 people identified in the police affidavit (see chart), *The Indian Express* focused on

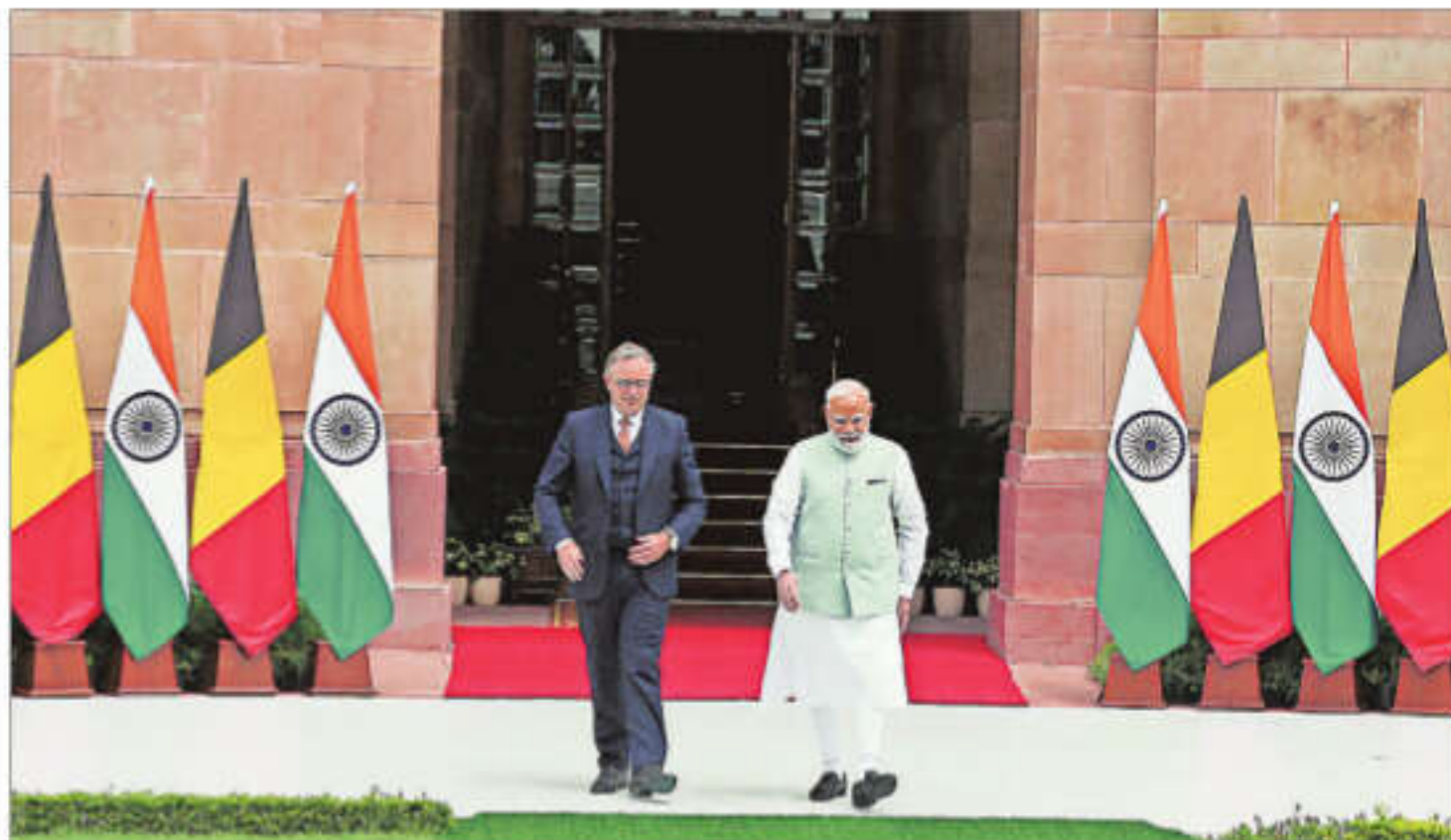
● 'Criminals' spotted: Delhi Police to SC

Offence	No. of accused
Murder	101
Attempt to murder	62
Dacoity/ robbery	284
Rape	61
POCSO Act	06
Molestation of women	25
Arms Act	229
Snatching	135
Kidnapping	19
NDPS (drugs cases)	67
Other IPC/BNS and special laws	1884
TOTAL	2873

those who were accused of murder, attempt to murder and rape. This accounted for 205: 101 (murder), 61 (rape), six (Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act) and 37 of the 62 listed in the affidavit under attempt to murder.

In this group of 205, 17 facing charges of murder; four of rape, including two in POCSO cases; and four more of attempt to murder were lodged in Delhi's three prison complexes at Tihar, Mandoli and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 10



Focus on trade, defence ties

Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Belgian counterpart Bart De Wever in New Delhi, Thursday. Both sides agreed to strengthen defence cooperation and double bilateral trade. ANIL SHARMA; REPORTS, PAGE 6

SEVEN FOREIGNERS WERE ARRESTED IN MARCH

NIA links Ukraine, US nationals to drone attack on plane in Myanmar

Credible information men were engaged in drone warfare training: Probe agency

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 3

THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency (NIA) has told a Delhi court that the seven foreign nationals who were arrested this March for allegedly conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India were involved in a drone attack on a civilian aircraft in neighbouring Myanmar.



US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke is lodged in Tihar jail. MATTHEW VANDYKE.COM

The foreigners — six Ukrainians and an American — are currently in Tihar Jail. On August 31, Special Judge Prashant Sharma allowed the NIA's application seeking permission to interrogate two of the men in prison.

"...The Central Government has received credible information indicating the involvement of certain Ukrainian and US Nationals in a drone attack on a civilian aircraft in Myanmar," the NIA said in the application to the court dated August 19.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BILATERAL VISIT TO UKRAINE

Not buying Russia oil will not stop war: Jaishankar

Underlines need for dialogue, diplomacy, says India ready to help in any manner

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, September 3

DAYS AFTER Prime Minister Narendra Modi called on Russian President Vladimir Putin to move from "endless war" to "end of war", External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said in Kyiv on Thursday that stopping purchase of Russian oil will not "dissolve" the conflict, and underlined the need for "dialogue and diplomacy". He said India was ready to "help in any manner" to end the Russia-Ukraine war.

Demonstrating a diplomatic balancing act, Jaishankar's bilateral visit to Ukraine comes at a time when Modi is meeting Putin twice within weeks — on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) leaders' summit in Bishkek on August 31, and at the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13.

Besides meeting his Ukrainian counterpart Andrii Sybiha, Jaishankar also called on Ukraine's President Volodymyr



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy in Kyiv, Thursday. ANI

Zelenskyy on Thursday. Sybiha welcomed Modi's call to move "towards an end to the war", and said Ukraine "stands ready for diplomacy". In a post on X, Zelenskyy thanked India for its "commitment to ending this unjust war".

Responding to a question at a media briefing after his meeting with Sybiha, Jaishankar

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Happening today

● VICE PRESIDENT C P Radhakrishnan will inaugurate various facilities at Panjab University in Chandigarh, including the Tech Innovation Forum.

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NATION **PAGE 10**
ABHISHEK BANERJEE'S OFFICE VANDALISED, 6 HELD; NO POLITICAL LINK, SAY POLICE

Exports push GDP growth, but low-margin shipments struggle

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 3

INDIA'S GOODS exports bucked expectations to record their best-ever June, with outbound shipments jumping to a record \$44.24 billion at the peak of the disruption caused by the crisis in West Asia. This performance helped drive GDP growth in April-June to an unexpectedly high 7.8%. But under the head-

line number, most labour-intensive and low-margin exports did not fare well.

Overall goods exports in April-June rose 15% year-on-year to \$129.32 billion while non-petroleum, non-gems and jewellery shipments were up 12% at \$99.04 billion — well above the 6.5% growth exhibited over the previous two financial years.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NALSAR ROW

Apex court: Bar Councils have no disciplinary power over law students

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 3

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday said the Bar Council of India (BCI) and State Bar Councils have no power to take disciplinary action against law students before they are enrolled as lawyers, holding that such matters fall exclusively within the domain of their educational institutions.

The bench was hearing a plea against BCI Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra's now-withdrawn directions on barring the 2026 graduating batch of NALSAR University of Law, Hyderabad, from enrolling with State Bar Councils and seeking an inquiry to identify students behind a campaign against inviting Chief Justice of India Surya Kant for the university's convocation. The directive, issued on August 13, was rolled back within hours.

"We are of the opinion that the Advocates Act, 1961, whereunder BCI has been statutorily created, does not confer any express or implied power upon

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

SEWAGE TREATMENT PLANT TENDER 'SCAM'

Bail for Satyendar Jain, court questions 27-month delay between FIR and his arrest

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 3

GRANTING BAIL to Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader and former Delhi minister Satyendar Jain in the alleged multi-crore sewage treatment plant (STP) tender scam, a Delhi court Thursday pointed to the "unexplained and extraordinary" delay of 27 months

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



AAP's Satyendar Jain at Rouse Avenue Court in New Delhi, Thursday. RELATED REPORT, P4

Business as Usual

By EP UNNAY



THE WORLD **PAGE 14**
AROUND 20,000 HOUSES HAVE TO BE REBUILT IN SAFER LOCATIONS IN NEPAL

● HARSIMRAT CLAIMS BAAZ 'PROTECTED' HUSBAND DURING ATTACK; MANN SAYS CAME TO 'BLESS' HIM AT RALLY

In Punjab, the baaz, a rare hawk and state bird, creates a flutter in poll ring

Divya Goyal Gopal
Ludhiana, September 3

AS PER official records, Punjab has mounted two separate efforts, seven years apart (2018 and 2025), to try and locate its State Bird — the 'Northern Goshawk' — within its boundaries, with no success.

Now, ahead of the hotly contested Punjab Assembly elections, the bird has been "spotted" — flying somewhere near both Shiromani Akali Dal leader Sukhbir Singh Badal and

Chief Minister and Aam Aadmi Party leader Bhagwant Mann.

The venerable status of Northern Goshawk in Punjab, and its designation as State Bird, flow from the belief that the majestic black and white hawk is the avian species that features in depictions of Guru Gobind Singh. Due to this, the Tenth Guru is often referred to as *Bajanyala*, or the Master of the Hawk, with the bird seen as a symbol of royal authority, sovereignty, and the fearless warrior spirit of the Khalsa, founded



The Northern Goshawk. VIKRAM JIT SINGH

by Gobind Singh.

The Akali Dal, which guards its Panthic vote eagle-like, was the first to claim a sighting. After Badal was attacked outside a gurdwara in Nanded on August 13, his wife and former Union minister Harsimrat Kaur Badal said the Guru had sent his "baaz" to protect him. At a series of rallies in Punjab, Harsimrat displayed photos of "150 stitches" that she said Badal had received following the deep cut on his right hand, and claimed their children had seen

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LICP-1/2025-26/34-E/9



Ladakh L-G Vinai Kumar Saxena and officials review ongoing tourism development initiatives at the heritage village of Hunderman near the Line of Control in Kargil on Thursday. ANI

All Ladakh districts to have autonomous hill development councils

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 3

MONTHS AFTER the Centre approved the creation of districts in the Union Territory of Ladakh, Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Thursday gave his nod to the notification for creation of Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs) for each of them, saying that the move will “empower the people.”

This comes two months after the decision was announced by the Ladakh administration.

In April, L-G VK Saxena notified the creation of new districts in Ladakh. This comes at a time when representative groups from Ladakh — the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) — are in talks with the Ministry of Home Affairs, seeking greater democratic representation, a legislature and protections for their land and environment under the sixth schedule of the Constitution.

The L-G said on Thursday that the establishment of the seven councils will decentralise and strengthen “participatory local governance, allowing local aspirations and priorities to be reflected more effectively and in district-level planning and development.”

With the notification, LAHDCs will be extended to all seven districts of Ladakh — Leh, Kargil, Sham, Nubra, Changthang, Zaskar and Drass.

The framework of elected local self-governance, which was earlier limited to Leh and Kargil, will now be extended to the five newly created districts in the UT.

The hill councils were created in 1995 under the LAHDC

Act, with powers pertaining to allotment, use and occupation of land vested in the Council by the government, formulation of development programmes for the district, special measures for employment generation, public health and sanitation, local road transport and its development, among other functions.

The Kargil Hill Council held elections in October 2023 while the term of the Leh council concluded in October 2025. Fresh elections to the Leh hill council have not been announced since, which is unprecedented.

Leh and Kargil remain the most densely populated areas by virtue of being district headquarters over a long period of time. The Act currently provides for 26 directly elected councillors in each council who will then elect a chief executive councillor from among them.

“The creation of Autonomous Hill Development Councils in all seven districts is a milestone in strengthening grassroots governance in Ladakh. This will empower the people and enable development to be more responsive to local needs and aspirations,” L-G Saxena said.

The notification issued by the Revenue Department, UT of Ladakh, says the elections to the newly constituted Councils will be held in due course after a formal notification is issued under Section 8 of the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils Act, 1997.

As part of the Centre’s ongoing engagement with Ladakh, the Ministry of Home Affairs has fixed an official meeting of the sub committee on September 9 in Delhi. The last meeting between MHA and Ladakh took place on May 22.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Jaishankar in Ukraine

defended India’s decision to buy Russian oil. “This conflict, which is today in its fifth year, will not dissolve because somebody is buying or not buying oil or alumina or minerals or metals... This conflict will be solved by dialogue, by diplomacy, by negotiations. And that is why it is something we would encourage,” he said.

He said ensuring fuel supplies for India’s 1.4 billion people is a challenge, adding that he respects Ukraine’s position on Russian oil purchases, but expects the same respect for India’s position.

“India has consistently maintained that this is not an era of war, and that solutions will not emerge from the battlefield. Just two days ago in Bishkek, Prime Minister Modi declared that endless war must now give way to the end of war. Every passing day of conflict only means more deaths and more destruction. Understandably, it is for the parties involved to find a way. But, if India can be of any help in any manner, we are ready, and this was the core of my discussion so far with Foreign Minister Sybiha,” he said.

While Jaishankar had accompanied Modi to Ukraine in August 2024, this was his first bilateral visit to the country.

Jaishankar said there were some specific aspects of the conflict that came up in the discussions on Thursday. “Prominent among them was attacks on commercial shipping. Indian seafarers man ships of many flags and have been among the unfortunate casualties. The impact on shipping is also significantly affecting many nations of the Global South in a variety of ways, leading to fuel, fertiliser and food shortages,” he said.

He was referring to the deaths of Indians, including five seafarers, since July this year due to the exchange of fire between Russia and Ukraine.

In a post on X, Jaishankar said he apprised Zelenskyy of his discussions with Sybiha on “deepening our bilateral cooperation”. “Our conversation centered on approaches to end the ongoing conflict,” he said.

Zelenskyy, in his post on X, said: “We are grateful to India for its commitment to ending this unjust war -- Russia’s war against Ukraine. This certainly must not be a time of war. Peace is needed. This is India’s clear position. Today, while the Minister was here with us in Kyiv, Russia once again launched jet-powered ‘shaheds’, which were developed not without Iran’s help. Thanks to our combat aviation, the delegation was safe, because it is Ukrainian fighter jets that shoot down most of these drones. We hope that other major world powers will also take a clear stance that this war must end and that a reliable peace must be achieved.”

“Of course, we discussed the situation in the Black Sea, including the existing threats to civilian shipping. We concur that it is absolutely unacceptable to block food supplies to regions where this is a highly sensitive issue and where people depend on these maritime routes. Russia’s actions aimed at blocking our ports, our food corridor, and our supplies are causing major disruption to global relations. We must all work together to guarantee security,” Zelenskyy said.

“Honored to welcome my Indian colleague @DrSJai-shankar to Kyiv for the first-ever dedicated bilateral visit of an Indian External Affairs Minister to Ukraine. This historic moment takes place amid escalating Russian attacks against our cities, port infra-

structure and civil shipping. Our capital is constantly under attack and I appreciate my colleague’s brave visit,” Sybiha said in a post on X.

“During our negotiations, we discussed the need to restore freedom of navigation in the Black Sea and global food security. India is a global power and we welcome Prime Minister Modi’s call to move from an endless war towards an end to the war. Ukraine stands ready for diplomacy,” he said.

“We also discussed our bilateral cooperation. From infrastructure and pharmaceutical sector to technological innovation and digitalisation, we are ready to realise our full potential. We agreed to work on convening our next Intergovernmental Commission meeting to turn great perspectives into great mutually beneficial projects,” Sybiha said.

Jaishankar invited Sybiha to India for the next meeting of the Intergovernmental Commission.

On bilateral cooperation, Jaishankar said: “This has a considerable history and it pre-dates Ukraine’s independence. Our trade spans a wide range of sectors — from pharmaceuticals, food and agriculture, and fertilisers to machinery, chemicals and consumer goods. Understandably, in the last four years, this trade has seen some disruption due to the war situation and logistical challenges. At the same time, there has been a visible resilience and, some new possibilities have emerged.”

“Where the future prospects of our bilateral cooperation are concerned, we are very much aware that Ukraine has deep strengths and capabilities. India too is developing at a rapid pace. And some of these notable areas of progress are in digital capabilities, innovation and startups. The world of AI offers new openings in health, education, agriculture, even in governance,” he said.

NIA

“In this regard”, the application said, “14 Ukrainians had entered India on tourist visa on different dates and flew to Guwahati and thereafter, they travelled to Mizoram without requisite documents Restricted Area Permit (RAP) / Protected Area Permit (PAP) and entered into Myanmar illegally to conduct a pre-scheduled training on the drone warfare, drone operations, assembly and jamming technology for Myanmar-based Ethnic Armed Groups (EAGs) targeting the Myanmar Military Junta.”

Several Ethnic Armed Organisations (EAOs) have been active in Myanmar for decades. Since the military, known as Tatmadaw, seized power in a coup on February 1, 2021, EAOs acting in a loose alliance with local militias and other resistance forces have been leading an armed struggle against the government of the junta.

Burma News International, a network of media organisations based in and around Myanmar that positions itself as the voice of the country’s ethnic minorities, reported on February 24 that a Myanmar National Airlines ATR 72-600 passenger aircraft preparing for take-off to Mandalay had been struck by an FPV suicide drone at Myitkyina

Bar Councils

the BCI or any State Bar Council to take any disciplinary action against the students of law; such a power is preceded by registration of a law graduate as an advocate under the said Act,” said the three-judge bench presided by the CJJ.

“So far as students are concerned, it is their parent institution or the authority prescribed under the regulations/bylaws of such institution who alone are competent to take disciplinary action,” said the bench which included Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The bench held that all communications issued by the BCI on August 13 were “without any authority of law”.

On August 14, too, when the matter was mentioned before the court, the CJJ had expressed his displeasure over the BCI’s actions. The court had passed an interim order protecting the NALSAR students and faculty from any punitive action at the instance of the BCI or State Bar Council. On Thursday, the court disposed of the petition, making the interim order absolute.

Appearing for the petitioners, Senior Advocate K Parameshwar said: “It is not about just one student. It is about banning freedom of speech and expression across an entire university... We want to know under what circumstances those orders were passed, whether meetings were held. After all, it’s a statutory authority responsible

airport in Kachin state four days earlier. It was not immediately clear if the NIA application referred to this particular attack.

The seven foreign nationals “had earlier travelled similarly through Mizoram and conducted training on two separate occasions in addition to illegally imported huge consignments of drones and its relevant parts from Europe to Myanmar via India for use of EAGs”, the application said. “...These EAGs are also known to support certain proscribed Indian insurgent groups by supplying weapons, terrorist hardware and training them thus affecting national security and interest of India.”

According to NIA, which is being represented by Special Public Prosecutor Rahul Tyagi, Public Prosecutor Ankit Gautam, and advocates Jatin Khatri and Amit Rohilla, “multiple digital devices” seized from the accused have been sent for forensic examination and data extraction. Some reports have been made available, but the “very huge and voluminous data... need time for thorough analysis for the purpose of investigation”, the NIA told the court.

“During scrutiny of the data extracted from seized devices, incriminating information and facts emerged in the form of images, videos, voice samples, etc., which are required to be confronted and corroborated with arrested accused persons to take the investigation to its logical conclusion,” the NIA said. In its application, the NIA said it

needed to interrogate Matthew Aaron Van Dyke, the American, and Viktor Kaminskyi, one of the six Ukrainians, to confront them with facts disclosed by certain witnesses to “unearth the larger conspiracy” in the case.

The interrogation was also “necessary to obtain more details about other suspects who are the masterminds sitting in Myanmar”, the application said.

Van Dyke was detained at Kolkata airport on March 13, and the Ukrainians — Kaminskyi, Petro Hurbia, Taras Sliyviak, Ivan Sukmanovskyi, Marian Stefanikiv, and Maksim Honcharuk — were detained at airports in Lucknow and Delhi. They were produced before the Special NIA Judge in Patiala House court on March 14, and they have been in Tihar since April 6. The NIA is expected to interrogate Van Dyke and Kaminskyi with the help of a Ukrainian translator.

Appearing for the accused, advocates Rohit Dandriyal, Rohit Gour, and Nitin Saluja argued that the NIA’s application does not mention any fresh or specific ground for interrogating the accused, and that the application was an “afterthought”.

The NIA’s probe has found that several consignments of drones from Europe were allegedly delivered by accused persons to individuals and groups in Mizoram. According to the NIA, the accused have told interrogators they were in “direct touch and abetted in their terrorist illegal activities by unknown terrorists carrying AK47 rifles”.

That’s a different thing,” he said. The bench then held that the BCI directives were “bad in law”.

In a related development, the SC asked a petitioner who sought a CBI probe into the alleged manhandling of some lawyers, who had protested outside the BCI office on August 21 seeking Mishra’s resignation, to approach the Delhi High Court.

Appearing for the petitioner, Advocate Prashant Bhushan told the CJJ-led bench that after the incident, Mishra “unnecessarily... issued a statement proudly saying that some legal coachroaches were protesting... and our lawyers came and beat them and sent them away.” He also sought directions to preserve the CCTV footage of the alleged incident.

The bench expressed its displeasure at the lawyers choosing to protest rather than approaching the court. “We never said they can’t protest. Nonetheless, this court has also laid down rules with regard to their response to maladministration in the judicial offices,” Justice Bagchi said, adding they could have raised their grievances before the appropriate forum.

“If some lawyers are protesting, they can’t be beaten up,” Bhushan said.

Justice Bagchi said that as citizens, they have every right to take to the streets. “But when it concerns the administration of justice, this court has laid down very clear, defined, graded response for the disciplined officers of the court. And that is what we expect the officers of the court to follow,” he said.

Bail for Satyendar Jain

between the FIR being registered and his arrest.

In the order, Special Judge Dig Vinay Singh of Rouse Avenue Court said this delay “indicates that the investigating agency did not consider his physical custody necessary for over two years”.

“...The prosecution has failed to identify any new or sudden intervening circumstance that warranted his arrest after such a prolonged gap. Not much seems to have been achieved in the investigation during this long period besides collecting replies/responses and documents,” said the judge.

The FIR was registered on May 11 in 2024 while Jain, former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai and four others, were arrested on August 18 this year. The case is being investigated by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB).

Special Judge Singh, in the order, also said the entire case rests on official documentary and electronic evidence. “...The notes, files, technical proposals, minutes of meetings, and bank transaction statements, etc., have already been seized by the ACB,” he added.

“Thirdly, the primary purpose of pre-trial detention is to secure the accused’s presence at trial and to prevent obstruction of justice. It cannot be permitted to degenerate into an advanced form of punitive punishment prior to conviction,” the Judge said, adding that the decision of the ACB not to seek police custody demonstrated that there was no active requirement for custodial interrogation.

“Continued detention in judicial custody cannot be justified on the generic plea that a conspiracy is yet to be unearthed,” the Judge said.

The order also noted that there are no WhatsApp chats or calls that might presently connect Jain to the kickbacks and hawala transactions with other co-accused persons in the conspiracy.

While Senior Advocate N Hariharan appeared for Jain, Public Prosecutor Manish Rawat appeared for the state.

The ACB’s probe focused on a specific contract to upgrade five Delhi’s STPs in 2022 when Jain was Water Minister.

The ACB claimed the tendering process was allegedly manipulated to restrict competition and favour Euroteck Environment (EEPL), which was eventually awarded the contract to upgrade and augment the five STPs in Nilothi, Najafgarh, Narela and Kondli between 2021 and 2022.

It also claimed money was routed through intermediaries allegedly linked to Jain and Rai — the latter has been accused of taking bribes worth Rs 1.5 crore.

The ACB probe also claimed that augmentation costs were included in the project that was meant to upgrade some STPs.

The ACB alleged that Jain altered the technical proposal for augmentation of the Rohini STP from 15 MGD to 25 MGD, and that he “approved the enhancement” without any “technical recommendation or feasibility study”. It claimed that the Rohini and Narela STPs were included in the project while the Okhla Phase V STP was excluded, which allegedly resulted in an estimated cost escalation of approximately Rs 123 crore.

Terming Jain’s decisions “arbitrary”, the ACB said they were “taken without adequate technical justification”.

Exports

On Monday, Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) V Anantha Nageswaran attributed the “brisk” growth in India’s core exports to the signing of free trade agreements (FTAs), export diversification efforts, and “possibly rising competitiveness”.

According to economists, net exports added 3 percentage points to GDP growth in April-June 2026 and this was driven by a decline in real imports as the conflict in West Asia weighed on import volumes.

“Export growth accelerated to 12% in Q1; combined with the decline in imports, this meant net exports contributed positively to GDP,” Barclays economists said Monday.

The headline numbers, however, mask an uneven sectoral picture.

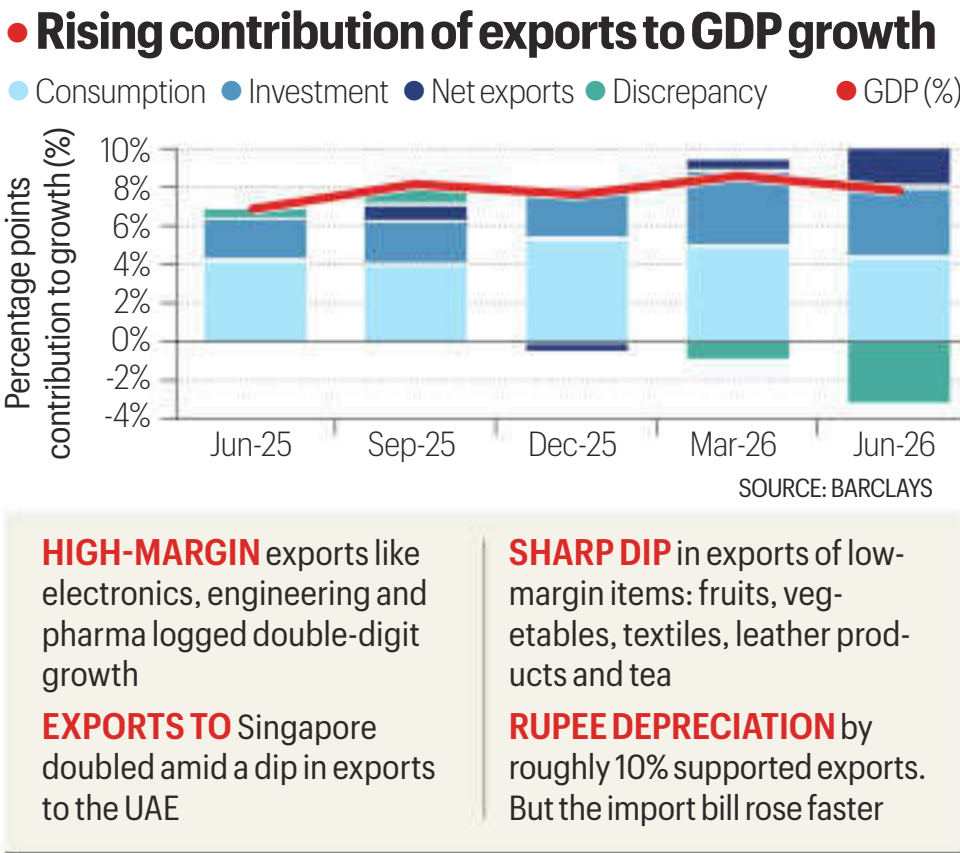
While high-end products such as engineering goods, electronics and pharmaceuticals grew 18.1%, 22.6% and 6.8%, respectively, during the April-June quarter, several labour-intensive sectors registered a sharp decline. Textile exports slipped 12.4% while leather products declined 4.7%. Exports of low-margin products such as fruits and vegetables, ceramics and glassware, and jute products fell 10.3%, 25%, and 13.4%, respectively. Tea exports were under particular pressure, falling 17.5%.

Of the 31 export sectors, 11 posted a year-on-year decline in April-June.

According to economists and industry executives, the West Asia crisis is disrupting trade at various levels, with steep logistics costs hurting exporters’ profit margins. While products which have a high margin, such as consumer electronics, allow their exporters to absorb the shock of more expensive logistics, exporters of low-margin products struggle and give up profits to protect market share.

According to Devendra Kumar Pant, Chief Economist at India Ratings, the problem for exporters would be the margins. “On higher margins, exporters would not be competitive, or the importers won’t give the price which will protect exporters’ margins. So, they will be forced to lower margins. Export figures will not show the dip in profitability,” Pant said.

Anshuman Kanoria, Chairman of the Indian Tea Exporters Association (ITEA), said the outlook for tea exports



E. EXPLAINED

Uneven basket
Net exports and a June export record of \$44.24 billion amid falling imports have fired the GDP growth. But it remains uneven. High-end electronics and engineering goods have thrived under new FTAs but soaring logistics costs have severely hit labour-intensive sectors like ceramics and textiles.

this year is very poor and the West Asia war could lead to a 25% fall in outbound shipment.

“There has been a 10-fold surge in freight rates in key markets including Iran, Iraq, the US and the EU. Payment has also become a major problem in trade with Iran, which is India’s largest export market for tea. Things have aggravated after the UAE cut trade ties with Iran,” Kanoria said.

Experts said a sharp depreciation in the rupee has aided competitiveness.

The Indian rupee ended June at 94.7-per-dollar, down around 10% compared to 12 months ago. While this helped export-oriented sectors such as IT and pharmaceuticals, import-dependent sectors such as oil and gas, and companies that depend heavily on imported raw materials have been hurt as the weaker rupee made these inputs costly.

“As of now, the rupee at 94 is providing good support to exports,” Ajay Sahai, Director General & CEO of the Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO), said. “Over a period of time, the rupee has depreciated by around 7% and the Chinese yuan has appreciated by 8%. This is giving Indian exporters a 15% advantage over China. Besides, in the

sunrise and knowledge- and technology-driven sectors, exports are doing well. But in labour-intensive sectors, it’s a mixed picture,” he said.

Swift diversification and higher export absorption by countries with which India has signed FTAs also helped cushion the impact of the West Asia crisis. When Indian exports came under pressure, particularly those going to UAE, exporters turned their attention to Singapore, another transhipment hub.

Data shows that Indian exports to Singapore nearly doubled during April-June from a year earlier. While exports to the UAE fell 11% year-on-year to \$7.9 billion from \$9 billion, exports to Singapore jumped 101% to \$6.5 billion from \$3.2 billion.

The UAE is India’s second-largest export market after the US.

India’s exports to FTA countries, particularly Australia and the UK, also showed significant growth. Exports to the UK rose 11% during the quarter, while shipments to Australia jumped 25%. Exports to China also increased, rising 25% to \$5.6 billion, although this was dominated by inputs rather than finished goods.

Addressing reporters after the release of April-June GDP data, CEA Nageswaran also said headwinds to export growth could come from volatile crude oil prices due to the “lurking risk” of supply disruption, which could prevent oil prices falling materially and sustainably below \$80 a barrel. In the US, diesel prices are heading towards \$6 per gallon — a level last seen in 2022 — while natural gas prices in Europe are significantly higher compared to last year, he said.

This, according to the government’s top economist, could impact the demand from abroad for India’s exports.

Punjab

the hawk flying outside the hospital where the former Deputy CM was admitted (he received treatment first in Maharashtra’s Nanded, and then Gurugram in Haryana).

“My children told me a baaz was constantly circling the sky outside the hospital. So when Bajajvala is here to protect us, why should we fear anyone? We won’t fear, we won’t bend, we will rest only after making them flee Punjab,” Harsimrat said, attacking the AAP.

Circling in, CM Mann started telling people in every speech that the bird outside the hospital wasn’t there to “protect” Badal, but to “protect its own eggs from him”, as the former Deputy CM might have “demanded a business share in the eggs too”. The AAP and Mann have repeatedly accused the Badals of building massive business empires at the cost of Punjab’s development, including in transport, sand, cable TV etc.

Why would the Guru send his baaz to protect the Badals, Mann added, given that they “disrespected Sir Guru Granth Sahib”, in a reference to the 2015 sacrilege incidents that happened during the SAD-BJP government, and continue to stir Punjab’s political pot.

During his recent ‘Lok Milnis (public interactions)’ in several districts, Mann made his point while mimicking with his hands a bird circling around a building: “She (Harsimrat) says Guru’s baaz was flying around to protect Badal. *Oye oye hoye hoye... Is*

baaz wella (idle) to guard such people who got *beadbiyaan* (sacrilege) done?”

He added: “Firstly, it is not even clear if it was actually a baaz. Some say it was a kaan (crow), others say it might be an ill (kite). But even if I believe it was a baaz, it wasn’t there to protect or guard this family. The bird’s wife must have laid eggs nearby. She must have sent him to check that Sukhbir Badal stays away from their nest.”

At his most recent Lok Milni gathering, at Teera village in Mohali district, the CM embellished this further and, pointing to a big bird flying overhead, said the baaz was actually flying over the sky during his speech, corroborating what he was saying. “See, he is here to thank me. He has got to know that whatever I said about him was true. In fact, he must have gone to the hospital totell Sukhbir that ‘*Ehna harkataanton baazaaja*’ (Beware such claims),” Mann said, leaving the audience in splits.

Paramvir Singh, Professor, Department of Encyclopedia of Sikhism, Punjabi University, Patiala, says the association of a hawk with Sikhism isn’t just limited to Guru Gobind Singh, but even older.

“The first major armed battle between Sikhs and the Mughal Empire in 1634 was due to a baaz. Sixth Sikh master Guru Hargobind Singh fought — and defeated — the Mughals over the possession of a rare, white hawk who had flown into the Guru’s sharan (protection) on his own. The battle had a deep symbolic meaning. For the Mughals, the majestic bird was a rigid symbol of imperial status and domi-

nance. By keeping the bird, Guru Hargobind Sahib sent a clear message: true sovereignty belongs to the people, not to a tyrannical empire,” Paramvir Singh said.

“Guru Gobind Singh kept the baaz as his companion as a symbol of absolute freedom, the fearless spirit of the Khalsa and battle against injustices,” he said.

If the Badals and Mann are both winging it, the baaz at least is used to it. In 1989, Punjab had named ‘Eastern Goshawk’ as its State Bird. The state changed it only in 2015, 26 years later, to ‘Northern Goshawk’, after realising there was no ‘Eastern Goshawk’ in modern terminology. The closest in name is the ‘Eastern Chanting Goshawk’, which is a bird native to Africa with zero connection to India or Sikh history.

Vikram Jit Singh, Member, Empowered Committee of the Punjab Forest & Wildlife Preservation Department on Determination of State Bird 2011, says: “Not every bird from the hawk family is a baaz. It is only the female of the Northern Goshawk that is a baaz, historically associated with Sikh history. The male is called a jurra. The female is larger than a male.”

Noting that it is common “to confuse every hunting bird, be it eagle, black kite or Shikra with a baaz”, Singh says: “There is no recorded sighting of the baaz in present-day Punjab or even Haryana. The closest sightings are in Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Rajasthan. There are very rare sightings of the goshawk in Maharashtra, but confined to winters when this raptor migrates from the Himalayas.”

NDMC chief seeks feedback to turn inner circle of CP vehicle-free

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

THE NEW Delhi Municipal Corporation (NDMC) chairperson Manoj Kumar Dwivedi on Thursday sought public feedback on a proposal to make the inner circle of Connaught Place vehicle-free.

Dwivedi, in a post on X, sought suggestions from people in the NCR who has visited Connaught Place to make the inner circle of the commercial and cultural hub 'vehicle-free'. He wrote, "At least once every person in NCR would have visited Connaught Place. I need your advice: Can we make the inner circle of CP vehicles free? People can walk around freely like on some mall roads or central areas in foreign cities."

He asked whether the plan should be implemented full-day or on a seasonal basis: 6:00 pm to midnight in the summer, and 11:00 am to 4:00 pm in the winter. Further, in his post, he sought suggestions for introducing different timings for weekends.

Dwivedi also requested 'positive suggestions' for NDMC's ideas including activities that can be held at the inner circle during the 'no-vehicles' slot.

COUPLE HAD CHECKED IN AT A NORTH DELHI HOTEL

Woman stabbed to death, husband found unconscious at hotel

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 3

A COUPLE had checked into a hotel in North Delhi's Lahori Gate hotel on Wednesday night. By Thursday morning, 28-year-old Shivani was dead from multiple stab wounds and her husband, Prakash, also 28, was found unconscious after allegedly consuming poison, police said.

The two were staying at Prince Hotel. Police said hotel staff became suspicious when the couple did not respond to calls. They opened the door with a spare key and found Shivani lying in a pool of blood and Prakash unconscious.

DCP (North) Niharika Bhatt said, "We received information at Lahori Gate police station that a man and a woman were found unconscious at Prince Hotel. A police team immediately reached the spot... the woman bore multiple stab wounds."

Both were rushed to the hospital, where the woman was declared dead on arrival. Police said Prakash is undergoing treatment.

Shivani hailed from Bihar's



The hotel in North Delhi's Lahori Gate. EXPRESS

Samastipur while Prakash is from Rajasthan. According to police, Prakash and Shivani got married about six months ago in Rajasthan where Prakash owned a tea shop. "But one month into their marriage, things started falling apart. There were disagreements between Shivani and her in-laws. The couple would also fight frequently," said a senior officer.

Police said Shivani subsequently left her in-law's house and came to Delhi around five months ago. She started working at a salon and lived in Old Delhi, said a police officer.

On Wednesday, Prakash told

Shivani that he was coming to Delhi to meet her, said an officer, adding that he reached the Capital by evening.

"He booked a room at the hotel and asked her to meet him. The couple then checked into the hotel at night," said a senior officer.

Police said that prima facie, Prakash appears to have consumed poison before he stabbed Shivani multiple times.

Police are now trying to establish contact with the woman's family and are trying to ascertain if it was a planned murder and verifying if Prakash was carrying a knife.

Two killed after bike skids, hit by SUV in Delhi Cantonment

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

TWO EMPLOYEES with the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) were killed after a Mahindra Thar rammed into their bike in Delhi Cantonment on Wednesday evening. The driver of the SUV, Bhupendra (26), was arrested after local residents caught hold of him at the accident site.

Police identified the deceased as Sukhbir Singh (55) and Manju Singh (45).

"The two motorcycle riders, aged between 45 and 50 years, were seriously injured in the crash. They were immediately shifted to a hospital, where doctors declared them dead on arrival," said DCP (Southwest) Amit Goel.

Police said a preliminary probe revealed that the motorcycle had allegedly slipped on the road and the Mahindra Thar, which was behind it, collided with the two-wheeler.

The victims were on their way home to Sector 1, Dwarka,



The Mahindra Thar. EXPRESS

from their workplace at Lodhi Road.

At the Safdarjung Hospital mortuary, Chote Lal, Sukhbir's elder brother, said he was returning from work when he got a call about the accident. "They said my brother was hit by a Thar. I called his number, but it kept ringing," he added.

Lal then dialled Delhi Cantonment police station, and was told that his brother was no more. "He had no one apart from me and my family. I want the person responsible for this to be punished," he said.

An FIR under charges of rash driving or riding on a public way and causing death by negligence has been registered, said the DCP.

COURT OVERTURNS RAPE ACQUITTAL

Can't expect four-year-old to describe assault precisely: HC

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 3

THE DELHI High Court has overturned a rape acquittal from 16 years ago citing various flaws in the order of the trial court, including its excessive reliance on the language used by a then four-year-old child to describe the offence.

"The Court must remain sensitive to the fact that a child of four years is incapable of understanding or articulating the legal ingredients of the offence and cannot be expected to describe the act in precise language. A perusal of the statement of the prosecutrix... reveals that she was hesitant, fearful, and shy while recounting the incident, reflecting the trauma she had undergone," a Bench of Justices Ravinder Dubeja and Navin Chawla said in an order passed on September 2.

"We are also unable to comprehend to the reasoning of the learned Trial Court that the offence of rape remained unproved merely because the prosecutrix did not expressly use the

word "penetration" in her testimony," the court said.

"The testimony of a child witness cannot be assessed on the touchstone of technical, legal or medical terminology, but must be appreciated by considering its substance, the surrounding circumstances and the natural manner in which the child of such a tender age narrates such a traumatic incident of rape," it added.

The Delhi Police, represented by Additional Public Prosecutor Aman Usman, had moved the HC against the judgment of April 10, 2010, in which a trial court had acquitted the accused of rape but convicted him for assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. The man was sentenced to rigorous imprisonment of a year and six months.

APP Usman submitted that the trial court had "erred in acquitting the respondent of the offence under Section 376 IPC while simultaneously convicting him under Section 354 IPC on the very same set of facts and evidence".

The court had erroneously held that the prosecution had failed to prove rape merely "because the victim had not expressly used the word "penetration" in her testimony", Usman argued. Usman told the court that even though the probe agency had failed to collect the blood group of the victim, blood-stained clothes including a bedsheet were recovered from the house of the accused.

"...The learned Trial Court proceeded mainly on the premise that the prosecution had failed to establish penetration merely because the prosecutrix did not expressly depose to the same. Such an approach overlooks that the testimony of a child victim cannot be assessed with undue emphasis on technical or anatomical terminology," the HC said.

"The medical evidence on record unequivocally corroborates the prosecution case...." the court said. "The Courts recognise that a child of such tender age cannot be expected to describe the act with clinical precision....," it added.

• **Skywatch**



Forecast: September 4, 2026
Generally cloudy sky; spell of light to moderate rain
MAX: 31-33°C
1.1°C below normal

MIN: 25-27°C
0.6°C below normal

• **AQI Tracker**

Location	AQI	Category
Bawana	56	Satisfactory
Wazirpur	132	Moderate
Mundka	76	Satisfactory
Narela	68	Satisfactory

● Good (0-50)
● Satisfactory (51-100)
● Moderate (101-200)
● Poor (201-300)
● Very Poor (301-400)
● Severe (401-500)

BRICS Summit: Govt offices in Delhi to remain shut on Sept 11

New Delhi: All the offices of the Delhi government, Central government will remain closed on September 11 in view of the 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit scheduled to be held at Bharat Mandapam from September 11 to 13, officials said on Thursday.

"The Lieutenant General of the NCT of Delhi is pleased to declare September 11 (Friday) to be a holiday in all government offices, autonomous bodies and public sector undertakings under the Delhi government in view of the BRICS Summit..." said the order issued by the General Administration Department.

In a office memorandum issued on Thursday, the Department of Personnel and Training said the decision to close Central government offices on September 11 in Delhi was taken considering the summit's scale and the logistical arrangements required for the event. **ENS**

Eye on curbing repeated road digging: Delhi govt approves multi-utility underground ducts

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

TO REDUCE repeated instances of road digging, the Delhi government has approved a city-wide plan for multi-utility ducts, beginning with two stretches in Chandni Chowk, to create common underground corridors for electricity, water, gas and other services.

The pilot project will cover 310 metres of Esplanade Road and 560 metres of Mor Sarai

Road, with work on both stretches set to begin soon, the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) said on Thursday.

The ducts will, wherever technically feasible, accommodate electricity cables, water and gas lines, fire-hydrant networks and other essential utility services, officials said.

The CMO said the system would "reduce the need to repeatedly dig up and repair roads, minimise disruptions to traffic, reduce inconvenience to

citizens and help maintain the structural strength of roads more effectively."

On the initiative, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, "We want to create infrastructure that is safe, well-organised and sustainable, keeping future requirements in mind. The multi-utility duct is part of this vision."

An expert technical panel will be constituted to guide the project and its expansion across the city. It will include expert of-

ficials from discoms, the DJB, the PWD and other departments, officials said.

The committee will oversee the technical design of the ducts, including provisions for ventilation, fire safety, maintenance access and emergency response.

The CMO said the arrangement would also improve coordination among agencies and reduce the possibility of accidental damage to utility lines during excavation.



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



ॐ कृष्णाय वासुदेवाय हरये परमात्मने।
प्रणतः क्लेशनाशाय गोविन्दाय नमो नमः॥

आप सभी को
श्री कृष्ण जन्माष्टमी
की हार्दिक शुभकामनाएं



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

STP TENDER ‘SCAM’

No direct link to kickbacks, delay in arrest: Why Satyendar Jain got bail



Satyendar Jain interacts with police officers at the Rouse Avenue Court in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 3

GRANTING BAIL to AAP leader and former Delhi minister Satyendar Jain in the alleged multi-crore sewage treatment plant (STP) tender scam, a Delhi court on Thursday noted that none of the corrigendums that changed the specifications of the work were approved by him.

Jain did not sign corrigendums

Special Judge Dig Vinay Singh of Rouse Avenue Court said all the corrigendums – a formal correction for a mistake found in a contract or notice after it has been published or released – were approved and signed by former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai, who is also an accused in the case.

“None of the corrigendums that changed the specification of the work was approved by the applicant. All were approved and signed by the CEO, Udit Prakash Rai (A-2),” the judge said.

Allegations primarily against other accused

The court said the allegations in the case were primarily against the other accused, while Jain’s alleged role was that of the minister who was alleged in conspiracy with them and aided the illegal transactions. “...even if the statements on record and the materials gathered are taken into account, the applicant’s complicity will have to be established at trial, and, if convicted, the applicant will be sentenced,” it added.

The court said that a few decisions taken by Jain raised eyebrows, but the same couldn’t be the reason to deny him bail.

“A few decisions taken by the applicant... as evident from the contents of the notes... do raise eyebrows, and he may not be innocent, but by themselves they are not enough at this stage to deny bail. The investigating agency ought to have first conducted a thorough in-

vestigation and gathered more evidence before rushing to arrest him,” it added.

No direct link to alleged kickbacks

The court noted that there were no WhatsApp chats, call records or SMS messages that, at this stage, connected Jain to the alleged kickbacks and hawala transactions involving the other accused.

“Prima facie, none of the WhatsApp chats links the applicant,” Judge Singh said, adding that there were no other phone records or SMS messages that might at present connect him to the alleged transactions.

27-month gap in arrest since FIR lodged

Further, the court questioned the “unexplained and extraordinary” 27-month gap between registration of the FIR and Jain’s arrest.

The FIR was registered on May 11, 2024, while Jain, Rai and four others were arrested on August 18 this year.

The court said the delay indicated that the investigating agency had not considered Jain’s physical custody necessary for over two years. It also said the prosecution had failed to identify any new circumstance that warranted his arrest after such a prolonged gap.

Evidence already seized by ACB

The court noted that the case largely rested on documentary and electronic evidence, including notes, files, technical proposals, minutes of meetings and bank transaction statements. These materials had already been seized by the ACB, it said.

The court also noted that the ACB had not sought police custody of Jain, indicating that there was no active requirement for custodial interrogation.

The ACB’s probe concerns a contract to upgrade and augment five STPs in Nilothi, Najafgarh, Narela and Kondli during 2021-22, when Jain was Water Minister. The agency has alleged that the tendering process was manipulated.

60-70% questions about X post on Home Minister, Home Secy: Ex-civil servant Joshi

Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 3

A DAY after he was questioned for nearly nine hours by the Delhi Police Special Cell, former civil servant Ashish Joshi claimed on Thursday that he had been summoned in connection with his August 26 post on X on the West Bengal elections, but that a substantial part of the questioning was about an earlier post in which he had referred to a purported disagreement between the Union Home Minister and Home Secretary.

Police have said that Joshi was questioned regarding a case that was registered by the Special Cell’s Counter Intelligence (CI) unit under Section 192 of the BNS, which deals with provocation with the intent, or knowledge, that it is



Ashish Joshi. X/@BISMIL_PRASAD

likely to cause a riot.

Around “60-70%” of the questions by police were relating to his August 12 post about the Home Minister and Home Secretary, Joshi told *The Indian Express*. Police were especially interested in knowing the source of his information, Joshi claimed. “They were more interested in the August 12 tweet. The questions were more about it and they wanted to know who

had told me about it,” Joshi, a former Controller of Communications in the Department of Telecommunications, said.

He said he had declined to reveal the source because “It would be unethical and intellectually dishonest,” he added.

Joshi said he was also questioned about his August 26 post, which was the stated subject of the police summons. In that post, Joshi had questioned the conduct of the electoral process and referred to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal.

The post also contained a reference to a “Nuremberg-style trial”. Joshi told *The Indian Express* that police had asked him what he had meant.

“I said the context of the Nuremberg trials is that all those who have betrayed the Constitution of India have to be

brought to book. They should be held responsible and accountable for taking actions which are inimical to the citizens of the country,” he said.

The Nuremberg trials were held by the victorious Allied powers after World War II to prosecute key leaders of Nazi Germany for war crimes.

Delhi Police spokesperson Rajeev Ranjan did not respond to messages or calls from *The Indian Express* seeking a response to Joshi’s claims regarding his questioning by the Special Cell.

On Wednesday, Special Cell officers picked up Joshi from near his home around 10 am. He was released around 7 pm, and dropped home by police after his family members gathered outside the office of the CI unit of the Special Cell in New Friends Colony.



Festival-ready

An illuminated ISKCON temple on the eve of Janmashtami, in New Delhi on Thursday. ANI

Beaten by cops, targeted for our surnames, allege women journalists; police deny charges

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

TWO WOMEN journalists working with digital news platform 4PM News Network alleged on Thursday that they were assaulted and detained by the Delhi Police following an incident close to the venue of a program attended by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta in South Delhi’s Saket.

Police denied the allegations, and said that the journalists were detained after they allegedly blocked the exit and parked their scooter on the VVIP movement route, and had an altercation with police personnel deployed there. No case had been registered until late on Thursday evening. Sen-



A grab from the video shared on X. @4PMNEWS_NETWORK

ior officers were in touch with the two women, police said.

The incident took place on Thursday morning when Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Gupta attended the inauguration of Max Smart Super Speciality Hospital in Saket. The journalists, Shaheen Khan and Nafisa Khan, alleged they had gone to cover the event, but were

stopped by police and taken to Saket police station.

In a video released by 4 PM News Network, Shaheen alleged they were physically assaulted and targeted by personnel at the police station because of their surname and religion. It showed bruises and welts on their bodies, which they alleged were the result of beating by police.

The Congress posted the video on its X handle. AAP leader Saurabh Bhardwaj condemned the alleged assault.

In a statement, the Press Club of India, Indian Women’s Press Corps, Delhi Union of Journalists, Press Association, and Kerala Union of Working Journalists “strongly condemn[ed] and call[ed] for punitive action against Delhi Police

officials...for brutally assaulting [the two] freelance journalists”.

In an official statement, DCP (South) Anant Mittal described the allegations as “factually incorrect and misleading”.

He said the “two women had obstructed the designated VVIP route by parking their scooter near the venue”, and had “refused to comply” with “repeated requests and instructions to remove the vehicle and clear the route”.

The statement said the women were “taken to the local police station for further enquiry”, but “allegations of assault for asking questions to the Hon’ble Chief Minister are totally false, misleading and baseless”.

EXPRESS exclusive

Rs 50 lakh paid: Gurgaon couple’s 9-year wait for a shop

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, September 3

IN 2017, Gurgaon residents Rohit Singh and Garima Sachan were looking to buy property when they were approached by sales executives from Raheja Developers who spoke about a new project, Raheja Trinity’, in Sector 84.

The executives, they claimed, “portrayed an extremely rosy picture” of high commercial returns. Singh, 46, who works in a private firm, told *The Indian Express* Thursday that he was keen on having a source of retiral income, and that the area where the project was located — Dwarka Expressway — was booming as an investment space. So, they booked a shop for Rs 52 lakh.

What followed was nearly nine years of waiting for a commercial unit that, the couple alleged, never progressed beyond the early stages of construction. Now, the Gurgaon bench of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HARERA) has ordered the builder to refund Rs 50.5 lakh with 10.80% an-

nual interest to the couple.

It also struck off the developer’s defence after it intentionally evaded written replies across six hearings.

Project left incomplete

In an order dated August 14, uploaded recently, HARERA chairperson Arun Kumar ruled in favour of the allottees after they discovered that despite collecting over 95% of the total cost for a 578.99 sq ft commercial unit at ‘Raheja Trinity’, the promoter had left the construction site completely deserted.

As per the order and their complaint before RERA, the couple had booked a shop on the first floor in September 2017. They signed a builder-buyer agreement on January 15, 2019, for a total sale consideration of Rs 52.98 lakh and deposited Rs 50,49,890 across installments. The builder committed to handing over possession in 48 months plus a 12-month grace period, setting the completion deadline for January 15, 2024.

However, when the buyers visited the site after the committed timeline elapsed, they



Raheja Trinity in Gurgaon’s Sector 84 remains incomplete. The couple had invested in a shop in the project. EXPRESS

were allegedly met with absolute inactivity. “...there was nothing on the ground i.e. the builder has not even completed the first phase of construction and... the construction was at halt and no one was present on the site,” the buyers alleged in their complaint, claiming that the promoter was “sleeping over the hard-earned money of the complainants”.

Builder’s defence struck off

The dispute then moved before the real estate regulator.

During the regulatory proceedings, legal counsel for Raheja Developers marked attendance on six separate dates between September 2024 and August 2026, but persistently failed to put its stance on record, the RERA said.

“Despite giving specific directions to file a reply, it has failed to comply with the orders of the authority. It shows that the respondent is intentionally avoiding filing ... written reply. Therefore, the defence of the respondent is hereby struck off,” the authority noted in its order.

Holding the promoter in violation of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, the authority cited a Supreme Court precedent to affirm that buyers have an “unconditional absolute right” to withdraw from a stalled project.

“The unqualified right of the allottee to seek refund... is not dependent on any contingencies or stipulations thereof,” the authority observed, noting that the Occupation Certificate had not been obtained even years after the promised completion date.

Refund with interest

Pegging the interest rate at 10.80%, calculated as the State Bank of India’s Marginal Cost of Funds Based Lending Rate (MCLR) of 8.80% plus 2%, HRERA directed Raheja Developers to refund the entire paid-up sum of Rs 50,49,890 — calculated from the date of each payment — within 90 days. It warned that legal consequences would follow if it fails to do so.

The company and its PR representatives have been contacted for a response.

Singh, who currently lives in a high-rise residential society towards Manesar, said it was a long fight. “I found out about the order only on Wednesday. But I am happy that the authority gave us full compensation for the delay,” he said.

The money invested was hard-earned, their lifelong savings, he stressed. “Respite will only come when we get the compensation. We are not aware of any appeals being filed or planned. The law has considered our rights; we have to see how serious Raheja is now,” Singh added.

“We were prepared for it (proceedings) to take at least two years, which it did. We would have been happy if it took a year less, but thankful regardless. Fortunately, as buyers/investors, we had a RERA-registered agreement.”

The experience has also changed how he plans to approach future investments. “I’ll be much more careful now,” said Singh.

“Due diligence is important in under-construction projects, I’ve now learnt the hard way...”

● AKRITI HAS SECURED BAIL IN FIVE FIRs, SIX BAIL PLEAS YET TO BE HEARD IN HIGH COURT

‘We’ll hug her tight’: In Durgapur, kin of DU student held over Noida stir dare to hope

Drishiti Jain
Noida, September 3

TWO MONTHS ago, before Akriti’s 25th birthday, her father, Arun Chaudhary, sat at their home in West Bengal’s Durgapur and wrote her a letter.

“My dear Soni, Happy birthday,” he wrote.

“But this time, your birthday is very difficult for us. Everyone is at home, but our greatest joy, our Soni, is not with us. Today, I can’t even hug you and say Happy Birthday. There’s probably no greater pain for motu papa.”

July 18 was her birthday. It was also her 99th day in police custody. Akriti’s friends, who visited her in jail that day, read her father’s letter aloud to her.

She had been behind bars since her arrest in April in connection with the Noida workers’ protest. Akriti was named in 11 FIRs, and a month

later, the National Security Act (NSA) was invoked against her.

On Wednesday, the Allahabad High Court quashed her detention, describing the invocation of the stringent NSA as “arbitrary and vague”.

The ruling, however, did not mean an immediate release. While Akriti has secured bail in five FIRs, six bail pleas are yet to be heard in the High Court.

For her father, the order was nevertheless a moment of relief. He said he has always trusted the judiciary.

“I know how my daughter was shaping out to be. I might have not said this to her, but when I visited her in Delhi in February, she took me to a basti where she used to teach poor children. I felt extremely proud that my daughter has grown into someone very different from the society... but I had told her to be cautious,” he said.

A history graduate from



Akrity Chaudhary with her family; (right) on her graduation day.

Delhi University who recently enrolled in law, Akriti, her father said, felt strongly about others. “Everyone fights for themselves, but she fought for the ones who couldn’t fight for themselves, the poor, the hungry.”

Arun said he used to send her Rs 14,000 a month. “She would say no to even an extra

rupee even though it was not possible to survive on this amount in Delhi... She used to take tuition classes to earn a little,” he said.

The family wanted her to prepare for the Union Public Service Commission Examination in Delhi so she would not have to face financial struggles,



“But she chose this life and we accepted it,” Arun said.

College senior and friend, Naureen Sabba, 26, said Akriti is an artist who used art to teach difficult subjects. “She used to do theatre and even produce and direct nukkad natak (street plays). On March 23, observed as Shaheed Diwas, she directed

a play in Shahbad Dairy,” she told *The Indian Express*.

Sabba said she lives in a locality where many children of domestic workers cannot afford classes for the Common University Entrance Test -- a standardised exam for admission to undergraduate and postgraduate programmes. “Akriti taught them,” she said.

She last met Akriti before leaving for her hometown on March 30. “Akriti had cooked mutton that day, though she is not a good chef. I still remember what she said: ‘Aapjiaa rahe ho, aapko rescue karne toh nahi aana padega agar aapke mummy papa na aane de wapas Delhi (You’re going, will we have to come to rescue you in case your parents don’t allow you to come back to Delhi?)’”

On Wednesday, Arun, who had been in Allahabad tracking the case, had to leave for Durgapur due to a death in the family.

His wife, and his son who lives in Chennai, were waiting anxiously as a hearing was scheduled.

Around noon, his phone buzzed. It was a notification from their lawyer, Manik Gupta: “NSA has been revoked, penalty of Rs 5 lakh ordered.”

For the family, it was the first good news in months. “Akriti’s mother has been very happy since yesterday. She used to say whenever I left for Noida, kisi tarah beti ko wapas leke aao (bring our daughter back somehow),” he said.

Her friends went to Kasna Jail in Gautam Buddh Nagar, where Akriti is lodged, to share the news about the High Court ruling. Suraj, 27, who first met Akriti during the DU Students’ Union election campaign in 2023, said, “We first met other friends in jail. We told Aditya about the NSA being quashed. He was happy... then, when Ak-

riti stood behind the mesh, he told her. She was very happy, and asked when Satyam’s hearing was due.”

Aditya Anand, an NIT Jamshedpur graduate, and Satyam Verma, a former journalist from Lucknow, were also arrested in the case. The NSA was slapped against Satyam as well.

“Akriti hasn’t stopped doing what she used to do outside. Inside, she reads books and discusses them with inmates who cannot read. She did not ever break down,” Suraj added.

Back in Durgapur, Akriti’s family said that once she is out, they will make her stay with them for at least 15 days. “We will take good care of her and hold her tight,” said her father.

For months, he said, all they could do was wait outside courts and the jail for a glimpse of their daughter through a mesh. “No parent should go through that,” he said.



ADVERTORIAL

Krishna is ‘Love’



Your life revolves around all that is Krishna, so what does Janmashtami mean to you?

Janamshtami is a joyous occasion when universally every Krishna devotee celebrates HIS birth in human avatar to liberate the oppressed from the wrong doers. Gaiety takes over with overwhelming expression of love by devotees through music, singing of hymns in HIS praise. This rejoicing undoubtedly builds a pleasant, spiritual ambience across.

Having said that, my take on the symbolism of Janmashtami is, however, different. For this you have to understand the four cosmic time cycles, each stretching across eons, of the Hindu philosophy. It says, Lord Vishnu, manifested in different avatars (human forms) in the Satya Yuga, Treta Yuga, Dwapar Yuga, and the Kali Yuga. It is only in the Dwapar Yuga that Krishna came in his own avatar alongwith Radha Rani, into an utterly chaotic world, only to spread the message of love. They dispelled the darkness created by baser human instincts of negativity, by removing the hurdles to attaining spiritual bliss. Love is one emotion that asks for a seekers total surrender to the Almighty. By doing so, you attain true salvation.

Krishna embodies and symbolises absolute LOVE for ultimate moksha (release) from the cycle of birth and death. The present global strife resonates with the era of Krishna and Radha's presence on earth, who kindled love to bring earthly order, hence of timeless relevance. I believe that the only path towards peace and harmony passes through the power of love for transformation of human beings and where the heart brims with love for all.

How do you intend to offer your obeisance to Lord Krishna on Janmashtami through creativity?

Each day of my life is dedicated in the service of Lord Krishna and Radha Rani in thought, word and action. My every art creation and fashion clothing find expression through themes based on Krishna, endeavouring to showcase HIS love. This studio has for over the past 30 years withheld its distinctive 'Krishna' identity, attracting people not only to possess a 'Sunil Mehra' collection, but also move closer to Krishna Bhakti. I interact with each of my customer encouraging them to explore, understand and experience the divine light of Krishna.

For Janmashtami this year, I shall be unveiling a series of new art work themed on Raas, depicting love, and which has much more meaning to what meets the ordinary eye. It is a dance of divine love symbolising Krishna as central and the entire cosmos revolving around him. Each piece of art on display is a work to behold as it celebrates the embodiment of love-Krishna.



*The ‘Flute collection’ depicting Radha - Krishna in the midst of cows on exhibit at the ‘**Sunil Mehra**’ gallery casts a magical spell for its sheer ethereal beauty as you step into the art gallery/showroom of the couture brand at Greater Kailash, New Delhi. An ardent Krishna devotee, Founder, Sunil Mehra, is a renowned designer of art and couture line that is unique for its Krishna motifs and so are his artworks on the same theme. Krishna Janmasthami (Birth of Lord Krishna), symbolises the unconditional and transformative power of love, which is the need of the hour in a world reeling under destructive forces in thought and in action. Only by taking refuge in Krishna, especially, the youth, can we build a better, kinder and happier world, believes Mr Mehra.*

eased this dilemma where surrender of ego and love can lead you on the path of Krishna Bhakti. Material offerings cannot win Krishna, but only 'bhav' i.e., pure expression of love, can. In the Bhagvad Geeta, in his sermon to Arjuna on the battlefield of Kurukshetra in the epic Mahabharata, Krishna explains true karma yoga, which involves performing one's duties without attachment to results, and dedicating all actions to the Divine. I believe that Krishna came to this world for nothing else but only on the mission of instilling love.

You chose a very different path of Krishna Bhakti from quiet a young age. What actually embarked you on this journey as a spiritual seeker?

As far as I can remember, when I was 27 years, the restlessness emerged wanting to find conditional love. As the quest became more intense, the search for true meaning of love and the experience of the emotion per

se, turned me into a voracious reader of philosophy, in-depth understanding of various scriptures including Taoism and even took me to different sects of believers, such as Osho, but it failed to anchor my wandering mind and conscious. There was a missing link, the pulse of which I could not catch. I felt incomplete. But the one common thing that I observed in my young spiritual journey that was shaping was that everybody in this world is looking for THAT LOVE. Whatever may be their explanation or stance of being fulfilled, the fact is that every human becomes complete ONLY when he/she finds THAT LOVE. My search ended when I found Krishna. Deeper understanding about HIM enamoured me to totally to HIS LOVE. No one guided me to Krishna, except my insight. One fine day, I just closed my eyes and the first image that emerged was of Radha - Krishna. My conscious recognised the indication of dedicating my art to the concept of Divine Love.



Being a designer, I chose the medium of my art in fashion to showcase LOVE through exclusive garments based on different spiritual themes at my shows. They were well received and I have never looked back with every creation of mine leaving a measure of imprint about Krishna's Love on my customers.

After you realised the call of Radha-Krishna, what was your first reaction and action taken?

On realising that I had found my answer to the long search for love, I went to the ISKON temple, something which I had never done earlier. I visited its library reading many books for a deeper understanding of Radha - Krishna. Thereafter, it was the first time that a gush of irrepressible urge rose in me to visit Vrindavan. It was an unearthly hour, yet, without a second thought, I promptly headed for the land of Krishna Leela. I recall vividly that it was a Tuesday and a holiday. This set my beautiful, spiritual journey in motion and since then has an unbroken ritual that I follow diligently of visiting Vrindavan every Tuesday for the past 30 years, without fail. It has re-inforced my belief that this could happen only because of the will and blessings of Radha-Krishna. My every visit to Vrindavan unveils a miracle, unravelling a new aspect of the power of Bhakti. I feel the presence of Radha- Krishna with me at every step, further strengthening the bond that they are so close to me. It's a beautiful emotion that defies any explanation, but can only be experienced. It reinforces my belief that Krishna came to this world just for Love. He first created Radha, who is the yogmaya Shakti of Krishna and then HE went on to create the world and instil love, which is the foundation of everything that happens on earth and ultimately devotees completes themselves through their selfless devotion of love offered to HIM. Only when the soul completes itself by merging with true love manifesting in the Divine Krishna through complete surrender of ego can one rid themselves from the cycle of rebirth. This is the ultimate universal truth.

Where do you find yourself across the spectrum of spiritual journey traversed by you, and how close are you to THAT COMPLETION?

One lifetime is insufficient to experience the entire import of divine love because love is kinetic and takes on different forms testing your patience, awakening your desire to experience that love, and unlock the bliss of finding the love of Radha- Krishna's. I have a long way to go, but yes, each day is new and comes with new challenges. By surrendering myself to the dynamics of the cosmos as per my deeds is my sincere endeavour to finally converge in that divine light of love. Every shade and colour in nature, be it the flowers, birds, and animals are creations that have

emanated from the love of Radha-Krishna. Each vibrant colour of these creations evoking a new bhav to which we relate instantly with joy.

How do you balance your spiritual journey with real life situations, which could be pleasant and not so pleasant?

This reminds me of the beautiful verse from Ram Charitmanas, " *Jaki Rahi Bhavna Jaisi, Prabhu Murat Dekhi Tin Taishi.*" Meaning, "As is a person's inner feeling, faith, or disposition, so does the Divine appear to them." Love makes you see HIM in everything including people because everyone is God's creation. So when HE is with you there is nothing to fear or face harshness, therefore, I don't see or feel agitated with any person or any situation. One must realise that every living thing function at different energy levels that may not be compatible with you, nevertheless, they are propelled by the creator himself. This realisation is the first step towards love and living by this philosophy comes realisation. To share an example, the artisans of Vrindavan with whom I have been associated for decades now, I have learnt a lot from them about humility and surrender to Krishna. Because if they are doing such beautiful art they have to be beautiful from within. I am where I am because of the artists of Vrindavan. It's been a humbling and journey of realisation working with them.

Is your method of worshipping Krishna different from others and its core philosophy?

Lord Vishnu, the Supreme power who runs the entire cosmos, has taken avatar in both, animal and human form, which is represented in the ten incarnations - 'dashavataar'. Lord Krishna is one of them standing-out with flute and the peacock feather adorning his crown. The flute represents the rhythm of life, therefore, Krishna said that if I am present anywhere first in the Vedas, then it is Samved, the scripture dedicated to music. Therefore, music is one medium by which one can connect with Krishna. I pray to Radha-Krishna the way I want to and not be fettered by any societal does and don'ts. I believe whatever time Krishna has given me on this earth, I should utilise it to the optimum to spread HIS message of love, which is the only way to peace and living a contented and happy life. If I am destined to do so in a larger mission-mode, I am sure HE will create those opportunities and open doors for me to move forward to accomplish what I have set out to. So far, I have touched many lives including that of customers and connected them to the power of Krishna's love. Even to take on such a stand and purpose in life needs tremendous courage, which I derive from the Supreme source-Krishna and HIS blessings.



FIRST VISIT BY A BELGIAN PM IN TWO DECADES; MODI & DE WEVER DISCUSS UKRAINE, WEST ASIA

From defence to fintech, India & Belgium give ties a major boost

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 3

INDIA AND Belgium agreed to strengthen defence and Intelligence-sharing, establish an investment fast-track mechanism, double bilateral trade, boost partnership on semiconductors and enter a pact on renewable energy, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi met the visiting Prime Minister of Belgium, Bart De Wever, on Thursday.

After the bilateral meeting, PM Modi said, "I am confident that today's discussions mark the beginning of a new chapter in our bilateral relations."

"Defence and security cooperation is a key pillar of our relationship. Today, we agreed to enhance military exchanges and training cooperation between the two countries. The agreements between our governments and defence industries will open up new opportunities for defence co-development and co-production. We will also further strengthen Intelligence-sharing and cooperation between our agencies in combatting crime," he said.

Belgian PM De Wever said, "The exchange of the letter of intent we have just witnessed gives that cooperation a new framework—from government to government contacts and military exchanges to research, innovation, co-development, and hopefully co-production. And alongside it, a series of additional defence-related MoUs are being concluded, bringing companies and institutions from both countries closer together. Security too is something we strengthen by working with partners we can trust."

Defence delegations from



PM Narendra Modi during a meeting with his Belgian counterpart Bart De Wever in Delhi, Thursday. PTI

the two sides met and agreed to strengthen cooperation in defence industries, which includes drones, anti-mine systems, rockets, tanks, munitions. Representatives from about 15 Belgian defence companies accompanied the Belgian Prime Minister and interacted with the Indian defence industry players as well.

PM Modi said, "For Belgian companies, we have established an Investment Fast-Track Mechanism in India. We have decided to make the India-Belgium Business Forum a regular mechanism. We will strengthen coordination among the financial, fintech and regulatory institutions of both countries. Through all these initiatives, we will realise our goal of doubling bilateral trade over the next five years."

Belgium is an important economic partner for India in Europe. Bilateral trade reached \$13.01 billion in 2025-26. Diamond trade, with Antwerp as a major global hub, remains a significant component of bilateral

commerce. Belgium is also an important source of investment in India. FDI inflows from Belgium amounted to approximately \$4.2 billion between April 2000 and December 2025.

This is PM De Wever's first visit to India since taking office in February 2025. This is also the first visit by a Belgian Prime Minister to India in two decades—marking a significant new phase in India-Belgium relations.

The Belgian PM said, "Prime Minister Modi and I had a very good discussion about trade and investment, and about broader changes taking place in the world of today and the economy of today. My country believes strongly in free and fair trade. For us, open markets are not just an abstract principle; they are part of our economical DNA and the basis of our prosperity. Trade within and between economies allows countries to specialize in what they do best. It spreads ideas and technology. It drives competition and innovation.

support all efforts aimed at an early end to conflicts and the restoration of peace."

The joint statement elaborated: "Regarding the war in Ukraine, both sides reaffirmed their support for efforts towards the achievement of a comprehensive, just and lasting peace through dialogue and diplomacy, in accordance with the principles of the United Nations Charter and international law. On West Asia, they discussed recent developments of concern in the region and underscored the importance of dialogue and diplomatic engagement to address challenges in a peaceful manner. They also stressed the importance of ensuring the safety and security of maritime routes and of maintaining safe and unimpeded maritime shipping."

PM Modi also referenced the GDP numbers and India's economic strength. "Today, the world is going through a period of great upheaval. Conflicts continue to persist in many parts of the world. Whether it is food, fuel, or supply chains, every sector is being impacted by uncertainty. In this challenging environment, India's economy has maintained its momentum. We recorded 7.8% growth in the last quarter. Today, India's growth story is becoming a source of confidence and new opportunities for the world," he said.

PM De Wever hinted that PM Modi will be visiting Belgium in December. "It would be a happy ending of the year 2026 to see the signature (happening) in Belgium, and we have the honour of receiving Prime Minister Modi in my country... I look forward to welcoming you to Brussels in December, maybe Antwerp."



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and his Belgian counterpart Theo Francken at a meeting in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Maritime security is a key area of focus. India wants to strengthen its capabilities in mine countermeasures, autonomous maritime systems, underwater robotics, advanced sensors and the protection of critical infrastructure, including ports, pipelines and subsea data cables.

There are also opportunities in weapons systems, ammunition, radar, electro-optical sensors, command and control, and counter-drone systems. These are precisely areas in which Belgian industry has particularly strong expertise.

"With this visit, we are reaping the benefits of what we have built over the past year. Access to major programmes, industrial cooperation and tangible results. Every project that connects our technology with India's growing defence industry strengthens both our security and our economic position. That means expertise, contracts and jobs in our country," Francken said.

EXPRESS special

'Is NRC being supported as a matter of principle, or as a political strategy against the Kuki-Zo?'

Tea Point

JAL SHAKTI Ministers of BJP-ruled states had a "joyful" interaction with Prime Minister Narendra Modi when he invited them for tea on Thursday. The ministers—23 of them from 14 states—came to the Capital to attend a meeting convened by Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil but were asked to stay back for a day. This meeting, coordinated by senior BJP leader Vinay Sahasrabudhe who heads the Department of Good Governance and Policy Research in the party, revived a practice that had been discontinued in 2011. Sources said PM Modi was keen to resume the practice of interacting with state ministers; there will be more such meetings at the BJP headquarters in the coming days. BJP national president Nitin Nabin also hosted a dinner for the state ministers on Wednesday.

UP: 26 doctors sacked over 'absenteeism' and 'negligence'

Press Trust of India
Lucknow, September 3

TWENTY-SIX DOCTORS posted at government hospitals and health centres in Uttar Pradesh have been dismissed for allegedly remaining absent for prolonged periods and failing to discharge their responsibilities, officials said on Thursday. The action was taken on the directions of Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak after the Health Department reviewed cases involving doctors accused of prolonged absence and negligence. The departmental action has also been ordered against nine other doctors for allegedly disobeying orders of senior officials and negligence in medical duties. "...Strict action will continue against those who remain absent from duty or neglect their medical responsibilities," Pathak said.

THE CENTRE'S decision to proceed with the delayed 2027 Census has opened a fresh political contest in Manipur over population, citizenship and future political representation. While Meitei civil society groups and political leaders, as well as sections of the Naga leadership, have demanded that an NRC be carried out before the Census and delimitation, the Kuki-Zo Council (KZC) has opposed the sequencing, calling it "premature and unjustified".

KZC spokesperson and Secretary for Information and Publicity **Ginza Vualzong** tells **Deeptiman Tiwary** about the Census, NRC, the Naga-Kuki tensions and the council's changing position on Manipur's political process, among other issues. Excerpts:

Why does the KZC oppose an NRC before the Census?

There is nothing to fear about the NRC; what we question is its legality and manner in which it is being proposed. The NRC is a national exercise, and there is no provision in the Constitution to conduct it ex-

clusively in a particular state. As a national exercise, we leave it to the wisdom of the Centre to decide whether it should be conducted nationwide keeping in mind the failure in Assam.

The argument being advanced by Meiteis is that the NRC is needed to identify and address the supposedly inflated number of illegal immigrants from Myanmar. But Manipur is not the only Indian state sharing an international border with Myanmar or other countries. So why should NRC be conducted only in Manipur? Would that not be discriminatory? If the objective is to settle claims about illegal immigrants, refugees, or abnormal population growth among the Kuki-Zo, the most appropriate starting point is credible demographic data. The Census is the proper instrument for establishing such facts. Therefore, demanding an NRC before the completion and publication of the 2027 Census data is premature and unjustified.

The Naga leadership is also backing an NRC. Does the KZC see this as a political



move against Kuki-Zos?

Irrespective of community, whether Kuki-Zo, Meitei or Naga, the NRC will affect everyone, as we have seen in Assam. In fact, as per the last Census, the most significant population growth was recorded in the Naga-dominated district of Senapati. I believe the Naga leadership in Manipur is supporting the NRC primarily to gain favour with the Meiteis, particularly at a time when they are in conflict with the Kuki-Zo. This raises an important question: is the NRC being supported as a

matter of principle, or as a political strategy against the Kuki-Zo?

Given the Kuki-Zos' links with Myanmar, how do you respond to concerns over illegal immigration?

Before India came into existence, our people lived on the same land. Unfortunately, the British colonial administration divided our ancestral homeland across different territories, leaving our people in what are now India, Myanmar, and Bangladesh. This division was imposed without our consent or knowledge. The same historical reality applies to the Naga and Meitei people, many of whom also lived across what is now Myanmar. If there are genuine concerns about illegal immigration, they must first be established through credible demographic data and evidence...

The KZC had welcomed the end of President's Rule and Khemchand government. Why has that changed?

We had hoped the change of government in Manipur would bring greater security, stability,

and normalcy. Unfortunately, the reality has been the opposite. Attacks and killings continue, and the present state government, led by Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, has failed to provide the Kuki-Zo people with the security and confidence necessary for peaceful coexistence. The Kuki-Zo Council therefore calls for the reimposition of President's Rule in Manipur. Our people felt safer under President's Rule...

2 Kuki-Zo MLAs returned to the Assembly despite the call for a boycott. Does the KZC support this?

As these MLAs have chosen not to resign, they remain part and parcel of the Manipur government and continue to bear political responsibility for its actions. Imphal has become a valley of death for the Kuki-Zo people, where hundreds have been killed and our homes destroyed... If they are not going to speak for their people, then what exactly is the purpose of their presence in the Assembly?

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India and Belgium sign strategic deals, underline maritime security & drone tech

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 3

FROM MARITIME security to military hardware, from drones to rockets—India and Belgium decided to cooperate and pacts were signed between the two sides, as Belgian Defence Minister Theo Francken met Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday.

Francken, who holds the portfolios of defence and foreign trade, is accompanying Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever.

Francken said, "India is a rapidly growing economy and a major military power in the Indo-Pacific. The country is also strategically located along some of the world's most important trade routes. For an open trading nation like Belgium, the security of these sea lanes is vital. At the same time, Europe's security is increasingly interconnected with developments in Asia. Russia is waging war in Ukraine and is cooperating ever more closely with Iran and North Korea in the military sphere. China is becoming increasingly assertive in the Indo-Pacific. What happens in Asia has consequences for Europe. And vice versa."

The two sides signed a Letter of Intent that touches upon training, exchanges between officers, research and development, seminars, joint exercises and cooperation on maritime security.

"We have built trust. Now we need to translate that into concrete cooperation. Not non-binding declarations, but joint training, industrial projects and opportunities for our companies," says Francken.

24 days on, no FIR over Haldwani 'purification' yet: Kharge to Nadda

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

MALLIKARJUN KHARGE, Leader of Opposition in Rajya Sabha, wrote to Leader of the House J P Nadda on Thursday that no FIR had yet been registered in connection with the "purification" ritual in Uttarakhand's Haldwani even after 24 days since the incident—and despite his assurance.

The Congress president recalled that on August 13, he raised in Rajya Sabha the issue of the alleged "purification" carried out in Haldwani after his public meeting there on August 8 "with great sadness and pain". Kharge stated Nadda had then said it was "indeed a very sad matter".

"This is not just sad for the Congress, but sad for all of us... Whatever has happened will certainly have to be probed. I would like to say that the BJP never supports such activity. I condemn it and the national president will also look into it seriously. Whatever sentiments of yours have been hurt, that is a matter of concern for all of us," Kharge wrote, quoting Nadda. "You had also said that strict



Mallikarjun Kharge, Leader of Opposition in Rajya Sabha

action would be taken against anyone found guilty, after a probe. The Hon'ble Chairman of the Rajya Sabha had also expressed his deep anguish over the incident," Kharge wrote.

"But I am surprised that even after 24 days have passed since the incident, no FIR has yet been registered against the organisations and individuals involved in carrying out the alleged purification ceremony in Haldwani," according to the Congress president.

Kharge has also urged Nadda to direct Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhama to ensure that an FIR is registered against the individuals and organisations involved in the "purification" ceremony.

● CHIEF MINISTER REVIVES STATE'S BID TO USE TAMIL AS THE PRIMARY LANGUAGE OF THE MADRAS HIGH COURT, ALONGSIDE ENGLISH

Tamil be given its entitled Constitutional opportunity: Vijay in House

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 3

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay moved a government resolution in the Legislative Assembly on Thursday urging the Union government and the President to clear the use of Tamil as the primary language of the Madras High Court, alongside English. The move revives a demand the House endorsed 20 years ago.

The resolution seeks procedures allowing petitions, documents and arguments to be submitted in Tamil; a system for judgments, decrees and court orders to be issued officially in Tamil; and training in legal Tamil and translation for judges, advocates and court employees.

"This is not a demand to remove English," Vijay told the Assembly. "It is a demand that Tamil be given the constitutional opportunity to which it is entitled." The proposal turned a constitutional question into an argument about lived experience. A person may be physically present in a courtroom yet remain outside the meaning of what is unfolding if the words determining one's life, land, family, employment, property or rights cannot be understood.

"The language of justice being a language that the people can understand is a fundamental objective of democracy," Vijay said. Tamil is the State's official language under Section 2 of the Tamil Nadu Official Language Act, 1956. Sections 4-A and 4-B,



CM C Joseph Vijay during the Assembly session on Thursday. PTI

introduced through amendments in 1976, legally permit evidence to be recorded and judgments, decrees and orders to be written in Tamil in civil and criminal courts subordinate to

the HC, as well as in tribunals, rent courts and revenue courts.

The constitutional route for extending that use to the HC is more complicated. Article 348(1) of the Constitution provides for

English to be used in proceedings before the Supreme Court and HCs. But Article 348(2) allows a State governor, with the President's prior consent, to authorise the State's official language in HC proceedings.

Section 7 of the Official Languages Act, 1963, similarly allows the governor, again with prior presidential consent, to authorise an official language in addition to English for judgments, decrees and orders. An English translation must accompany a ruling delivered in the State language. Tamil Nadu's Assembly unanimously passed a similar resolution on December 6, 2006, and forwarded it to the Union government. During the debate, lawmakers stressed that Tamil would supplement, rather

than displace, English.

The proposal did not advance. As per the present resolution, the Union law minister told the Rajya Sabha on February 22, 2018, that it had been referred to the CJJ and that the top court's full court had declined it in a letter dated October 16, 2012.

Vijay argued that rejection at one point could not close the question forever. Legal education, law books, dictionaries and translations of judgments in Tamil have expanded, he said, while digital courts, legal databases and technology-assisted translation have advanced. AI now makes it possible, he said, for speech in Tamil to be heard simultaneously in English.

Vijay described Tamil as the world's oldest language, still

spoken vibrantly, with grammatical and literary riches spanning thousands of years and about nine crore speakers worldwide, including eight crore in India. The Union government recognised it as a classical language on October 12, 2004, based on its antiquity, continuous literary tradition, inscriptions and historical evidence.

The resolution calls on the Union government to act immediately on a proposal forwarded by the governor under Article 348(2) and Section 7. Vijay asked members of every party to adopt it unanimously, calling it not a demand against another language, but a democratic claim to understand, approach and experience justice in one's own language.

‘Got WhatsApp text asking if I’d accept post, I froze’: First Ram Mandir woman trustee

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 3

ON SEPTEMBER 2, Dr Nirmala Yadav, 66, received a WhatsApp message from the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust. She was asked to confirm, at short notice, whether she would accept the position of trustee of the Ram Mandir trust. “I froze for a moment,” Yadav, a retired teacher and former principal from Shikohabad, in Firozabad district, told *The Indian Express*.

“I’d been given an indication that I could be given a role in the Trust, but I never expected to become a trustee. I received a message on WhatsApp asking me to confirm whether I would accept the responsibility and was asked to respond quickly.” Later that evening, she was announced as the first and only woman member of the Trust. “I had never dreamt of it. I thought I had already played almost all the roles I had to in life. Then this came as a blessing from Lord Ram,” she said.

At its meeting on Wednesday, the Ram Temple Trust appointed retired Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra as its first Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and inducted three new trustees — Dr Yadav, advocate Madan Mohan Pandey and businessman-social worker Mahesh Bhagchandka. The three will fill positions that fell vacant after Bimlendra Mohan Mishra’s death last year and the resignation of former general secretary Champat Rai and member Anil Mishra in the wake of the donation theft row.

With a PhD in Hindi, Yadav spent 25 years as a college principal. She was also part of the Akhil Bharatiya Rashtriya Shaikshik Mahasangh (ABRSM), an RSS-affiliated teachers’ organisation. Her administrative experience in management, she said, would help her contribute to the Trust’s functioning. “My selection also reflects women’s empowerment; I’ll ensure that the suggestions and concerns of women are appropriately placed before the Trust during important decisions,” she said.

Yadav began her career as a lecturer at BDA Kanya Mahavidyalaya, Shikohabad, in 1999.



Dr Nirmala Yadav is a 66-yr-old retired college principal from UP’s Firozabad district

She became its principal, serving in that position until 2006. From 2006 to 2022, she was principal of Mahatma Gandhi PG College in Firozabad. She retired in 2022. Her association with the ABRSM also dates back to 1999, when she became vice-president of its UP unit. She subsequently served as vice-president of its national women’s wing and as vice-president for higher education.

For the past two years, she had been serving as the organisation’s Akhil Bharatiya “Sam-park Pramukh”. After she retired, Yadav was elected to the council of Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar University, Agra, as the Governor’s nominee. She studied in Bareilly and Etah districts before marrying into a family in Shikohabad. Her family, too, has links with the RSS and the broader Sangh ecosystem. Yadav said her father-in-law was associated with the RSS, while her late husband, an advocate, was associated with both the RSS and BJP.

Her husband’s family is associated with the Urawar (Zamindar) Estate, whose members established a college in Shikohabad in 1916. The institution, popularly known as “Ahr College”, was later renamed Adarsha Krishna PG College.

Her appointment is also politically significant due to its underlying symbolism. One, she is a Yadav woman gaining representation in Ram Mandir, the centrepiece of the BJP’s ideological achievement. Two, she is from Shikohabad, a key Yadav stronghold that has seen a decades-long political tug-of-war between the SP and BJP.

‘Needs more maturity’: Mayawati’s flip-flop on nephew Akash again

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, September 3

EVEN AS parties are projecting young leaders in their bid to connect with Gen Z voters and the youth, Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) president Mayawati on Thursday dropped hints of sidelining her nephew Akash Anand, saying he needs to become more mature and it would be inappropriate to assign him significant responsibilities at this point.

Sources in the BSP said she has removed Akash from the post of national convenor. Akash was absent from a meeting of BSP’s national office-bearers in Lucknow. However, his younger brother Ishaan Anand was present and occupied the chair usually reserved for Akash. While BSP general secretary Mevalal said “the message lies in the press release (issued after the meeting)”, another party leader said, “Behenji did not clarify whether Akash has been removed. Akashji will work for the party as a worker.”

In a statement issued after the meeting, Mayawati said, “Just as respected Shri Kanshi Ram Ji allowed his family members and other relatives to support in party work, but he was opposed to allowing them to contest elections or give them any position if the government was formed, I too remain firmly committed to that resolution. Acting on this, I have allowed Akash Anand to work in the party... However, Akash Anand still needs to be more mature in this matter. Until then, it would not be appropriate to give him significant party responsibilities. This is needed to avoid harm in the elections due to tactics used by opponents.”

In May last year, Mayawati elevated Akash as the BSP’s chief national coordinator. Three months later, she appointed him the party’s national convenor,



Akash Anand was projected as Mayawati’s political heir ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha polls

signalling his formal rehabilitation within the party hierarchy after a public fallout.

Last month, as part of his re-launch in BSP, 31-year-old Akash addressed meetings of party workers in Hathras on August 10 and in Jewar on August 25. He also announced BSP candidates for the two assembly seats for the 2027 UP election. Sources said the BSP had planned public meetings by Akash across the state in October-November, with an eye on the polls.

The fresh setback marks the latest chapter in Akash’s eventful relationship with his aunt Mayawati over the past two years. Projected as her political heir ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, he was entrusted with leading the BSP’s campaign, particularly in UP.

However, in May 2024, after being booked for allegedly promoting enmity during a public rally in Sitapur ahead of the Lok Sabha election, Mayawati removed her nephew as BSP’s national coordinator and withdrew her earlier declaration naming him as political heir. He was also barred from campaigning. Later, Mayawati accused Akash of acting under the influence of his father-in-law Ashok Siddharth, then a senior BSP leader, and said he had prioritised family interests over the party. Akash was briefly expelled from the BSP in March 2025 before being reinstated after he expressed regret and pledged loyalty to the party leadership.

Manipur govt warns legal action against those blocking highways

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, September 3

THE MANIPUR Government has warned of strict legal action against individuals, organisations and groups involved in road blockades, obstructions and damage to public property in the state.

The state Home Department issued the order on Thursday and said it comes into force with immediate effect. In the order, the state government reiterated that strict action would be taken against violators without exception.

“The government had received reports of bandhs, blockades, road obstructions, forcible restrictions on movement and other unlawful activities on National Highways and roads, causing hardship to the public

and disrupting the movement of essential commodities, goods and services. Under the order, no individual, organisation, association, group or body shall block, obstruct, barricade or otherwise interfere with traffic on any National Highway, State Highway or public road in Manipur,” says the order.

It also prohibits attempts to restrict the movement of essential commodities, fuel, medicines, emergency services, public transport, goods vehicles and private vehicles.

The order directs Deputy Commissioners, Superintendents of Police and other law-enforcement agencies to take immediate measures to ensure uninterrupted movement on highways and roads and initiate prompt legal action against violators.



Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh at the Assembly on Thursday. PTI

“Those found organising, instigating, supporting or participating in unlawful blockades, highway obstruction, damage to public property or acts resulting in breach of peace may face

prosecution without further notice under relevant laws, including the National Highways Act, Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, Motor Vehicles Act, Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,” it says.

The order specifically cites Section 8B of the National Highways Act, 1956, under which acts rendering or likely to render an NH impassable or less safe for travelling or conveying property may attract imprisonment of up to five years, or fine, or both.

It also appeals to citizens, civil society organisations, student bodies, community organisations, unions and associations to maintain peace and order and refrain from bandhs, blockades, forcible road obstruction and damage to public property.

Revanth moves to drop Surekha, reshuffles key posts amid Congress disciplinary action

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, September 3

TELANGANA CHIEF Minister A Revanth Reddy has decided to drop Endowments Minister Konda Surekha from the Council of Ministers with immediate effect, the CMO said.

“A recommendation to this effect has been sent to the Hon’ble Governor already,” a release issued by the CMO said. For Surekha to be dropped from the Council of Ministers, Telangana Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla has to give his assent. Soon after the CM’s office announced its decision, Surekha released letters she had written to Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, AICC chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Congress general secretary K C Venugopal and the party’s Telangana in-charge Meenakshi Natarajan, claiming that she was discriminated against on account of being a “BC (Backward Classes) woman leader”.

The CM has also decided to rescind the appointment of G Chinna Reddy as vice-chairman of the Telangana Planning Board with immediate effect. “In place of G Chinna Reddy, Gadwal Vijayalakshmi has been appointed as Vice Chairman, Te-



Telangana CMA A Revanth Reddy; minister Konda Surekha

langana Planning Board,” the release said. Vijayalakshmi served as the Mayor of the Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation. She was earlier with the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) but joined the Congress in 2024.

In her letter to Gandhi, on August 23, Surekha alleged that key decisions in the Endowments Department were being taken without consulting her — that she was kept out of the Yadadri Temple Trust Board process, that Sammakka-Saralamma temple funds were shifted to the Roads and Buildings Department, and that her photo was “omitted” from government advertisements. She also alleged that her Officer on Special Duty (OSD), Sumanth, was “removed and targeted” without her knowledge.

She alleged that her family



was being politically isolated in Warangal and a show-cause notice was issued to her over statements made by her adult daughter. The letter asks Gandhi to order a comprehensive inquiry into the circumstances that led to her isolation. Surekha’s removal from the Council of Ministers comes after the Congress disciplinary commit-

tee recommended it in August. The committee had also recommended removing G Chinna Reddy from his position as state Planning Board vice-chairman.

A report to this effect was submitted to Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee president and party MLC B Mahesh Kumar Goud. Speaking at a press conference in Hyderabad on Tuesday, Congress leader, MP and disciplinary committee chairman Mallu Ravi said, “...Disciplinary action must be taken so that the party comes to power again.”

Speaking to the media on Thursday, Surekha said that she “has not decided on the future course of action”.

WITH INPUTS FROM SREENIVAS JANYALA

NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED
(A Govt. of India Undertaking) A-11, Sector-24, Noida-201301
Phone No.-0120-2412294, Fax No.-2412397

Pre-qualification of parties for freight forwarding of imported consignments (sea mode)

National Fertilizers Limited intends to pre-qualify and draw a comprehensive list of pre-qualified freight forwarders (Sea mode). For eligibility criteria & other details please visit our website: www.nationalfertilizers.com or www.eprocure.gov.in. Last date for submission of documents is **12.10.2026 up to 02:00PM**, Corrigendum (if any) will be displayed on our website only. **GM (Materials)**

NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY AND JUDICIAL ACADEMY, ASSAM
Hajo Road, Amingaon, Guwahati-781 031
Advt. No.: NLUJA/ADMIN/F/CONVOCATION-4/2026/50 Date: 03.09.26

FOURTH CONVOCATION OCTOBER 10, 2026

National Law University and Judicial Academy, Assam takes immense pleasure in announcing its Fourth Convocation Ceremony scheduled to be held on **October 10, 2026** at **Srimanta Sankaradeva Kalakshetra, Punjabari, Guwahati-781037**. Candidates (UG, PG, Ph.D) who have qualified for award of degree certificate shall register themselves online. For further information please visit University's website www.nluassam.ac.in

Sd/- Registrar

International Institute for Population Sciences
(Deemed to be University)
An Autonomous Organization of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India
Govandi Station Road, Deonar, Mumbai - 400088.

ADVERTISEMENT NOTIFICATION NO. ADMIN. 01/2026

Applications are invited through proper channel for 01 post of Chief Administrative Officer (Group 'A') on Deputation basis in Pay Level-13 of the 7th CPC Pay Matrix. Eligible officers with the prescribed qualifications and experience may apply. Last date for receipt of application: 05th October, 2026. The prescribed application format and detailed advertisement are available on the Institute's website: www.iipsindia.ac.in

Director & Sr. Professor, IIPS

NIRMAL EDUCATION SOCIETY'S SUBHASH DESAI COLLEGE OF LAW
D.S. Road, Asha Nagar, Thakur Complex, Kandivali (East), Mumbai - 400101.
APPLICATIONS ARE INVITED FOR THE FOLLOWING POSTS FROM THE ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-27

UN-AIDED LLB (3 YEARS COURSE)

Sr. No.	Cadre	Subject	Total no. of Post.	Post Reserved for
1	Principal	----	01	01-OPEN
2	Assistant Professor	Law	07	01-ST, 01-DT(A), 01-OBG, 01-SEBC, 01-EWS, 02-OPEN, Horizontal Reservation- Women- 01 Post (01- OPEN)
3	Librarian	----	01	01-OPEN

The posts for the reserved category candidates will be filled in by the same category candidates (Domicile of State of Maharashtra) belonging to that particular category only. Reservation for women will be as per University Circular No. BCC/16/74/1998 dated 10th March 1998. 4% reservation shall be for persons with disability as per University Circular No. Special Cell/ICC/2019-20/05 dated 05th July, 2019. Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.

“Qualification, Pay Scales and other requirements are as prescribed by the UGC Notification dated 18th July 2018, Government of Maharashtra Resolution No. Misc-2018/C.R.56/18/UNI-1, dated 8th March 2019 and University Circular No. TAAS/ (CT)/ICD/2018-19/1241, dated 26th March 2019 and revised from time to time.”

The Government Resolution & Circular are available on the website nue.ac.in. Applicants who are already employed must send their application through proper channel. Applicants are required to account for breaks, if any in their academic career.

Applications with full details should reach the **TRUSTEE, NIRMAL EDUCATION SOCIETY'S SUBHASH DESAI COLLEGE OF LAW, Nirmala Memorial Foundation Campus, D. S. Road, Asha Nagar, Thakur Complex, Kandivali (East), Mumbai - 400101** within 15 days from the date of publication of this advertisement.

Sd/- TRUSTEE

HC dismisses Stalin’s challenge to Kolathur election result, says remedy in poll petition

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 3



Former Tamil Nadu CM and DMK president M K Stalin

THE MADRAS High Court on Thursday dismissed former Chief Minister and DMK president M K Stalin’s challenge to his defeat in Kolathur, ruling that his attempt to seek a complete VVPAT count and verification of all electronic voting machines could not be entertained as a writ petition and must instead be pursued through the special legal mechanism for challenging an election.

A Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G Arul Murugan dismissed Stalin’s petition as not maintainable, holding that it was barred by Article 329(b) of the Constitution read with Section 80 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. The judgment was reserved on August 31 and delivered on September 3.

Significantly, the court did not decide whether any of the irregularities Stalin alleged in the EVM and VVPAT verification process had actually occurred or whether they raised doubts about the Kolathur result. It expressly left those questions open, saying it was unnecessary to examine the merits once it had concluded that the writ itself was not maintainable. With this order, the most consequential electoral defeat of Stalin’s career remains intact. But the court has left the factual dispute beneath it unresolved — not because it found nothing to examine, but because it con-

cluded that Stalin had come before the wrong legal door.

Stalin had finished second in Kolathur in the April Assembly poll, losing to Vijay’s TVK candidate V S Babu. Three days after the result, on May 7, Stalin sought checking and verification of EVMs from 14 polling stations, constituting 5% of the constituency’s 286 polling stations. The process began on July 29, nearly three months later, and concluded on August 5, when the District Election Officer certified that it had been successfully carried out.

Stalin’s affidavit challenged that conclusion through a catalogue of alleged problems uncovered during the exercise. It said VVPAT units at polling stations 28 and 75 malfunctioned during confirmatory mockpolls; EVM carrying cases from polling station 157 had blank or irregularly sealed address tags; two ballot units at polling station 79 did not tally with recorded address tags; and, at polling station 208, a Control Unit failed to detect a Ballot Unit said to bear Stalin’s name.

Antim Ardaas
SARDAR HARBHAJAN SINGH
04.03.1954 - 02.09.2026
with profound grief and sorrow that we announce the passing of Sardar Harbhajan Singh, who left us peacefully on 02 September 2026 in London.
BHOG OF SHRI AKHAND PATH SAHIB
will be held on Saturday 05.09.2026 at 08.45 AM followed by Kirtan at GURUDWARA SRI GURU SINGH SABHA, GREATER KAILASH-2, DELHI-48 #: 98116 95855
-----FONDLY REMEMBERED BY-----
Harmeet Kaur - Wife Jasmeet Singh - Son
Pardeep Singh - Son Daman Deep Singh - Son

PM SHRI KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA
(Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)
Sector-2 Rama Krishna Puram, New Delhi-110022
Website: kvpuramsec2.kvs.ac.in | Email: pmshriskvpuram2@kvsrodelhi.in
CBSE School Code: 29013 | CBSE Affiliation No.2700002
Tel. No. - 011-26867615 | KVS Vidyalaya Code: 1437

TENDER NOTICE

PM Shri Kendriya Vidyalaya Sector – 2 R K Puram, New Delhi-110022 is inviting sealed tenders from reputed/registered firms for M&R Civil & Plumbing works, Tent items and PA System on hire and providing canteen services in the Vidyalaya. The Tender form can be obtained from the Vidyalaya office during all working days from **05.09.2026 to 19.09.2026 between 11:30 AM to 02:30 PM** by depositing Rs.1000/- in cash/cheque/demand draft in favor of **VVN KV Shift-1 Sec 2 R K Puram, New Delhi**. Sealed tenders should reach the Vidyalaya office through Speed post/registered post within 21 days of publication of this notice in the newspaper.

Principal

पेंशन निधि विनियामक और विकास प्राधिकरण
PENSION FUND REGULATORY AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) is a statutory regulatory body established by Parliament of India under the PFRDA Act (23 of 2013) and set up under Ministry of Finance, Government of India with the mandate to promote, develop and regulate pension sector in India. PFRDA invites applications from Indian Citizens for filling up of 30 posts of Assistant Managers (Grade 'A') in various streams on **direct recruitment basis** as under:

Stream	NUMBER OF POSTS					Out of which PwBD*	Total Posts
	SC	ST	OBC	EWS*	UR/ GEN		
General	4	2	7	3	9	1(Blindness and Low Vision)	25
						1 (Deaf and Hard of Hearing)	
Research	1	-	-	-	1	-	2
Actuary	-	-	-	-	2	-	2
Official Language (Rajbhasha)	-	-	1	-	-	-	1
Total	5	2	8	3	12	2	30

2. Details of requisite qualification and experience along with terms and conditions of appointment to the post may be seen at PFRDA website: www.pfrda.org.in. Eligible and willing candidates may apply through online mode from 03.09.2026 to 24.09.2026.

3. PFRDA reserves the right to cancel/terminate the exercise at any stage as may be considered appropriate by the Authority.

General Manager (Human Resources)

‘Human life is a precious gift’: HC spares death-row convict, cites social boycott

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 3

TAKING INTO consideration that a death-row convict was treated as an outcast for marrying outside of his caste and the social isolation it may have caused, the Madhya Pradesh High Court commuted his death sentence for the sexual assault of a toddler. While doing so, the court emphasised that “human life is a precious gift of God”.

A Division Bench of Justices Vivek Agarwal and Avanindra Kumar Singh instead sentenced him to life imprisonment for at least 25 years without remission and observed that the convict had been “treated as an outcast in the society only on account of performing marriage in another caste”, and held that he could not be regarded as a continuing threat to society warranting the “rarest of rare” punishment.

The Bench specifically relied on the fact that the convict had been socially ostracised after marrying outside his caste. “He is already treated as an outcast in society only on account of performing marriage in another caste,” the court observed, adding that there was “no evidence of him being a professional or habitual offender” and that he was “not a continuous threat to society.”

The court consequently held that Dhimar “cannot be treated to be a menace to society requiring ‘rarest of rare’ punishment in the matter.” It added: “Human life is a precious gift of God, therefore in the facts and circumstances of this case and law laid by Hon’ble Supreme Court we find that life should not be taken away lightly from [the] appellant.”

The Bench said the convict came from a “rural economically weaker background” and

had family responsibilities. It also took into account his conduct while in custody. Referring to a report from the Assistant Superintendent of Sub-Jail, Budhar, the court noted that “he has not committed any act of indiscipline” during his incarceration.

“These circumstances, coupled with the fact that appellant has no previous criminal antecedents and possibility of his reformation or/and rehabilitation at the age of 32 years cannot be ruled out,” the bench said.

The Bench also drew attention to inconsistencies in the prosecution evidence. It noted that the DNA report showed that the victim’s lower garment, recovered from Dhimar’s house, matched the victim’s source swabs, but “no male DNA profile was found in [the] victim’s above articles”.

The court also pointed to the prosecution’s failure to examine a potentially important

child witness. Referring to the convict’s minor daughter, whose statement allegedly described her father slapping and throwing the victim to the floor, the court said: “This child eye-witness has not been examined before the trial Court.” It described her as “the best witness” who “could have thrown more light on the manner in which [the] incident took place”.

While the court upheld his conviction for sexual assault, murder, concealment of evidence and criminal intimidation, it found the case did not meet the threshold for capital punishment. The judgment records that the child, aged two years and five months, was left in the convict’s custody while her mother went to collect coal. Her mother later discovered her with a skull fracture and injuries suggestive of sexual assault. The child passed away at a local hospital during treatment.

Notice to 450 BEd colleges in Bengal, ‘cash for degree’ claims

Kolkata: The state higher education department has issued show-cause notices to at least 450 BEd (Bachelor of Education) colleges in the state after allegations of several ‘cash-for-degrees’ scams, Higher Education Minister Jagannath Chattopadhyay informed Thursday.

Addressing a press conference, Chattopadhyay alleged fake degrees were being sold at several BEd, polytechnic, ITI and pharmacy colleges in the state, adding that a number of BEd colleges had mushroomed in the last 15 years. He said, the higher education department conducted inspections across all of the 602 BEd colleges in the state throughout July and August. He informed that the evaluation of institutions’ infrastructure and teaching standards were on a 100-mark matrix, and an average score of 51.5 per cent was achieved. **ENS**

DAY AFTER REPORT THAT HE'S NOT IN PUNJAB DRAFT ROLL

Raghav Chadha has no moral right to be in Parliament, says AAP Delhi chief Bharadwaj

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

THE AAM Aadmi Party and its former Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha, who has since joined the BJP, faced off over the deletion of his name from the electoral roll in Punjab following the Election Commission of India’s Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the state’s voter list, first reported by *The Indian Express* Thursday.

Chadha accused the AAP-led Punjab government of “politics of revenge”, alleging that despite being a sitting Rajya Sabha MP from Punjab with his voter ID registered in Mohali, his name had been classified as “shifted” in the draft electoral rolls.

AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj hit back, stating that “Chadha lives in Delhi, not Punjab”, questioning why he should have a vote at the latter and invoking SIR rules, under which a voter’s name can be deleted if they are not found residing at their registered address. He added that the same rules were used in Delhi to mark lakhs of voters as “shifted” and delete their votes merely for changing houses.

Chadha, in a post on X, reiterated what he had told *The Indian Express*: “Names are corrected during the ‘Claims and Objections’ process, which is ongoing. The Final Electoral Rolls will be published in October 2026. I am already in the process of availing the remedies provided under SIR guidelines. This does not seem like a mere clerical mistake. This is a clear case of political vendetta.”



Saurabh Bharadwaj and (right) Raghav Chadha



“If Raghav Chadha does not live in Punjab, his vote should be deleted from there. The man who used to speak about the Right to Reject, should now apply that rule to himself.”

SAURABH BHARADWAJ,
DELHI PRESIDENT, AAP

Addressing a press conference, AAP’s Bharadwaj said, “If Raghav Chadha does not live in Punjab, his vote should be deleted from there. The man who used to speak about the Right to Reject (people should have the right to recall an elected representative), should now apply that rule to himself.”

He added, “He no longer has any moral right to enter that temple of Parliament or spend even a single day in the government accommodation allotted to him as a Rajya Sabha member, because he used to make reels from Parliament ad-

vocating the Right to Reject. The media should ask him: Under what moral authority is he occupying that seat?”

Bharadwaj also claimed that *The Indian Express* had “information” that Chadha was trying to get his voter registration made in Delhi through the EC via a “backdated process.” He said that when *The Indian Express* sought an official response from the EC, this process was stopped. He claimed that this was not published in the newspaper.

The Indian Express replies: Bharadwaj’s claim that the newspaper sought the EC’s response on the “backdated” process is incorrect. Incidentally, on Wednesday, when *The Indian Express* asked AAP for its comment on Chadha’s allegation, the party sent a statement which claimed: “The AAP has received information from Election Commission sources that Raghav Chadha is trying to get his voter registration made in Rajinder Nagar, Delhi, through a backdated process.”

The Indian Express sent an email to the Election Commission on Thursday on AAP’s claim. There was no response.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE	
	HEAD CONSTABLE BHOPAL SINGH 172 BN BSF 24.06.1953 – 04.09.1999
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Bhopal Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries while fighting militants in Handwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.	
	CONSTABLE SUKHPAL SINGH 53 BN BSF 01.06.1969 – 04.09.1992
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Sukhpal Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting with militants in area of Doru, Anantnag (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.	

‘Floor-collected noodles turned into bhujia’: FSSAI raids Ajmer firm

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, September 3

BROKEN NOODLES collected from floor and reprocessed into bhujia, sale of unlicensed products, and other deficiencies in hygiene – officials of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) found all this and more as it conducted an inspection at the manufacturing

unit of a namkeen brand in Ajmer.

The food regulator has initiated enforcement action against CG Foods India Private Limited after FSSAI officials visited its manufacturing unit in Roopangarh area of Ajmer.

The officials found alleged food safety, hygiene and regulatory violations and the company has been directed to stop

production of Veg Bhujia namkeen products without required approvals.

According to details released by the FSSAI on Wednesday, officials inspected the facility to verify manufacturing and hygiene practices and found broken noodles collected from the floor being reprocessed into *bhujia* products without heat treatment.

Surat man gets 4.5-yr jail in US for smuggling fentanyl ingredients

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 3

A BUSINESSMAN from Gujarat has been sentenced to over four years in prison in the US for using his Surat-based company to smuggle chemicals used to manufacture fentanyl, a synthetic opioid illegally used in recreational drugs.

US District Judge Pamela K Chen sentenced Bhavesh Lathiya, 37, to 54 months in prison. Lathiya, who founded and led Surat-based Raxuter Chemicals, pleaded guilty in April to smuggling and distributing precursor chemicals, knowing they would be used to manufacture fentanyl.

He was also ordered to pay forfeiture of \$24,560 and will be deported once his prison term ends.

According to court filings cited by US Attorney Joseph Nocella, Jr.’s Office for the Eastern District of New York, Raxuter Chemicals sold and smuggled more than 50 pounds of chemicals commonly used in fentanyl manufacture, supplying buyers in the United States and Mexico.

“...when hundreds of Americans were dying every day of fentanyl overdoses, Lathiya smuggled and distributed... without any regard for the harm that his conduct would cause,” stated Attorney Nocella.

He said the sentence sent a message that the office would “hold precursor traffickers like the defendant accountable for their role in the fentanyl supply chain”.



Road Construction Department

Office of the Executive Engineer
Road Division, Dhaka,
Road Construction Department Bihar, Patna
e-mail : rcdhdhaka1@gmail.com
MBD BASED DETAILED NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER
(Through e-procurement mode only) https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in

RE-TENDER NIT No. - 05/2026-27

1.	Designation and Address of the Advertiser	: The Executive Engineer, Road Division, Dhaka, Road Construction Department, Bihar
2.	Date of Issue of Notice Inviting Tender	: Date: 28/08/2026.
3.	Period For Download of Tender Document	: From 11/09/2026 to 18/09/2026 up-to 15:00 hrs. (From Website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) only
4.	Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting	: Date: 14/09/2026, at 10.00AM
5.	Last Date & Time for Uploading Tender Document by Bidder	: 18.09.2026 Upto 15:00 hrs. on Website: (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Only.
6.	Date, Time & Place of Opening of Technical Bid (By the office of the Executive Engineer, Road Division, Sitamarhi, RCD, Bihar)	: Date- 18.09.2026 at 15:30 hrs. On Website: https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7.	Date, Time & Place of opening of Financial Bid	: To be announced by the Office of the Executive Engineer, Road Division, Dhaka, RCD, East Champaran, Bihar after approval of Technical Bid by Competent Authority. (On Website https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in

8. The Executive Engineer, Road Division, Dhaka under District East Champaran Road Construction Department, Bihar on behalf of Governor of Bihar invites bids for the works detailed below:

Project Scope & Duration:
To undertake Ordinary Maintenance Works, Initial Rectification Works, Periodic Maintenance Works including re-application of Road Marking, Minor Improvement Works including Strengthening Works and Emergency & Contingent Works on Roads under the Package/s, for total length of as described in SL.No. 9 below.
The Maintenance Works shall also include the Cross Drainage Works, Minor Works on Culverts and Road side Maintenance within the selected road limits.
Ordinary Maintenance Works and Services shall be carried out under Output & Performance-Based Road Assets Maintenance Works on a lump sum basis and shall be paid monthly.
Initial Rectification Works and Periodic Maintenance Works including re-application of Road Marking shall be paid on measured quantity to the value of the lump sum in Km.
Minor Improvement Works including Strengthening Works, Emergency and Contingent Works shall be paid on the basis of actual executed quantities of the items.
This Contract requires the specialized maintenance equipment and the contract obligations is for a period of 7 years (84 months).

9. Details of works:

Sl. No.	RCD, Road Division, Dhaka	Particulars	Quantity	Rate	Amount	Remarks
028		Stalpur-Pipra Khem Road	2.53			
		Chakia-Madhurapur Road	12.95			
		Chakia-Ahiraulya Road	1.70			
		Mehsi Link Road	3.35			
		Pipra Link Road	3.15			
		Mahuawa Link Road	1.60			
		Chakia-Madhuban Road	10.10			
		Pakridyal-Link Road	2.60			
		Madhuban-Minapur Road	23.65			
		Sirauna-Patahi road	8.50			
		Fazilpur-Mohapur road	3.50			
		Madhuban Oak Bangla chowk to Meia Bazar	1.80			
		Madhuchakra Link Road	1.20			
		Barkagan Thikha road	4.01			
		Tetariya Narha Narwara road	12.00			
		Krishnagar NH 104 to Fenhara	11.10			
		SH-74 Joghraha to Khajuria (CH-84.3 to CH-103.6 km, excluding 3.166 Km of NH-227A)	16.134			
		SH-74 Khajuria to Pashupatinath Chowk (CH-103.6 to CH-123.6 km)	20.00			
		Nawada Dhala More to Nothside Dohri Dhala to Sangrampur via Mathnamore Road	5.86			
		Kotwa to Sahaganj Via Rajpur Chowk	26.825			

Office of the Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division, Dhaka

10000.00 As per eproc2.0 11513.17211 125.33

Period of Contract: 84 Months

Date, Time & Place of Opening of Financial Bid: to be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation on Website: <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

Corrigendum/Addendum, if any will be published on the <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

**Executive Engineer
Road Division, Dhaka
Road Construction Department
Bihar, Patna**

PR- 010956 (RCD) 2026-27

सिस्टम सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-7
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(प्र 30 सरकार का उपक्रम)
ए-212, ब्लाक-ए, देवदयासपुरी, मेरठ-250005
Tale 0121-4385869
E-mail ID: cds.unit7@gmail.com

निविदा सूचना सं.: 3414/E-Tender/222
दिनांक : 03.09.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से आयोजित/आयोजित द्वारा Development work of Amrit Sarovar pond at Dundaheara, District-Ghaziabad, (U.P.) के निर्माण अनुमानित लागत ₹ 261.51 लाख (जी.एस.टी. रॉल एवम् लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी.एण्ड डी.एस. में योजित श्रेणी में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत टेकदारों से दिनांक 18.09.2026 के अपराह्न 15.00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 04.09.2026 से दिनांक 18.09.2026 के अपराह्न 15.00 बजे तक ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य ₹ 10000.00+GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोजेक्ट/रैप्रेजेंट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक् से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

**कार्यालय कुलसचिव
नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, जबरपुर, (म.प्र.)**
ई-निविदा सूचना

ई-निविदा सूचना क्र. 3312/Reg./Tender/ET-02/2026-27, दिनांक 02.09.2026
नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, जबरपुर, (म.प्र.) द्वारा निम्न दर्शाये कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत पत्रों / संस्थाओं से खुली निविदा ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत निविदा ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखी जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरान्त निविदा में कोई संशोधन या परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र अपरोक्त उल्लिखित ई-निविदा पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नानुसार है :-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम
1	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय अंग्रेज किराये पर खल्याहार गृह (केन्टीन) संचालन एवं खल्याहार तथा भोजन, पानी की व्यवस्था हेतु दर निर्धारण।
2	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, अधिनस्त जबरपुर स्थित समस्त महाविद्यालयों / इकाईयों में व्यवसायिक सेवा प्रदाता (सुरक्षा) कार्य हेतु दर निर्धारण।

निविदा अनिवार्य भर्ते की प्रारंभिक तिथि 05.09.2026 से एवं अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 25.09.2026

कुलसचिव

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No.	17 (A,B,C)/26-27WE
Name of work with its location	
(A)	Provision of stainless-steel water storage overhead tank and painting of roof with solar reflective paint at P.K. Road Railway colony in the section of SSE/WPG under ADENE/E-I
(B)	Repair to damaged RCC underground & overhead tanks and repair to water supply pipe lines at P. K. Road and Basant lane railway colony in the section of SSE/WPG under ADENE/E-I
(C)	Improvement of Toilet, Bath, Kitchen and flooring in type-I, II, III & IV qtrs. & replacement of damage SCI vertical stack to PVC stack in Sadar Bazar, Motia Bagh, Hospital, More Sarai Railway Colony in the section of SSE/W.T. Hazari under ADENE/E-I
Approx. cost of work	(A) 14999880.71 (B) 9999705.56 (C) 14999976.38
EMD amount	(A) 300000.00 (B) 200000.00 (C) 300000.00
Completion	(A) 08 Months (B) 08 Months (C) 06 Months
period of work	
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Closing date of tender on 05.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
128-W/269/OET/24-25/WE/NIT/17 (A,B,C)/26-27(WE) Dated:-03.09.2026	3046/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE	



Noida Power Company Limited

Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

TENDER NOTICE

Date: 04-09-2026

e-Tender (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following, from all interested bidders

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NIT No. NPCL/FY26-27/STP Pole / 030	ANNUAL YEAR RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF STP POLE (12M & 13M)	2.50 Lac	04.09.2026 & 25.09.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website www.noidapower.com→Procurement→Tenders

HEAD (CMM)

झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई-निविदा सं० :- RDD/SD/HZB/24/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:

युप सं०	आईडेंटिफिकेशन संस्था / पैकेज संस्था	प्रयण्ड	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विचर का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	RDD/SD/HZB/ 24/01/2026-27	चलकुशा	हजारीबाग जिला के चलकुशा प्रखण्ड अंतर्गत बांका से गडनी पथ के बीच बरकर नदी पर पुल निर्माण	100733200.00	2015000.00	10000.00	24 माह
2.	RDD/SD/HZB/ 24/02/2026-27	विष्णुगढ़	हजारीबाग जिलान्तर्गत विष्णुगढ़ प्रखण्ड के पचायत खरना के गडुवारा के बुंदरमाड में पुल निर्माण।	37763200.00	755500.00	10000.00	18 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 12.09.2026
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 12.09.2026 से दिनांक 03.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग
5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 05.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे
6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दृष्टांत सं० – 9934523795
8. परिमाण विचर की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग

PR 389001 (Rural Development) 26-27 (D)

SC upholds NCTE notice for appraisal reports from teachers education institutes

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 3

UNDERLINING THAT the development of a child “is integrally connected to the role of an elementary school teacher”, the Supreme Court on Thursday upheld a Public Notice issued by the Member Secretary of the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE) Executive Committee, requiring Teacher Education Institutions (TEI) to file an annual Performance Appraisal Report. We are of the opinion that even without a specific empowerment under the statute, such a regulatory measure can always be incidental and ancillary to the duties and functions of a regulator. As there is a performance audit of NCTE itself by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG), it is but natural and incidental that NCTE would require the stakeholders, over which it exercises the regulatory jurisdiction, to provide the necessary Performance Appraisal Report,” the court said. It added that “it is necessary for the Council and its bodies to ensure accountability of educational institutions”.

Setting aside the HC Order, the SC said Section 23 of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 (RTE Act), recognises the importance of qualified teachers for effective exercise of the right to education of children and, therefore, provides for an ‘academic authority’ to lay down the minimum qualifications..The ‘academic authority’, contemplated under Section 23, is the...Council, established under the National Council for Teacher Education Act, 1993...

The notice was challenged on the ground that the Council alone could have issued and implemented the notice and not the Executive Committee.

The SC, however, said it is “not in agreement with the approach adopted by the High Court”.

“We are of the opinion that there is ample empowerment of the Council as well as the Executive Committee to call for

annual Performance Appraisal Report from institutions imparting teacher education,” the court said.

“We fail to understand as to how a regulatory measure of a statutory body, empowered to achieve planned and coordinated development of teacher education system in the country could be restrained from calling upon the TEIs to file Performance Appraisal Report. We are of the opinion that even without a specific empowerment under the statute, such a regulatory measure can always be incidental and ancillary to the duties and functions of a regulator. As there is a performance audit of NCTE itself by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG), it is but natural and incidental that NCTE would require the stakeholders, over which it exercises the regulatory jurisdiction, to provide the necessary Performance Appraisal Report,” the court said. It added that “it is necessary for the Council and its bodies to ensure accountability of educational institutions”.

Setting aside the HC Order, the SC said Section 23 of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 (RTE Act), recognises the importance of qualified teachers for effective exercise of the right to education of children and, therefore, provides for an ‘academic authority’ to lay down the minimum qualifications..The ‘academic authority’, contemplated under Section 23, is the...Council, established under the National Council for Teacher Education Act, 1993...

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FULL REPORT ON
[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

WMO warns of ‘very strong El Nino, to last until February 2027

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 3

THE WORLD Meteorological Organization (WMO) on Thursday warned of an impending “very strong” El Nino that could last till February of next year and could alter temperature and rainfall patterns globally.

“El Nino is firmly established and is expected to strengthen. It has the potential to deliver a massive blow to communities and economies across the world. We are already seeing disruption and devastation from droughts and floods and we expect these impacts to increase as El Nino intensifies,” said WMO Secretary-General Celeste Saulo at a press briefing on Thursday.

El Nino is a natural ocean-atmosphere phenomenon that is caused when the equatorial Pacific Ocean warms significantly and interferes with

weather patterns globally. It is known to trigger extreme weather — heatwaves, wet spells and extreme temperatures. The intensity of El Nino is determined by the sea surface temperature average over three months in the Nino 3.4 region along the equatorial Pacific Ocean. In recent months, this temperature index value surpassed 1.5 degrees Celsius above normal during May-July and escalated 2 degrees Celsius mark above normal in July.

Europe, this year, witnessed one of the hottest summers in recent decades and August, according to many global weather agencies, reported record temperatures in many parts of the globe. The UN agency’s chief said: “Never before in the 50-year history of the WMO have we launched such a major mobilisation with National Meteorological and Hydrological Services

who are on the frontline of delivering forecasts and services to save lives and livelihoods.”

The India Meteorological Department (IMD), earlier this month, confirmed that the monsoon rainfall in the later half of August came under the cloud of El Nino. But, with three-fourths of the season over, the monsoon has largely escaped the developing El Nino.

WMO further said the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) — the Indian Ocean counterpart of El Nino Southern Oscillation (ENSO) — was likely to develop during September-November.

“A positive phase of the IOD is also expected to develop with a seasonal mean value of 0.9 degrees Celsius,” WMO said.

This could counter El Nino and in late August, the IOD had, briefly, swung towards the positive phase but returned to neutral, the IMD said.

Step up preparedness for glacial lake outbursts: MHA to states

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

THE MINISTRY of Home Affairs has asked Himalayan states and Union Territories to step up preparedness against glacial lake outburst floods (GLOFs) and snow avalanches, stressing the need to move from response-based planning to preventive mitigation and community-level readiness, an MHA spokesperson said.

Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan chaired a meeting here on Thursday to review the

preparedness of Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir against the risks posed by GLOFs and snow avalanches.

According to the spokesperson, the meeting reviewed the evolving risk of GLOFs in the Himalayan region and focused on strengthening early warning systems, monitoring of vulnerable glacial lakes and snow-covered areas, identification of high-risk locations, flow-path mapping, timely dissemination of alerts, evacuation pre-

paredness and strengthening response mechanisms.

The states and UTs presented their preparedness and mitigation strategies.

“State and UT-specific vulnerabilities were discussed in detail, with emphasis on ensuring that mitigation measures are translated into concrete actions at the district and local levels,” the spokesperson said.

Mohan emphasised the need for continuous and proactive monitoring of vulnerable glacial lakes and avalanche-prone areas, particularly dur-

ing periods of heightened risk.

He advised the states and UT to maintain close coordination among state agencies, district administrations and scientific and technical institutions so that warnings are acted upon promptly and effectively.

The Union Home Secretary also said preparedness for GLOFs and snow avalanches must go beyond response-oriented measures and include risk-informed planning, preventive mitigation and community-level preparedness.

States and UTs were advised to regularly review preparedness plans, identify gaps in early warning and evacuation arrangements, and take corrective measures ahead of any extreme event.

The meeting was attended by the Chief Secretaries and state disaster management authorities of the states and UTs concerned, senior officials of the MHA, officials of National Disaster Management Authority, Central Water Commission, India Meteorological Department and Defence

Geoinformatics Research Establishment, the spokesperson said.

Mohan also asked the states to expedite progress on GLOF mitigation projects sanctioned by the Central government in 2024, the spokesperson said.

The meeting concluded with directions for continued inter-agency coordination, regular sharing of risk information and strengthening of early warning and response mechanisms to minimise loss of life and property in vulnerable Himalayan areas.

SC bins plea against curbs on outsiders’ entry in govt schools of UP, Rajasthan

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 3

THE SUPREME Court has dismissed a PIL challenging restrictions imposed by the Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh education departments on the entry of journalists, YouTubers, social media personalities and civil society members in government schools.

The dismissal of the public interest litigation (PIL) plea assumes significance in the wake of a recent assault on Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists in Rajasthan during their inspection of a government school as part of the ‘school thik karo’ campaign.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe dismissed the PIL filed by Priya Mishra.

“We are not inclined to entertain the writ petition filed under Article 32 of the Constitution of India,” the bench said in its September 1 order.

The PIL had also challenged curbs placed on photography, videography, interviews, audio recording and live-streaming from government schools.

It had said similar orders have been issued in other districts of Uttar Pradesh as well.

This comes after Rajasthan announced renovations for a school that CJP visited

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, September 3

WITH THE Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) stepping up pressure on the Rajasthan government over the poor condition of schools in the state, the RSS-affiliated Akhil Bhartiya Rashtriya Shaikshik Mahasangh (ABRSM) has hit back at the outfit and opposed its actions while mobilising lakhs of its members across the state to improve the education system.

In its latest newsletter for September, ABRSM has said that government schools should be “free from political activities and outside interference”, adding that “the temples of education will not be allowed to become a political arena at any cost. The Mahasangh strongly opposes outside interference in schools and the use of teachers for political activities.”

This comes after a row and a confrontation over the CJP’s protest at a Rajasthan government school on August 21 in Rampura village of Jaipur’s Bagru Assembly constituency.

Days after the protest, the Rajasthan government announced renovations at the school — a development that the CJP took as a sign of victory.

ABRSM boasts of a membership of 2.80 lakh government school teachers in Rajasthan — 13.60 lakh across the country — with about 45,000 ABRSM workers/post holders in the state.

Countering CJP drive

Referring to the attack on a CJP delegation that was on its way to visit a school on the outskirts of Jaipur, Mahasangh’s state organisation minister, Umrao Lal Verma, backed the villagers who opposed the visit.

He said that if any individual or organisation has any objection to the arrangements, facilities or educational status of a government school, the prescribed channels of the education department and the administration are open to them, and that “it is not appropriate to enter a school without following the due process and creating a political controversy.”



Villagers assault a CJP member visiting a govt school as part of the outfit’s ‘school thik karo’ drive, in Bagru, Jaipur, on August 21. PTI

Talking to *The Indian Express*, ABRSM national president Narayan Lal Gupta said that ABRSM has been raising the issue of school infrastructure, teacher vacancies, etc. under successive governments for a long time. In the context of CJP’s campaign, he said that instead of merely highlighting the issues, there should be an attempt towards a solution too.

The ABRSM has been running a ‘Humara vidyalaya, humara teerth’ (Our school, our pilgrimage) campaign to develop schools in the state and beyond, he said. In Rajasthan, the campaign covers as many as 10,000

schools. Additionally, he said that ABRSM recently adopted 1,000 government schools in the state as part of the same campaign, with the aim of their overall improvement through the help of philanthropists, teachers, parents, ABRSM, as well as the government.

“If you look at the Jaipur school too (in Rampura), it was the locals who had given the land for this school,” Gupta said, adding that the issues which have been plaguing the schools for the last 60-70 years cannot be resolved in a year and that “we have been raising the issue of increasing the edu-

cation budget at the central level to 6 per cent.”

ABRSM state president Ramesh Chandra Pushkarna said that the idea behind the campaign is to have the same “facilities and peace” at school as is often seen at pilgrimage sites.

Citing the state government’s audit last year, which said that 86,934 rooms in schools were dilapidated, Pushkarna said that Rs 3,000 crore for rebuilding those rooms isn’t enough. With CJP visiting schools in the state, he urged it to raise money from its social media followers, numbering in crores, to repair these schools, “instead of merely indulging in propaganda.” As for ABRSM’s own efforts, he said members have been doing their bit to improve the condition of schools.

The ABRSM has also backed the state government over its recent directive restricting the entry of outsiders, with its division vice-president Arjun Singh saying that it “supports Education Minister Madan Dilawar to improve the education system... The guidelines have been issued to control outsiders and political interference, and are intended to provide a safe, disciplined, and educational environment in schools.”

Pune man demanding DJ ban during Ganeshotsav assaulted, attacker arrested

Express News Service
Pune, September 3

VIDYANAND BAPAT, whose campaign against noise pollution during the Ganpati festival in Pune has sparked a massive debate, was attacked in public on Thursday morning. The incident on Tilak Road was caught on camera. Bapat is seen speaking to some media persons when a man slaps him.

Pune Police Commissioner Amitesh Kumar said the attacker had been arrested and was being charged with cognisable non-bailable offences.

Bapat has been vocal in recent days about the need to curb noise pollution during festivals by banning loudspeakers and dhol tashas during public celebrations.

Kumar said, “The accused will be presented in court tomorrow (Friday) and we will ask for PCR (police custody remand).”

“The police have taken this incident extremely seriously and there will be strict action against the accused. It is an extremely condemnable incident of violence,” Kumar said. He added that Bapat was being provided round-the-clock police protection. He said that at a meeting with him, Ganesh mandals ‘unanimously’ denounced the attack.



The incident was caught on camera when Vidyand Bapat was speaking to the media.

The attack was condemned by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis. “Violence like this is not correct. Everyone has a right to state their opinion. Attacking someone while they are expressing their views is not correct...”

Condemning the attack, the Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti (MANS) said, “If anyone disagrees with Bapat’s position, they should present their views based on facts. Resorting to physical violence when you are unable to refute points is a highly dangerous trend. If a person speaking out against noise pollution is assaulted today, tomorrow any citizen might fear raising their voice against injustice, superstition, pollution, corruption, or public malpractices.”

● FOUNDATION STONE OF THE UTTAM KUMAR FILM CENTRE WILL BE LAID IN KOLKATA’S NEW TOWN AREA; MOVE SIGNALS THE SAFFRON PARTY’S CULTURAL POLITICS AFTER WINNING IN THE ASSEMBLY POLLS

Uttam Kumar, Tollywood and Suvendu’s cultural power play in West Bengal

From film screenings to walks at locations linked to the late superstar’s life, govt goes all in to celebrate his birth centenary

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 3

FORTY-SIX YEARS may have passed since his death. But, for quintessentially argumentative Bengalis, there is rare, near-unanimous consensus that Uttam Kumar is the greatest Bengali cine star in history. And now, the actor — popularly known as “Mahanayak (mega star)” — is at the centre of the BJP government’s outreach,

even as the party looks to solidify its control over the Bengali film industry, or Tollywood named after the Tollygunge neighbourhood of Kolkata.

On Thursday morning, even as Prime Minister Narendra Modi released a video statement commemorating Uttam Kumar’s birth centenary, the BJP-led state government organised a special tribute ceremony at the matinee idol’s statue near the Tolly-

gunge metro station, which was attended by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari and a host of big names from the industry. Among them were film star Prosenjit Chatterjee; veteran actor Ranjit Mallick, whose daughter Koel was appointed a Trinamool Congress (TMC) Rajya Sabha MP, but who resigned; rebel Trinamool MP and film star Deepak Adhikari, or Dev, who is now part of the Nationalist Citizens Party of



CM Suvendu Adhikari speaks during the tribute ceremony of Uttam Kumar in Kolkata on Thursday. ANI

India; director Gautam Ghosh, and BJP MLAs Rudranil Ghosh

and Papiya Adhikari, and actor Rituparna Sengupta.

At the event, the CM touched Ranjit’s feet and took him to the stage. This, in a nutshell, illustrated the wave of change that has swept through Tollywood since the BJP’s win in the Assembly elections. The change has been more pronounced since the arrest of TMC leader Swarup Biswas, who called the shots in Tollywood for the past decade.

Adhikari also led a one-and-a-half-km tribute walk from the state-run cultural complex Nandan to the Gaganendra Shilpa Pradarshashala, flanked by actor and BJP leader Mithun Chakraborty, veteran actor Bis-

wajit Chatterjee who was Uttam Kumar’s contemporary and is the father of Prosenjit, actor Jeet, veteran filmmaker Haranath Chakraborty, and Minister of State Purnima Chakraborty.

“We don’t have any differences. There is no narrow-mindedness. This film industry is vibrant and stands together. If required, we will pass legislation in the Assembly to help the film industry in every way,” Adhikari said at the Gaganendra Shilpa Pradarshashala, where an exhibition on the cine star began, showcasing behind-the-scenes stills, advertisements, and magazines featuring him.

The CM also announced that a state-of-the-art theatre complex bigger than the present Rabindra Sadan would be built to honour Kumar, and till September 6, film screenings, exhibitions, and guided heritage walks through locations tied to the actor’s life would be held, he added. On Friday, the foundation stone of the Uttam Kumar Film Centre will be laid in Kolkata’s New Town.

This massive outreach not only sends a signal to Tollywood but also to the public at large that Bengali cultural politics is important for the ruling party.

Veterinarian job scam: Jailed Karnataka IAS officer suspended

Kiran Parashar
Bengaluru, September 3

THE KARNATAKA government on Thursday suspended IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar who was arrested by the CID in connection with alleged fraud in the selection of veterinarians for 400 vacancies in the state's Animal Husbandry and Fisheries department.

Gangwar, hailing from UP and a Karnataka-cadre IAS officer of 2016 batch, was posted as a director for the Department of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises in the state Commerce and Industries ministry. He was serving as Controller of Examinations at KPSC when the alleged fraud took place.

In a report to the government, the CID's Director General of Police stated that the officer was produced before the magistrate and remanded to judicial custody on August 30, and was subsequently taken into police custody for further probe.

POLICE SAY NO POLITICAL LINK FOUND SO FAR

Six arrested after Abhishek's office 'vandalised' in Kolkata

Express News Service
Kolkata, September 3

KOLKATA POLICE has arrested six men from Howrah in connection with the vandalising of TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee's Camac Street office in Kolkata in the early hours of Thursday.

While the TMC leader alleged that the vandals belonged to the ruling BJP, police said that so far they have not found any political affiliation of the six arrested men, identified as Shankar Rao, Avinash Shaw, Sukhdev Gupta, Suraj Shaw, Amol Mondal and Rohit Borik.

"We have tracked the social media profile of the prime accused, Avinash Shaw. No political background of the accused has come to light. After taking them into custody, an identification process will be conducted to see if they were involved in any previous crimes. Some of the looted



A CCTV grab posted by Abhishek Banerjee showing men in masks 'vandalising' his Camac Street office in Kolkata, Thursday.

items were recovered from their possession," said Additional Commissioner of Police (Crime) Kunal Agarwal.

According to TMC general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, at around 4.30 am, men armed with weapons stormed his party office in the heart of Kolkata.

Sharing the purported CCTV footage of the incident on X in which men in helmets and masks were seen carrying TV screens and other appliances out of the office, Abhishek wrote, "BJP hooligans... They attacked our people, snatched their phones, smashed furniture, ran-

sacked the premises and destroyed electronic equipment."

The Diamond Harbour MP also accused the police of not responding to the calls at the time of the attack. "And where was Kolkata Police? For nearly two hours, despite repeated calls and emails from our people and lawyers, there was no response. This is outrageous and unacceptable," Abhishek said, demanding the immediate arrest of "every person involved in this attack".

Kolkata Police, meanwhile, rejected the TMC leader's charge, saying a police team reached the spot immediately after receiving the call. "This morning, at the local police station... just before 6 am, information was received... that some people entered a premise and were vandalising it. Immediately around 6:00 am... a local police team reached the spot

and six people were arrested from the spot," said Kolkata ACP Agarwal.

The BJP, meanwhile, trashed the allegations and claimed that the TMC staged the vandalism at Abhishek's office. "This is all staged by the Trinamool Congress. The BJP is not involved in all this. They have no (political) issue; that's why they are doing all this to stay in the limelight," said BJP MLA from Baranagar, Sajal Ghosh. "What were Trinamool workers doing at that office at those hours?" he asked.

The Camac Street office has been in the spotlight after a recent visit by officials of Kolkata civic body to remove "illegal hoardings". Kolkata Police have filed an FIR against Abhishek Banerjee, TMC's Rajya Sabha member Derek O'Brien, and others for resisting municipal officials and police from removing an illegal hoarding at the office.

'Dimaagi naxal mindset': BJP hits back at Cong over latest GDP figures

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 3

THE BJP on Thursday accused the Congress of using faulty calculations to convert India's 7.8 per cent real GDP growth into an "imaginary" 2.6 per cent, calling it a "dimaagi Naxal mindset" of looking at the country's economic progress.

This came after the Congress questioned the government on the latest GDP figures and asked why there was a substantial downward revision in GDP estimates for the last four years, and sought a detailed account of how this revision was done.

According to former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg's calculation, if the base year had not been revised down the way it was, nominal growth this quarter would be closer to 2.6 per cent, not the 10.3 per cent the government is claiming, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said in a three-page statement.

"And once you take inflation out of that, real growth is basically zero, nowhere near 7.8 per cent," the Congress leader said, asking what methodology was adopted by the government to do the revision.

Hitting back, BJP chief spokesperson Anil Baluni said, "Jairam Ramesh's entire three-page statement rests on comparing two numbers that cannot be compared. Everything built upon that error collapses with it." The Congress ecosystem has developed a "remarkably predictable" response to India's economic progress.

"If India grows slowly, it declares the government a failure. If India grows rapidly, it declares the data fraudulent. If economic indicators improve, it searches for one weak number. If the arithmetic refuses to support its politics, it simply changes the arith-

metic," Baluni said.

"That is the 'dimaagi Naxal' mindset -- an inability to accept Indian achievement, accompanied by a constant urge to diminish it, discredit it and damage the confidence of Indians themselves," he said.

The latest example is the attempt to convert India's 7.8 per cent real GDP growth in Q1 FY2026-27 into an imaginary 2.6 per cent, and then into "basically zero", the BJP leader said.

"The trick is -- take last year's GDP from the old, discontinued 2011-12 base series. Compare it with this year's GDP from the new 2022-23 base series. Divide one by the other. Call the resulting number India's 'real growth'. Then subtract household inflation from it," he added.

Without naming, the BJP leader also slammed Garg, saying a former finance secretary, who worked at the apex of a system built around national accounts, should know "the first rule of economic comparison -- use the same series on both sides". Citing data, Baluni said rebasing did not begin with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's tenure.

"This is not the first time India has revised its GDP base year. It is the ninth such revision since Independence. Between 1956 and 1999 alone, five revisions were carried out. Five of the total nine revisions took place when the Congress was in power at the Centre," he said.

Baluni said that if today's opposition is suggesting that base revision is statistical manipulation, then a legitimate question arises as to whether all those earlier revisions conducted by the Congress governments were an attempt to conceal the so-called "Hindu rate of growth" that persisted for decades under their rule.

Contempt of court case: SC suspends 6-month sentence on YouTuber

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 3

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday suspended a Delhi HC sentence on YouTuber Gulshan Pahuja, convicted for criminal contempt after he "scandalised... and lowered the authority of the Court" through some of his videos.

Issuing a notice on Pahuja's plea challenging the May 16, 2026, HC order convicting and sentencing him to six months' simple imprisonment, a bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Sheel Nagu also directed that he be released from custody.

The case dates back to 2025, when the HC had taken cognisance of a reference made by a civil judge at Shahdara court, Charu Asiwal, regarding contentious videos and banners on Pahuja's YouTube channel. Pahuja's videos allegedly showed lawyers making "some objectionable and derogatory remarks against judicial officers and the judicial institution as a whole".

The HC had also initiated contempt proceedings against the lawyers, but dropped it after they tendered unconditional apologies. The HC imposed a fine of Rs 2,000 under the Contempt of Courts Act.

Fighter pilot Abhinandan, taken POW after he downed Pak jet, joins pvt airline

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 3

THE NEXT time you are on a commercial flight, you would do better to listen to the announcement that introduces the pilots. Who knows, in the cockpit may be a former fighter pilot who made headlines during the Balakot airstrikes, as much for his flying prowess as for his moustache and his love for tea.

Group Captain Abhinandan Varthaman, a Vir Chakra awardee, has retired from the Indian Air Force and joined Goa-based regional airline FLY91 as a pilot. He is 43.

A Group Captain can serve in the IAF until age 54. No pub-



Group Captain Abhinandan Varthaman

lic statement details the reasons for his premature retirement.

The decorated officer, who prefers to maintain a low profile, shot down an enemy jet

during aerial combat with Pakistan in February 2019. The combat occurred on February 27, 2019, following the Balakot airstrikes India carried out to target terror camps in Pakistan in retaliation for the Pulwama attack.

During the encounter, Varthaman shot down a Pakistani F-16 fighter jet before his own MiG-21 Bison was hit by enemy fire. At the time, he held the rank of Wing Commander.

Following his ejection, Varthaman landed in Pakistani territory and was captured before Indian authorities secured his release in a globally watched diplomatic move. He was honoured with the Vir Chakra award in 2021. Varthaman is

learned to have joined the airline as a commercial pilot last month and was relieved by the IAF a few months ago.

As a fighter pilot in the IAF, Group Captain Varthaman flew the Su-30 MKI and later the MiG-21. He will now fly ATR aircraft for FLY91.

It is not uncommon for IAF pilots to retire relatively young and move into commercial aviation, given the substantial experience of fighter, helicopter and transport pilots in handling aircraft, navigation, emergencies, crew coordination and disciplined operating procedures.

Commercial airlines are also said to value military experience.

Surrounded by energy crises, Bihar eyes Rs 1.38 lakh cr solar investment

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 3

AMID MASSIVE power purchase costs, minimal revenue and energy demand peaking nearly 17 times the generation capacity in summers — Bihar is betting on solar energy to meet its electricity needs with a target of 24 GW of renewable energy capacity and 6 GWh of energy storage systems by 2030.

This clean energy push stems from the stark financial reality of the state's energy sector. The state collected over Rs 19,000 crore from electricity users in 2025-26, but spent between Rs 25,000 crore and Rs 35,000 crore annually to buy power from outside sources. It is also burdened with Rs 3,800 crore from offering 125 units of

free power to 1.89 crore of its 2.2 crore consumers.

The state faces an average daily demand of 7,300 to 7,400 MW, peaking at 9,500 MW in the summer, against its own generation capacity of just 550 MW. With electricity demand projected to cross 11,700 MW by 2030, the government has unveiled a Rs 1.38 lakh crore investment plan over the next five years, heavily focused on renewable energy.

Energy department officials, however, insist the move is guided by the power sector's recent financial turnaround rather than just fiscal pressure. "The focus on clean power comes amid a sharp financial turnaround across the state's energy utilities," a senior energy official told *The Indian Express*.

Under its Renewable Energy Policy 2025, Bihar aims to harness nearly 24 GW of renewable energy and build 6 GWh of energy storage systems by 2030, driven predominantly by solar power.

"To keep pace with peak electricity demand, which is projected to grow to 11,747 MW by 2030, the Bihar State Power Holding Company Limited will invest Rs 82,679 crore directly to generating assets, including pumped storage power projects, nuclear feasibility studies in Banka and Siwan, and solar installations. Transmission infrastructure will receive Rs 24,683 crore to build a 680-circuit-kilometer Green Energy Corridor, with the remaining funds earmarked for distribution, digital upgrades, and maintenance," the official said.

A centerpiece of the state's green agenda — Rs 2,866 crore Kajra Solar Power Plant in Laksharai, pairs a 301 MW solar facility with a 523 MWh Battery Energy Storage System (BESS). Beyond utility-scale plants, the state is also expanding decentralized solar infrastructure. Groundwork has begun on the 150 MW Aurangabad Solar Park. Rooftop solar is also scaling up under the Centre's Surya Sankalp scheme, which has installed 115 MW across 12,000 government buildings, with another 500 MW recently approved.

Rural and residential programs add to this through 457 MW in PM-KUSUM feeder solarization projects and rooftop installations targeting 10 lakh consumers under PM Surya Ghar.

Gang smuggling out Ganja in the name of Sambalpuri saree busted

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 3

IT LOOKED like a legitimate business when a group of individuals, earlier this year, registered with a leading e-commerce platform to sell their products. The hero product was the iconic Sambalpuri saree known for its double Ikat tie and dye technique and symbolic motifs.

Orders came in from different parts of the country, parcels went out and nothing seemed unusual for months until recently when the Balangir police in Odisha received a tip-off on what was being supplied in the name of the handloom saree.

On Wednesday, police arrested seven men and seized 113 kg of ganja hidden in the saree boxes as they were on

their way to the nearest logistics centre. Police said two of the arrested persons were masterminds of the operation that had tapped into a loophole in the e-commerce business: The consignments not being scanned for their contents before being shipped out for delivery.

The accused, most of them in their 30s, procured cannabis from interior areas of the bordering Kandhamal district, neatly packed it, generated QR code with the help of the e-commerce platform, and delivered it at the nearest logistic centre in Balangir after receiving money from the buyers, said Balangir Superintendent of Police Abilash G.

"The accused used this new modus operandi as the delivery partner had no way of knowing what was actually inside the

sealed parcel. The present lot, which we have seized, was being sent to Ghaziabad in Uttar Pradesh. They disguised Ganja consignments as saree orders, allowing the contraband to move through the e-commerce platform without raising suspicion," said the Balangir SP.

They were using the legal platform to transport illegal product, he added.

Police sources said at least 10 boxes were seized, each containing 10 smaller boxes, in which the contraband was allegedly concealed.

Investigation, including scanning of CCTV footage, revealed that the gang had used similar modus operandi four to five times earlier to transport cannabis to different parts of the country.

The investigation revealed

that the logistic centre had no details about the sellers except their CCTV footage as they scanned the QR code and sent out the consignment. "Once the consignment reaches the last location, the delivery agent only scans the QR code for the address and delivers it like a normal parcel. The law enforcement agency had no scope of knowing about the illegal operation," said an official.

According to the Balangir SP, the accused learned the modus operandi from the buyers, who came to the district to train the accused on the techniques for transportation of the contraband.

When asked whether the police would issue notice to the e-commerce platform, the Balangir SP said they are exploring legal aspects of the case.

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

Police camera 'caught' murder, rape accused at Jantar Mantar protest

Rohini when the FRS flagged them at Jantar Mantar, records show.

These 25 individuals included three identified by the FRS on July 24, 21 on July 25, and one on July 26, the last day of the protest at Jantar Mantar.

Responding on Monday to a questionnaire from *The Indian Express*, the Delhi Police said: "During the protests, 2873 individuals identified as prima facie having criminal antecedents were spotted. However, further verification in this regard is pending."

According to the police affidavit submitted on August 17, its FRS identified individuals with criminal records at the protest site whose "particulars matched with existing records available in official police databases". It said that 2,402 people were identified by the Delhi Police's biometric database, Crime Kundli, and 471 through criminal records.

Murder

Of the 205 verified by *The Indian Express*, the 17 shown in jail on charges of murder during the protest are:

1. Kishan (26), identified by FRS around 6.36 pm, July 24: Arrested from North-East Delhi's Karawal Nagar, also faces cases of armed robbery. He was first sent to jail on July 9, 2022, and jailed again on October 17, 2023.
2. Mustaq (29), identified around 6.31 pm, July 24: Arrested from North-East Delhi's Gokul Puri, also faces cases of snatching and attempt to murder. First jailed on January 1, 2024; again on June 23, 2026.
3. Ankit Kumar (22), identified around 5.58 pm, July 24: Arrested from North Delhi's Wazirabad. First jailed on November 11, 2022; again on June 24 this year.
4. Yogesh (27), identified around 4.24 pm, July 25: Arrested from South Delhi. First jailed on November 17, 2024; again on November 29, 2024.
5. Pratap Singh Sisodia (31), identified around 3.35 pm, July 25: Arrested along with an associate from East Delhi's Gandhi Nagar area. First jailed on November 28, 2014; jailed multiple times later, shifted from Mandoli to Tihar on August 5, 2026.

6. Arjun (28), identified around 1.48 pm, July 25: Arrested from West Delhi's Punjabi Bagh area. First jailed on March 10, 2021; again on March 9, 2023.
7. Sonu Kumar (34), identified around 8.39 pm, July 25: Arrested from South-East Delhi's Okhla Industrial area. First jailed on January 30, 2020; again on October 27, 2025.
8. Vijay (26), identified around 11.40 pm, July 25: Arrested from North-West Delhi's Shalimar Bagh area. First jailed on August 29, 2024; again on January 19, 2026.
9. Rakesh (42), identified around 1.30 pm, July 25: Arrested from North-West Delhi, also faces cases of robbery, snatching, theft and offences under the Excise Act. First jailed on December 7, 2008; again on February 18, 2024.
10. Bhola alias Shyam Kumar (32), identified around 4.58 pm, July 25: Arrested from North-West Delhi, also faces cases of snatching and burglary. First jailed on April 26, 2015; again on March 29, 2025.
11. Raja (27), identified

- around 2.22 pm, July 25: Arrested from North Delhi's Sabzi Mandi. First jailed on September 1, 2020; again on July 1, 2024.
12. Vicky alias Manoj Thakur (34), identified around 11.12 pm, July 25: Arrested from North Delhi's Kotwali area. First jailed on January 2, 2015; again on May 7, 2016.
13. Mohd Faraz (23), identified around 2.59 pm, July 25: Arrested from South Delhi's Wazirabad, faces a separate robbery case. First jailed on January 20, 2022; again on October 9, 2024.
14. Manish (28), identified around 4.25 pm, July 25: Arrested from Central Delhi's Ranjit Nagar area. First jailed on April 24, 2023; again on October 23, 2024.
15. Dharmender Yadav (37), identified around 1.20 pm, July 25: Arrested in a murder case from Delhi's Dwarka area, also faces cases of theft and attempt to murder. First jailed on July 22, 2016; again on May 14, 2026.
16. Sonu (29), identified around 3.44 pm, July 25: Arrested from G T B Enclave in Shahdara district, also faces

- cases of robbery. First jailed on February 11, 2018; again on April 26, 2022.
17. Royal Massy (25), identified around 5.45 pm, July 26: Arrested from South Delhi's Tigri area. First jailed on August 20, 2021; again on April 4, 2023.
- At least one of these cases is linked to a high-profile killing in the capital. Yogesh alias Raju was arrested for his alleged role in the murder of gym owner Nadir Shah in South Delhi's upscale Greater Kailash-1. According to records, he was a sharpshooter for the syndicates of gangsters Lawrence Bishnoi and Hashim Baba, and was arrested after an exchange of fire during which he sustained a bullet injury to his left leg.
- Rape**
- The four rape accused, including three held under POCSO Act, are:
 1. Ankit alias Mogli (34), identified around 3.28 pm, July 25: Arrested in 2022 from West Delhi's Tilak Nagar area. First jailed on February 15, 2022; again in Tihar on July 16, 2024.

2. Sunil Kumar (26), identified around 4.04 pm, July 25: Arrested from South Delhi under POCSO Act. First jailed on October 15, 2021; again on August 30, 2025.
3. Heera Singh, identified around 3.31 pm, July 25: Arrested from North-East Delhi under POCSO Act. He has been in jail since July 11, 2023.
4. Kundan, identified around 11.48 pm, July 25: Arrested from North-East Delhi under POCSO Act. First jailed on March 30, 2024; again on May 29, 2024.
- Attempt to murder**
- The four linked to attempt to murder cases are:
 1. Mahesh (33), identified around 3.34 pm, July 25: Arrested from North Delhi's Kotwali. First jailed on May 23, 2022; again on April 29, 2024.
 2. Bobby (24), identified around 4.23 pm, July 25: Arrested from South Delhi's Sangam Vihar area, also faces case of robbery. First jailed on May 3, 2021; again on February 21, 2024.
 3. Jishan Ahmad Idrishi (25), identified around 4.55 pm,

- July 25: Arrested from South-West Delhi's Sagarpur area, also faces case of snatching. First jailed on February 17, 2020; again on March 19, 2026.
4. Annu Gilodia alias Pahalwal (27), identified around 3.13 pm, July 25: Arrested from South-West Delhi's Kishan Garh. First jailed on October 23, 2021; again on March 25, 2022.
- 'No action solely on FRS'**
- The Delhi Police's facial recognition software places boxes around detected faces and compares them with images in police databases. In response to a Right to Information (RTI) request in 2022, the police had revealed that it considered a match to be "positive" if its system showed an accuracy rate of 80 per cent. The result is not, by itself, proof of identity. Performance varies with the algorithm, camera angle, lighting, image quality, masks, and the database being searched.
- The Delhi Police's affidavit in the Supreme Court was in response to petitions being heard alleging excessive force and use of surveillance at the students' protest in Jantar Mantar.
- District-wise, the data shows that Delhi's North re-

- coded the highest number of identified persons at 285, followed by Outer (257), North West (256), North East (174), East (173), and South West (166). Other districts and units listed included Railways, Shahdara, Central, South-East, West, Dwarka, South, Rohini, New Delhi, Crime Branch, IGI Airport, Metro and Special Cell.
- However, the affidavit does not specify whether those identified were accused, convicts, or merely named in criminal cases.
- According to the affidavit, "the face and other material of only those accused would be available in the police record who are facing serious offences and not petty offences like traffic challans/ violations of fences, etc".
- It also said: "No actions are taken solely based upon the result of the facial recognition system which is only the first step to identify a person in the crowd who has a criminal record. After the said face is recognised, there is a field verification done with respect to the individual concerned since that person's details are already in the police records and if, on field verification, it is found that he was, in fact, present at the site, actions are taken."

WHITE REVOLUTION

UNDER CM YOGI, UP BECOMES INDIA'S NO. 1 MILK-PRODUCING STATE

Uttar Pradesh has set a new benchmark by becoming India's top milk-producing state. Launched under Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the Nand Baba Milk Mission, Nandini Krishak Samridhhi and Mini Nandini Krishak Samridhhi schemes have turned dairy farming into a profitable enterprise for farmers, women and youth alike. Backed by improved cattle breeds, easy subsidies and scientific animal husbandry, the state now produces 38.8 million metric tonnes of milk, holding a 16 percent share of India's total milk output. Beyond the numbers, this marks a genuine transformation of the rural economy.



Milk Production

Number-1 in the Entire Country



38.8 Million Metric Tonnes: Production



16% Share: In national milk production



17,994 Beneficiaries: Received benefits of the Nand Baba Milk Mission



4,951 Primary Milk Cooperative Societies: Formed



2.25 Lakh People: Direct and indirect employment provided



39 Lakh Litres: Daily milk processing and chilling capacity



₹42 Crore Subsidy: Provided via DBT (Direct Benefit Transfer)



Modern Dairy Units Boost Farmers' Earnings



Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath during the inauguration of a new dairy processing centre under the State Industrial Policy in Miria Rehda Village, Azamgarh.

Push for better cattle breeds, balanced fodder management and animal healthcare services

Small and marginal farmers increasingly adopt dairy as a steady, reliable income source

Strong Participation by Women

- Women linked to self-help groups boosting family income through dairy farming
- Active role in animal care, milk collection and value-added products drives economic and social empowerment

Dairy Sector Becomes a New Model for Rural Development

- Fodder production, veterinary care, transport, packaging and marketing generate additional employment
- UP emerges as a national model for dairy-led self-employment and self-reliance

Nand Baba Milk Mission Strengthens the Cooperative Framework

- 17,994 beneficiaries have directly gained from the mission's schemes so far
- 4,951 primary milk cooperative societies formed, supporting nearly 2.25 lakh jobs
- Stronger systems for milk collection, quality testing and timely payments to farmers

Nandini Krishak Samridhhi Yojana: A Boon for Large Dairy Farmers

- 50% subsidy, up to Rs 31.25 lakh, for setting up a unit of 25 milch cattle (Gir, Sahiwal, Tharparkar, Gangatiri breeds)
- Subsidy disbursed in three phases; 50% of units reserved for women beneficiaries



Mini Nandini Krishak Samridhhi Yojana: New Strength for Small Dairy Farmers

- 50% subsidy, up to Rs 11.80 lakh, for a unit of 10 milch cattle
- Subsidy disbursed in two phases; half of all units reserved for women

Inspiring Story - Shivam Singh's Success



- Shivam Singh of Sandwa Chandika village, Pratapgarh, began animal husbandry by caring for an injured indigenous cow
- Took a Rs 5 lakh loan under Mini Nandini Yojana, bought Gir and Sahiwal cows from Rajasthan
- Now owns 25 cattle, produces around 110 litres of milk daily, earns nearly Rs 20 lakh a year
- Now makes ghee and other value-added products from A2 milk, also employing local youth

Dairy Emerges as a Second Pillar of Income Alongside Farming

- UP Government builds animal husbandry and dairy into a strong support system to cut over-reliance on crops
- Nandini and Mini Nandini schemes aim beyond milk-driving rural entrepreneurship and self-employment

Indigenous Breeds, Empowered Youth, Stronger Villages

- Mini Nandini scheme makes it easier to start a dairy unit with low investment
- Youth choosing villages over cities, driving local employment growth
- Gir, Sahiwal and other native breeds promoted through the CM's Swadeshi Gau-Samvardhan Yojana
- Indigenous breeds yield higher-quality milk, making animal husbandry more sustainable

Modern Dairy Industry Gets a New Boost

- UP Dairy Development and Milk Products Promotion Policy-2022 enables processing capacity of 39 lakh litres of milk per day
- Nearly 10,000 new jobs created; around Rs 42 crore disbursed via DBT to encourage private investment

With the right scheme, timely financial support and hard work, a successful enterprise can be built even while staying in the village. UP's white revolution stands as living proof of this belief.

Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar



~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Presumed guilty, SIR's spreading stain

FOUR BOOTHS in one district of Jharkhand do not a national election make. But as an investigation by this newspaper has shown, their story is emblematic of how the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls continues to raise troubling questions. In at least four booths in Godda, a stand-off between election officials and BJP workers has thrown up a disturbing pattern: Of BJP workers submitting Form 7s in bulk, seeking deletion of names from the draft rolls. Under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, Form 7 allows an objection to a proposed inclusion, an existing name, or a request for deletion. The red flags here are unmistakable — bulk objections by BJP workers do not merely invite accusations of procedural violation, they raise the graver concern of targeted deletion of minority voters. Many of those marked for deletion had submitted the required documents, lived in the same house for generations, or were mapped onto the 2003 rolls. An inquiry has been ordered after this newspaper's report but that cannot be the end of the matter. For, across states, the SIR increasingly looks designed not to clean rolls but to harass, and in the process, disenfranchise the vulnerable voter. It is distrustful of her, it asks her to establish belonging, or, more correctly, counter the accusation of unbelonging that is implicit in the exercise.

Nationwide, the SIR has resulted in 13 crore deletions. This, after it shifts the burden of proof onto the voter, demands documents that are often difficult to access, sets unrealistic deadlines and, in doing so, makes the process itself the punishment. This must be owned by the Election Commission under the watch of CEC Gyanesh Kumar. Some of the responsibility, with due respect, also lies with the Supreme Court. Yes, the Court intervened to ease the burden on Bihar's voters — directing the EC to accept Aadhaar, nudging it toward giving reasons for deletion. Its record of protecting the EC's institutional autonomy has been formidable in the past. But this time, institutional respect has given way to abdication. It has given the EC the benefit of every doubt, it has not asked of it the questions it needed to. In West Bengal, it contributed to the exercise piling up new layers, with the deployment of micro-observers, judicial officers, a bulky "under adjudication" list, and 19 appellate tribunals with no deadline after being set up too late. The Bengal appellate process goes on after the election is over. Those excluded remain in the dark about what comes next. Will it be detention, deportation, denial of benefits, prolonged litigation, or reapplication?

The electoral rolls need to be continuously cleaned and updated. But revision must never become a citizenship test, least of all in a climate where the spectre of the "ghuspaithiya" is politically expedient. That is what the SIR has become. An exercise meant to certify the voter has put her on trial. The EC and the SC need to ask themselves if they will let this terribly flawed process cast a shadow over their legacy.

Needed: More stable foreign capital

IN JUNE, the RBI announced several measures to boost capital flows into the country. There were, however, concerns over how much could be mopped up through various channels, considering the prevailing global financial conditions. Those worries have now been belied. By the end of August 31, inflows through the forex swap facility stood at a substantial \$136.3 billion, with \$63.5 billion coming in the last 10 days alone. Of the total flows, \$127 billion has come through the FCNR(B) route, with the balance coming from the External Commercial Borrowings and Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings channels. Flows have, thus, significantly exceeded expectations.

The RBI's forex reserves have risen to a record high of \$729 billion as on August 21. This will help with maintaining external stability. But the surge in inflows is creating management issues for the central bank with the liquidity surplus increasing. According to a note from economists at Bank of Baroda, the liquidity surplus began to swell from over Rs 3 lakh crore since the beginning of August to Rs 6.7 lakh crore by the end of the month. The central bank has responded by conducting variable rate reverse repo auctions. But other tools may also be needed. All this has come at a time when inflation is edging upwards and amidst expectations that the Monetary Policy Committee will need to raise interest rates. Robust growth in the first quarter would certainly provide the committee the space and comfort to undertake a tightening.

The FCNR(B) flows have provided a reprieve. The rupee's fall has been stemmed. But it does not address the underlying issues plaguing the economy. India runs a current account deficit and has in recent times not been able to attract sufficient stable foreign capital/investment. While over the past few months foreign portfolio investors have been net equity buyers and net FDI is inching upwards, tighter global financial conditions will influence flows. The larger issues need to be tackled to encourage foreign capital into the country.

All the lives that Gloria Steinem lived

GLORIA STEINEM spoke often about wanting to live to 100. "There is so much to do," she once explained in an interview. The prolific writer, one of the best-known faces of the women's liberation movement, died this week at 92 — a few years short of the century she had aspired to. A tireless journalist, activist, political organiser and speaker, Steinem lived for long stretches of time out of a suitcase because there were always so many ideas to be inspired by and lives to be changed.

Some of her restlessness owed to her fear of having missed out on important experiences when, from the age of 10 to 17, she was forced to "mother" her mentally ill mother. Then there was the doctor in the UK who performed an abortion — then illegal in much of the world — on a 22-year-old Steinem on two conditions: That she never reveal his name and that she do with her life exactly as she pleased. She would spend the next seven decades living up to the second — she broke the first after the doctor's death when she dedicated her memoir to him. Steinem battled long and hard alongside other stalwarts of the movement like Shirley Chisholm, Bella Abzug and Betty Friedan, to pass the Equal Rights Amendment (ERA), advocated for reproductive freedom, raised awareness about violence against women and co-founded a magazine, Ms, run and staffed entirely by women.

The ERA was never passed, the victory of *Roe v Wade* was reversed and violence against women remains pervasive. None of this is Steinem's failure, nor of the movement she led. All it shows is how much more there is still to do.

India's growth numbers are real. So is the reform challenge

IT IS a truth almost universally acknowledged that the Narendra Modi government must be interrogated on the data it produces. Over the past 12 years, it has worked hard to earn this reputation. It is not surprising, therefore, that within hours of the release of GDP data, the questioning began. Real GDP growth of 7.8 per cent in April-June 2026 over the corresponding quarter in 2025, nominal growth of 10.3 per cent, and therefore an economy-wide price rise of just 2.3 per cent. Is this all for real, or the expected response of any government with its back to the wall?

With war and tariffs ravaging the world, can India be an island of prosperity? It can, and India is not an island. Several economies have withstood these shocks. The IMF expects world growth of 3.0 per cent in 2026 against 2.9 last year; the world may well end 2026 growing faster than it did in 2025, war(ts) and all.

As it happens, the data turns out to support the government rather than the knee-jerk opposition.

Start with the deflator, where the critics have expectedly gathered. For a decade, the standard charge against Indian GDP data was single deflation. India applied one price index to output without separately deflating what firms paid for inputs — a squeeze on margins was recorded as extra production. The new 2022-23 national accounts series abolished single deflation outright, and manufacturing and agriculture are now double-deflated. That correction has not reached the critics, and certainly not the quick AI summaries doing the rounds. Further improvements are in the pipeline. We had only wholesale prices; producer price indices, which the IMF had asked for, were published for the first time in June.

Now to the devils/angels in the details.

Prices of what India actually bought — consumption, government and investment together — rose 4.4 per cent, above consumer inflation of 3.9. Two facts pull the headline down to 2.3 per cent. Import prices rose 32 per cent, on imports worth 28 per cent of GDP, and imports enter GDP with a minus sign. And net indirect taxes fell 0.4 per cent in rupee terms even as the volume taxed rose 3.9. Recall that the government surrendered 10 rupees a litre of excise on petrol and diesel in March; fertiliser subsidies are heading for twice the budgeted allocation. Taxes forgone and subsidies paid show up as a lower deflator.

Further evidence comes from the GST cut itself. In October-December, the first full quarter after the September reduction, Indians spent 8.5 per cent more in rupees than a year earlier — down from 10.8 per cent the year before. Yet real consumption grew 8.2 per cent, up from 6.0. The consumption deflator had collapsed to 0.4 per cent. Households parted with fewer additional rupees and took home more goods — exactly what a tax cut passed through to consumers looks like. The real GDP growth number is real.

But... double deflation is only as good as the input prices you feed into it, and with imported input costs up 32 per cent this quarter, MoSPI should publish the input deflator series it used. A reform this consequential should be complete.

A request also to India's GDP critics. Look at other, possibly more legitimate, targets of possible GDP data manipulation — the ones left alone because it is politically correct to do so.

Start with Bangladesh data, which yields the fashionable conclusion that its per capita income exceeds India's — a claim that sells



SURJIT S BHALLA

With war and tariffs ravaging the world, can India be an island of prosperity? It can, and India is not an island. Several economies have withstood these shocks

Poet who was also an environmental visionary



RAJNI BAKSHI

WENDELL BERRY, poet, farmer, environmental visionary, passed away on August 31, at the age of 92. He was a quiet, steady, sage presence for people across the world.

Berry's passing lends a bitter sharpness to the question on which the future of our species might depend.

Can the energy, will and wisdom of those who value the interdependence of all life on Earth prevail over the concentration of power in the hands of a few who drive trends in technology and thus markets?

Love of nature is more ancient than the human ability to form words, to develop language. There is also no doubt that passionate expression of this love, and public actions driven by it, have grown on a planetary scale over the last half century.

Just last week, an online group that I am part of collectively mourned the loss of a chestnut tree that stood as a welcoming host at the entrance of Schumacher College in Devon, UK. Age and infirmity took their toll and the tree came down. The energy of those who will miss the tree, its loving shade and the music of the breeze rustling through its leaves, is palpable.

Why does this energy seem inadequate to tackle and transform the forces destroying the delicate balance of life on planet Earth? Wendell's legacy inspires and empowers us to doggedly and defiantly keep seeking answers to this question.

As an activist, Wendell leaves behind a legacy of tirelessly standing up for justice and basic goodness in the face of ruthless power. From Vietnam to the American invasion of Iraq in 2003, Wendell passionately fought against American aggression abroad.

Along with many fellow-travellers, he advocated a 50-year farm bill that would tackle the combined problems of soil loss and degradation, toxic pollution, fossil-

fuel dependency and the destruction of rural communities.

Wendell's life and work were intertwined with the emergence of diverse shades of environmentalism over the last 75 years.

These overlapping streams of thought and action have proved that we are not in the midst of a "love-of-nature" vs "progress" conflict. The key challenge of the 21st century is how to live in partnership with the rest of nature, and this requires us to first redefine both "progress" and "growth".

Often described as an intellectual and spiritual heir to Henry David Thoreau, Wendell became a tall Gandhian presence in American public life, because he advocated empowering local economies, radical self-reliance and living within limits to ensure sustainability.

As we enter the second quarter of the 21st century, the concentration of money power and control over emerging technologies in the hands of a few people is more severe than ever before. In terms of tactics and strategy, the ideas and values that Wendell inspired can seem to be at a huge disadvantage.

And yet the essence of his inspiration is above and beyond all ideology, tactics, strategy — and will continue to flower in unexpected and unpredictable ways.

It is best to let his 1968 poem 'The Peace of Wild Things' speak for him: *When despair for the world grows in me/and I wake in the night at the least sound/in fear of what my life and my children's lives may be./I go and lie down where the wood drake/ rests in his beauty on the water, and the great heron feeds./I come into the peace of wild things/who do not tax their lives with forethought/ of grief. I come into the presence of still water./And I feel above me the day-blind stars/ waiting with their light. For a time/ I rest in the grace of the world, and am free.*

The writer is founder of the YouTube channel 'Ahimsa Conversations'

We need one Ministry of Energy, not five



PRATIK AGARWAL

INDIA IS entering a fundamentally different era of energy. For decades, our challenge was simple: Produce more energy. Coal, oil, gas, renewables and nuclear could each be planned independently because each largely operated within its own ecosystem. Today's challenge is no longer producing energy. It is optimising an increasingly complex energy system. A unit of solar power generated at noon has a different value from a unit of hydro power during the evening peak. Batteries, pumped storage and gas turbines all exist to balance renewable generation. Nuclear provides a steady baseload. Coal provides flexibility rather than simply volume. Every source now plays a different role at a different time of the day. Most importantly, every one of them depends on the same electricity grid. This changes how governments need to think about energy. India still governs the sector as though every fuel exists in isolation. Coal sits in one ministry. Oil and gas in another. Renewables in a third. Electricity in a fourth. Nuclear in a fifth. Each ministry has well-defined objectives. But each is optimising only one part of the system. Nobody is responsible for optimising the whole. That may have worked in the 20th century, but not for the 21st. Renewable projects are commissioned before transmission is ready. Gas-based plants were built without assured fuel. Coal production, imports, railway logistics and electricity demand have at times moved on different trajectories. Each ministry has largely achieved its own objectives, yet the overall system has often fallen short. The problem is not policy. It is governance.

Energy security today is no longer about having enough coal or enough renewable capacity. It is about ensuring the entire system works as one. That requires integrated planning across generation, fuel supply, transmission, storage and demand. Every investment should be evaluated based on how it improves the performance of the whole system, not one technology in isolation. Many countries have recognised this reality. The US, Brazil, Saudi Arabia and the UK have unified energy ministries responsible for looking across the energy landscape rather than individual fuels.

India should do the same. A single Ministry of Energy would not eliminate specialised expertise. Coal, oil, renewables and nuclear would continue to need dedicated departments and technical institutions. But strategy would come from one place. Infrastructure would be planned as one system. Investment decisions would be made with a single objective: Delivering the lowest-cost, most reliable and most secure energy mix for India.

As India moves towards becoming a developed economy, energy will become one of our biggest competitive advantages — or one of our biggest constraints. Our institutions need to evolve as quickly as our energy system has. Creating a unified Ministry of Energy may well be the single most important governance reform India can undertake to strengthen its energy security.

The writer is chairman, Resonia and Serentica Renewables and managing director, Sterlite Electric

40 YEARS AGO

September 04, 1986



India says UK visa rules racist

INDIAN OFFICIALS accused the British government of racial discrimination for proposing to introduce a visa system for visitors from India and four other Asian and African countries. The other countries that will face visa restrictions are Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nigeria and Ghana.

VP Singh 'land deals' uproar

THE ISSUE of alleged involvement of the Union Finance Minister, Vishwanath Pratap Singh, in the land deals of the Dahya Charitable Trust of Allahabad stalled the proceedings of the Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha for almost the entire day. Noisy and unruly scenes broke out in the House as

soon as Shatrudra Prakash (Lok Dal) rose to press his adjournment motion on the subject and demanded Singh's resignation pending a high-level inquiry into the affairs of the Dahya Charitable Trust. The House had to be adjourned several times before it was finally adjourned for the day at 5.25 pm. However, the Union Finance Minister, who air dashed from Delhi to Lucknow, kept his calm and summoned a press conference to clarify in no ambiguous terms that he was not a member of the Dahya Charitable Trust nor did he have any interest therein.

Farooq on President's Rule

THE NATIONAL Conference president, Farooq Abdullah, said that he would not

have any objection to a brief spell of President's Rule in Jammu and Kashmir as an interim measure until the end of his current discussions with the Prime Minister for a political settlement. Abdullah, however, emphasised that the restoration of democracy in the state would be the only final solution, and for that it was necessary to dissolve the present assembly and hold fresh elections.

US halts aid to Zimbabwe

THE UNITED States has announced that it will give no new aid to Zimbabwe because of that nation's "unwillingness to conduct its relations with the US according to accepted norms of diplomatic civility and practice".



DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

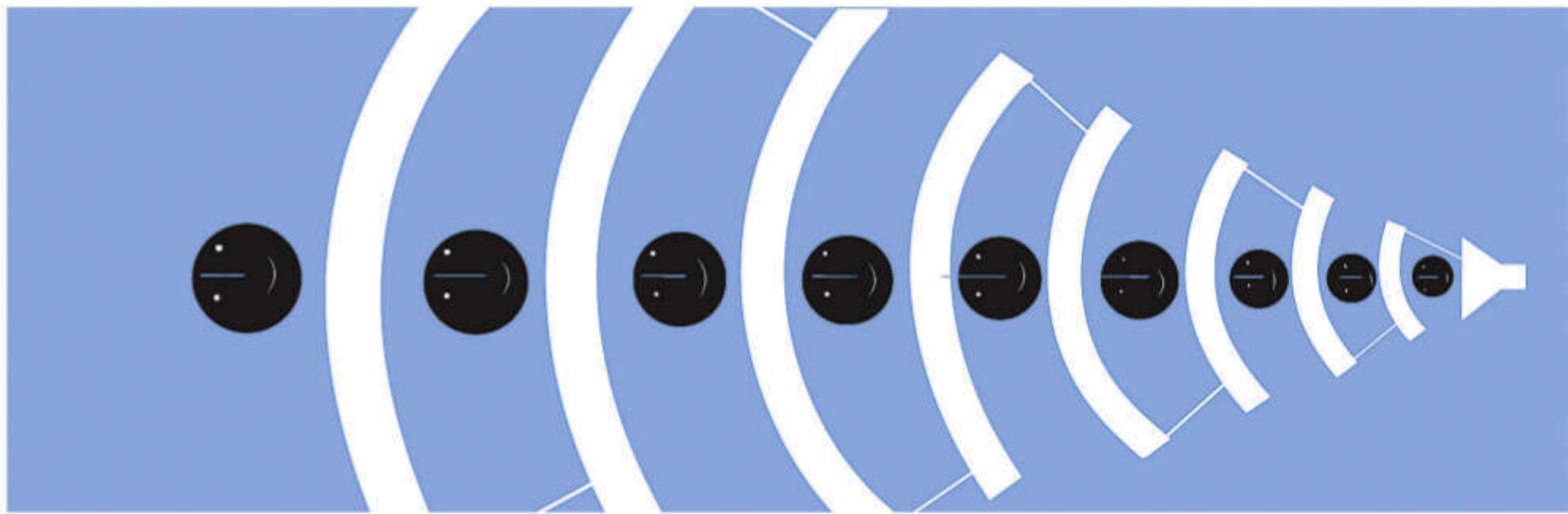


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Do Mohan Bhagwat’s speeches abroad indicate a shift in the RSS’s positioning?

Tactics change, Hindutva doesn’t



SUHAS PALSHIKAR

THANKS TO the convenient gullibility of those commenting on his speeches, Mohan Bhagwat is on the verge of becoming the new Jawaharlal Nehru. His recent “celebration” of diversity is being dutifully showcased as the RSS chief effecting an important shift. Thankfully, the evidence shows what he actually said: That diversity is decoration; it is beautification of unity. This is in contrast to the notion that diversity is not only an inseparable part of what we once understood as Indianness, but diversity actually facilitates our unity. Therefore, what Bhagwat said in North America is not a real shift but a tactical positioning of the idea of Hindutva to make it acceptable to a wider audience that adopts naivety as the method of analysis.

To be fair, Bhagwat has earlier also adopted the argument that Muslims in India are not “outsiders” and that people of all religions should live amicably. So, should we be thankful to him for this concession? Should we say that he is changing the way Hindutva is understood now, or should we put his utterances in context before we jump to certify his inclusionary credentials?

Three things provide the context. First, Bhagwat is not an individual. He is the chief of a “voluntary” organisation that supervises a vast network of individuals and organisations that stand by and for the idea of Hindutva. His statements, therefore, must resonate with all that goes in the name of Hindutva. How do we make sense of his assertion that “if a Hindu wants an India without Muslims, he is not a Hindu” when many Hindutva forces keep villainising Muslims? Didn’t he once say that there is no need to search for a *shivling* under every mosque (2022)? That didn’t stop Hindutva politics from doing exactly the opposite. If that is the case, what he says today about Muslims being part of India also becomes meaningless. In the 1990s, too, some naïve liberals argued that Muslims should hand over the Babri mosque and, in exchange, get an assurance that no such controversies over other places of worship would be raked up. Hindutva’s history shows two things: That it is unforgiving to those it views as its enemies, and it is unrelenting in its beliefs.

The second aspect is the convenient multi-vocal articulation of Hindutva. Leaders from its brother organisations and oftentimes even functionaries and publications of the RSS keep popularising ideas that

are in contravention to the sanguine utterances of the RSS chief. That explains the insistence of many from the current regime to exclude references to Mughals from history textbooks; it explains how those steeped in RSS training refer to communities as Aurangzeb’s *aulad* and an officer of the armed forces as sister of terrorists; it explains the constant confusion created by the interchangeable use of Hindu as religion (faith) and civilisation; how Lakshmi and Saraswati are argued to be cultural symbols but at the same time, Muslims are barricaded from “Hindu” festivals. Both in propagation of ideas and in practice, this slippery multi-vocality frustrates the supposed olive branch Bhagwat wants to hold out to critics of Hindutva.

The third dimension is the continuity from the time MS Golwalkar was RSS chief. Almost every single idea of organising Indian society upheld in Golwalkar’s time is back in fashion. Tactics and expressions have changed, and the RSS leadership has certainly advanced in terms of savvy media presence and the political use of institutional power. But the question students of Hindutva must ask is this: Has Hindutva as an ideology changed? In the absence of any substantive change, it will be a mistake to pick up some statements and be satisfied that Hindutva (or the RSS) is changing.

In its century-long history, the RSS has undergone many “transformations”. The early transformation was under Golwalkar. The second was when MD Deoras became the RSS chief. He defrocked the RSS of its upper-caste limitations and opened the floodgates of Hindutva to the larger social pool of backward castes. Deoras also realised that in the post-Nehru era, there was space for intervention in the formal political arena, and encouraged a more active presence of Hindutva cadres there.

Building on that, Modi and Bhagwat have brought about the third transformation: A close partnership between the state and the Hindutva cultural behemoth. This has facilitated extraordinary opportunities for Hindutva to both become hegemonic and also crush its ideological adversaries using the state apparatus. Bhagwat can afford to sound magnanimous because his politics already enjoys hegemony, not because it needs to become more acceptable or inclusive. Most importantly, those eager to find virtue in his utterances must remember that we are not dealing with Bhagwat the person, howsoever soft spoken and accommodating he might sound. We are dealing with politics in a deeper sense: Of combining a mammoth project of hegemony that seeks to strengthen itself with the unforgiving authority of the state.

The writer, based in Pune, taught Political Science



RAKESH SINHA

RSS SARSANGHCHALAK Mohan Bhagwat’s speeches, including the one in New York, carry a message for both domestic and foreign audiences. First, he has redefined the RSS’s positioning regarding minorities, especially Muslims, which has been used as a weapon to question its legitimacy in secular democracy. Second, and more importantly, Bhagwat critiqued the philosophical basis of neoliberalism, which increasingly legitimises conflicts and immorality to gain wealth and coercive superiority. In this context, he said that India’s ultimate ambition is “to be a *vishwaguru* rather than a superpower”. Finally, he didn’t confine himself to the controversies around the RSS but spoke at length about the idea of India and presented the RSS through that lens.

Bhagwat inaugurated the global role of the RSS through people-to-people dialogue. The RSS has a foreign department to understand the culture and politics of different nations and has branches of the Hindu Swayamsevak Sangh (HSS) abroad. The RSS, it seems, now want to expand that footprint.

An ossified perception about the RSS creates hurdles for its progressive socio-economic role. Here, Bhagwat’s observation that a Hindu would lose his Hinduness if he seeks to oust Muslims from India deserves serious discussion. This becomes difficult because of the unthinking professional critics of the RSS dubbing his words as doublespeak, citing anti-minority statements by some political leaders. The RSS leadership has refused to be a part of this coarse conversation.

The RSS has wrongly been perceived as a rigidly doctrinaire movement. Unlike other ideological movements that remain tied to the words and actions of their architects, its founder K B Hedgewar consciously became part of a collective leadership. Despite being the sole founder of the organisation, he ensured there was no “Hedgewarism”. This privileges flexibility and instils confidence in the leadership to interpret his ideas in new contexts. Such nimbleness is missing in communist and socialist movements.

Bhagwat’s approach to the Muslim question is consistent with his prede-

cessors. For example, Hindu Mahasabha leader B S Moonje was rebuked by Hedgewar and Martand Jog for his argument in a public meeting in Nagpur in 1930 that the British should not leave India till it was ensured that Muslims would not dominate politics. Moonje wrote in his diary, “They said that the Hindu-Muslim question is our internal affair which we will settle out. And the British have to go first.” Hedgewar’s successor, M S Golwalkar, surprised both friends and foes of the RSS when he said in his interview to the RSS daily *Motherland* on August 23, 1972, that personal law was justified as long as it did not endanger national unity.

This makes it obvious that there is a fundamental difference between Hindutva as perceived both by friends and foes and the variant theorised by the RSS. The former is a political consolidation for the Hindus. It was espoused by the Hindu Mahasabha. The RSS and Hedgewar faced resistance and criticism for their approach, which is civilisational. Bhagwat has assertively championed this legacy. There is a space for Hindus’ anger, given the role of the Mughals and Muslim League in the past. But this anger is not a path to resolution and instead creates what Antonio Gramsci called a “war of position”. Such elements do little to fight the social and cultural divides that are reasons for a fractured Hindu social order and a weak Indian polity. The RSS is the only social movement that is committed to creating a meaningful “meeting pot” (not a melting pot).

For the last few decades, extreme elements from both sides — egged on by social media — have contributed to making the RSS seem, erroneously, like a radical outfit. Some anti-RSS elements have been more than unfair when they compare it to the White supremacist Ku Klux Klan. Unfortunately, parties that claim to be secular have often projected the RSS as a parallel to the Muslim League. It is this perception that has travelled outside India.

Bhagwat’s aim is not to perpetuate the status quo but to convey to minorities that Hindus’ unwavering conviction about multiculturalism should lead to cultural flexibility among them, as they become part of India’s spiritual democracy. Unwillingness to depart from institutionalised prejudices is among the major challenges before the evolution of secularism in India. The Bhagwat doctrine is an opportunity for them to have further dialogue with the RSS to ensure the success of India’s secular democracy. Will they?

The writer is a former BJP Rajya Sabha MP

US settlement with Meta is a start. India must protect itself



SIGNAL TO NOISE

BY RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR

ON AUGUST 26, Meta agreed to pay up to \$17.1 billion to resolve child-harm claims brought by a bipartisan coalition of attorneys general across the United States, its territories and the District of Columbia. It is one of the largest consumer-protection settlements in internet history. More importantly, it marks a turning point in the debate over whether social-media platforms knowingly exposed children to harm in pursuit of growth and profit.

The case placed Meta’s design choices under legal scrutiny: How its products encouraged prolonged use, how teen safety-features were presented to the public, and how the company understood the risks its platforms created for young users. Meta denies wrongdoing. But the settlement demonstrates that voluntary self-regulation is no substitute for enforceable accountability.

Under the proposed settlement, Meta must adopt stronger safeguards for users under 18, including default time limits, restrictions on nighttime use, limits on notifications during school hours, enhanced age-assurance measures and independent compliance oversight. These are not cosmetic changes. They go to the core of how Facebook and Instagram are allowed to operate for minors.

If American children now receive court-backed protection from harmful platform design, why should Indian children not receive the same assurance of safety?

This settlement does not mean that Meta has solved the problem. A company that generated \$201 billion in revenue in 2025 can absorb \$17 billion paid over 10 years. That Meta stock was up 5 per cent after the settlement proves that this settlement has little or no punitive impact on the company. The mandated safety reforms are meaningful, but overdue. Most critically, the settlement protects American children under American law, through American prosecutors. It does not cover India’s 350 million young users. The same platforms operate here. The same recommendation systems shape what children see. The same incentives reward attention, engagement and prolonged use. Yet India has not seen comparable legal action, compelled disclosure or court-supervised reform.

That is not because the harm is less serious in India. It is because our debate on platform harm has remained episodic and inconclusive. A tragedy occurs, outrage follows, a platform issues a statement, a parliamentary question may be asked — and then silence returns. American litigation broke that cycle. India now needs a legal process capable of compelling the same disclosure.

Disclosure was the most important outcome of the US case. Court-compelled discovery forced Meta to produce internal research, design documents and communications about child safety — under oath, in public, and subject to cross-examination. A serious legal action in Indian courts would compel answers to questions like:

What does Meta’s internal research show about mental-health impact on In-

dian teenage girls? How does the recommendation engine behave in Hindi, Tamil, and Bengali for a 14-year-old at 11 pm? How many Indian children under 13 are active on platforms that legally prohibit their membership? What is the scale of child-sexual-abuse material affecting Indian users, and how is it reported? In the US alone, 7.5 million materials were under internal review.

Were the same addictive design features applied to Indian users? If yes, Indian users have been subjected to harm with no protection.

The answers exist — in Meta’s servers, internal research databases and executive communications. The only way to obtain them is through the courts. India has the legal foundation to act: The Consumer Protection Act, 2019, the IT (Intermediary Guidelines) Rules 2021, the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), the Juvenile Justice Act and the Constitution of India. We need not wait for new legislation.

The Safe, Trusted and Accountable framework developed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s government in 2021 — of which I was a part — was designed for this

purpose: To ensure that platforms operating at scale bear legal responsibility for the consequences of their design choices. The conduct alleged in the American cases fails that standard.

India needs to coordinate a national legal strategy. The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights should launch a formal inquiry with discovery powers, compelling platforms to produce India-specific

safety research, algorithm documentation, data on underage users, and internal-harm research.

Affected families in India can approach consumer forums and high courts directly, too. Parliament must pass legislation creating a statutory right to algorithmic disclosure — requiring platforms to reveal, to a designated Indian authority, their content moderation policies, recommendation engine parameters, and child-safety research for Indian users. Last, state governments should file coordinated consumer protection and child-safety suits against these platforms in Indian courts. A single pioneering state can trigger a national movement.

The US settlement is a beginning. For too long, global platforms have operated in India with less scrutiny, weaker oversight and lower public awareness than they face in the West. They have profited enormously from India’s young users while bearing little legal accountability.

The settlement is America’s answer to what social media has done to its children. India must now find its own answers. The shadow debate must end. The harm is real. The platforms know it. Legal tools exist. It’s time to act decisively to make all platforms safe, trusted and accountable.

The writer, former MP, former minister of state for Electronics & Information Technology, Government of India, is BJP Kerala state president and MLA for Nemom. He begins a fortnightly column. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Selective FIRs

SUBJECTING STUDENTS to police investigations and prolonged judicial proceedings in fabricated cases merely because their ideology differs from that of those in power is indefensible and undemocratic (“Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there’s a question”, *IE*, September 3). How does one account for the years lost before justice is delivered? Across India, countless undertrials remain incarcerated for years awaiting trial. In such circumstances, telling an accused that the High Court and Supreme Court remain open to them is hardly reassuring.

Tushar A Rahatgaonkar, Dombivli East

THE CJT’S observation that the determination of criminality has to be seen with the object and purpose for which

the students gathered, not simply by participation in an unlawful act, distinguishes the Jantar Mantar protest on the question of accountability, making the verdict appear selective (“Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but a question”, *IE*, September 3).

Madhusree Guha, Kolkata

Mass deletions

THAT 13 crore voters have had their names omitted from the draft rolls so far reveals a troubling bias in the SIR process (“There’s a new solution for India’s population problem — SIR”, *IE*, September 3). As the bulk of those excluded come from the ‘absent’ or ‘shifted’ categories, the question that arises is: Where have all these people gone? Or, why was there no corresponding increase in the number of voters in other states?

Kamal Laddha, Bengaluru



ASHOK KHEMKA

A FORMER finance secretary recently challenged the Q1 FY 2026-27 growth figures of 7.8 per cent in real terms and 10.3 per cent in nominal terms, suggesting that the corresponding growth rates were actually around 2.6 per cent and below 2.5 per cent. His calculation, however, has a methodological flaw: It uses the old-series nominal GDP of Rs 86.05 lakh crore for Q1 FY 2025-26 as the denominator against the new-series figure of approximately Rs 80 lakh crore. One cannot calculate a meaningful growth rate by mixing two incompatible statistical series. On this point, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is right. But that does not dispose of the more substantive question.

Under the old 2011-12-base-year series, nominal GDP for Q1 FY 2025-26 was officially

On GDP, what critics should ask

estimated at Rs 86.05 lakh crore and Q2 at Rs 85.25 lakh crore — a first-half total of Rs 171.30 lakh crore. Under the new 2022-23-base-year series, Q1 was revised to roughly Rs 80 lakh crore and Q2 also to approximately Rs 80 lakh crore. The first-half estimate has fallen by around Rs 11 lakh crore, or about 6.5 per cent. This enormous revision is concentrated in the first two quarters. There is an obvious reason this deserves scrutiny. The old series was discontinued before comparable Q3 and Q4 estimates for 2025-26 were published. So, there is no complete old-series annual estimate against which the new series can be reconciled quarter by quarter. MoSPI should open that window.

A new national-accounts series incorporates new data sources, wider coverage, improved indicators, methodological changes and revised approaches to measuring prices and volumes. It can, and should, change historical estimates when better information becomes available. But there is a crucial distinction that must not be lost.

Changing the base year primarily changes the measurement of real GDP. Nominal GDP is measured at current prices. Therefore, the fact that the base year has changed from 2011-12 to 2022-23 does not, by itself, explain the reduction. There may well be legitimate statistical reasons for the revision. But they need to be quantified.

MoSPI should publish a simple reconciliation bridge showing, in rupees, how the old estimate became the new one. For both Q1 and Q2, the public should be told how much of the revision is attributable to: Revised source data; changes in sectoral coverage; methodological changes; revised estimates of taxes and subsidies; changes in price indices and deflators and other statistical adjustments. The same exercise should be undertaken for GVA. If manufacturing, trade, financial services, agriculture or any other major component accounts for a significant part of the revision, the numbers should show it. That would settle the argument. It is equally important not to fall into

the opposite trap. A downward revision of GDP is not a loss of GDP. The economy has not become Rs 11 lakh crore smaller. Better data can lead to downward revisions.

Over three years from 2022-23 to 2025-26, nominal GDP rose by about 32.8 per cent and 32.3 per cent under the old and new series respectively. The cumulative real GDP growth is also broadly comparable, though somewhat lower under the new methodology.

Official statistics deserve confidence, but confidence is strengthened by transparency, not demanded in its absence. It is wrong to calculate current growth by combining an old-series denominator with a new-series numerator. But it is equally unsatisfactory to dismiss questions about a massive revision simply by invoking “change of base year”. Statistics become credible when an independent reader can understand, reproduce and interrogate the numbers.

The writer was an IAS officer. Views are personal

Iran buries victims of reported US wedding attack, fires at Kuwait base

Reuters
Dubai, September 3

IRANIAN MOURNERS carried caskets on Thursday at a funeral for victims of a US airstrike said to have struck a wedding party, and Tehran launched missiles and drones overnight at a US base in Kuwait, after the war's biggest escalation in more than a month.

Mourners assembled in the late afternoon outside the village of Kuhestak in Sirik County, along a stretch of the coast of the Strait of Hormuz that was hit by heavy US airstrikes late on Tuesday. Iranian officials say four people died and nearly 70 were wounded by a strike that hit a home during a wedding. The US military said it was aware of the Iranian reports but "never targets civilians".

"This is the body of Martyr Amir-Mohammad Karimi, a 4-year-old child who war martyred in an attack on the country's south by the criminal American regime," a reporter from Iran's Mehr news agency said in footage filmed in front of a pickup truck carrying a flag-draped coffin beneath a canopy of palm fronds.

In other footage of the funeral, mourners threw petals into the air as doleful music played from a loudspeaker. A casket was carried past a row of soldiers standing at attention with rifles.

Washington launched the airstrikes on Tuesday, hitting what it said were military targets along the coast in retaliation for Iranian attacks on shipping in the Strait of Hormuz.

The sudden escalation of the Iran war has caused a surge in oil prices to levels unseen since



The house that came under attack in Kuhestak village. REUTERS

July. Price rose for a fourth straight day on Thursday, taking Brent crude futures over \$96 a barrel. Iran reported 18 dead in the last US assault, including the four killed at the wedding. It responded on Wednesday to the US strikes with attacks on US bases in Iraq, Jordan, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain, and carried out further attacks early on Thursday, saying it was targeting another U.S. base, in Kuwait.

Kuwait's military said its air defences had intercepted missiles and drones. But following that, the war's biggest flareup since July appeared to subside, with no more major attacks from either side reported as the day wore on. The month of August was largely quiet in the Gulf after US President Donald Trump abruptly halted two weeks of intensive airstrikes in July, having been warned by his military that Washington was running low on munitions.

Trump has yet to achieve the aims he set out when he launched Operation Epic Fury in February: to end Iran's nuclear programme, halt its ability to attack its neighbours and create conditions for Iranians to topple their leadership.

AT LEAST 1,259 PEOPLE KILLED AND MORE THAN 4,200 REMAIN MISSING

Nepal races to rebuild homes, search for missing continues

20,000 houses need to be rebuilt in flood-hit areas

Gopal Sharma, Liz Lee & Ethan Wang
Beijing, Kathmandu, Sept 3

NEPAL WILL have to rebuild around 20,000 houses in flood-ravaged areas, authorities said on Thursday, as rescuers continued to search for workers trapped in tunnels linked to hydropower projects and thousands remain missing after last week's catastrophe.

A glacier collapse on August 26 sent a deluge of ice, rock and mud sweeping through the impoverished nation's border region with China, wiping out settlements and villages and leaving few houses standing and undamaged.

"Our preliminary estimates are that 7,500 houses have been completely destroyed, either washed away or buried under



A man carries a girl next to damaged buildings following the deadly flash floods and mudslides in Nuwakot district on Thursday. REUTERS

debris and mud," Dharma Raj Upreti, chief of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority, told Reuters.

Even houses still standing were not habitable, Upreti said, with authorities estimating that around 20,000 would have to be rebuilt in different, safer locations.

"We anticipate that the resources required for rebuilding

will be substantial," Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal told foreign ambassadors in Kathmandu.

At least 1,259 people were killed in Nepal last week as houses, streets and schools in towns and villages near the border with China's Tibet were swept away. More than 4,200 people are still missing and thousands more displaced.

China has put the death toll

in Tibet at 21, with 541 others listed as missing.

Prime Minister Balendra Shah's cabinet set September 7, the 13th day after the disaster, as a day of national mourning in Nepal, the cabinet spokesperson said. In Hindu tradition, the 13th day traditionally marks the end of the formal mourning period.

More than 9,300 Nepali army troops were on the ground in the affected areas of Timure in Rasuwa, Nuwakot,

Dhading, Chitwan and Nawalparasi East, coordinating search and rescue of the injured and helping with management of bodies, clearing blocked roads, and providing emergency medical treatment, an army statement said.

Authorities were working to restore regular routines as much as possible, with a focus on getting children into makeshift schools. More than a week after the flood, at least 22,000 children urgently need safe drinking water, sanitation and hygiene support, UNICEF said in a statement. REUTERS



Russian ship Professor Molchanov which, according to officials, was seized by Norway in the Arctic. FILE/REUTERS

Norway seizes Russian vessel to compensate Ukrainian energy firm

Reuters
Oslo, September 3

NORWEGIAN AUTHORITIES have seized a Russian cruise ship in the Arctic on behalf of Ukrainian energy company Naftogaz, which is seeking to enforce a \$4.22 billion compensation award for assets that Moscow took when Russia annexed Crimea in 2014.

Officials said the vessel, Professor Molchanov, was seized late on Wednesday in Barentsburg, a coal mining settlement that Russia operates on the Norwegian Arctic archipelago of Svalbard under the terms of a 1920 treaty. Russia called the arrest of the ship an act of piracy and said it had summoned the Norwegian ambassador to deliver a strong protest. The Russian Foreign Ministry said it would work to secure the vessel's release.

"Amid the restrictive measures imposed by Norway against Russia on Svalbard - measures that violate international law - Russian organizations and citizens operating on

Trump: Europe must repay US for Ukraine aid

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump on Thursday said he would ask European nations to pay back the US for military aid and munitions previously sent to Ukraine and appeared to signal a halt in sales to allied nations. In a social media post, Trump also slammed reports of heavily depleted US munition stockpiles amid the separate war in Iran, while adding that the United States was stockpiling munitions. "We are taking them for ourselves, the USA, rather than selling them to others, but the sales to Allies will soon again, begin," Trump wrote. AP

the archipelago are effectively under blockade," it said. Norway said the matter was between Naftogaz and Russia and did not involve the Oslo government.

• BRIEFLY

ITALY

Stories dangerous to people who peddle in fear: Clooney



Hollywood actor George Clooney. REUTERS

HOLLYWOOD STAR George Clooney received an honorary Golden Lion for lifetime achievement at the opening ceremony of the Venice Film Festival. In his acceptance speech, Clooney referenced the current political climate to emphasise the importance of stories. "...We're living through a moment in time where people in charge, the people with the most money are telling us to fear one another. But we know better than that, don't we? Because history does teach us a lesson," he said. "They're the filmmakers, writers, actors and musicians who insist that someone you have never met is deserving of your empathy. Stories are always dangerous to people who peddle in fear. The people who are afraid of books and music and stories, they're never the heroes in history," he added. PTI

UNITED STATES

Maduro, wife seek to evade drug charges

FORMER VENEZUELAN President Nicolas Maduro and his wife asked a judge on Wednesday to dismiss the drug trafficking indictment against them on the grounds that they have immunity as the leader and first lady of a foreign country. In papers filed in Manhattan federal court, lawyers for Maduro said a judge was required by law to reject the indictment because it cannot be brought against a foreign leader. AP

UNITED STATES

House passes bill to target varsities boycotting Israel

THE US House of Representatives passed legislation on Thursday to block federal aid for universities that boycott Israel, the latest Republican-backed pro-Israel measure amid growing Democratic criticism of the Israeli government over the war in Gaza. The Republican-majority chamber voted 237-169 in favor of the "Protect Economic and Academic Freedom Act," which would have to pass the Senate in order to become law. REUTERS

Finland runs Europe's biggest civil defence exercise since Cold War

Country's border with Russia stretches more than 1,300 km

Emma Burrows
Kuopio, September 3

IN A civil defence shelter hewn into rock, behind doors designed to withstand a nuclear or biological attack, two Finnish conscripts wearing hazmat suits and breathing masks are measuring radiation levels as

they take part in an exercise to turn a cave into a place of safety for thousands of people.

Inside, in what is normally a sports hall, hundreds of people are sleeping overnight on trestle beds. More than 2,000 people including volunteers and students are taking part in the biggest civil defence exercise in Europe since the end of World War II.

Critical infrastructure in the central Finnish city of Kuopio, including power and water, has been disrupted by cyberattacks and there's the threat of missile strikes from Finland's neighbour, Russia. The goal is for local author-



People stand at the entrance of a shelter designed to withstand chemical, nuclear and biological attacks. AP

ities and ordinary people to rehearse what they would do if they came under attack for real.

But while underground bunkers and shelters may offer some protection from missiles, they are

no defence against the campaign of sabotage and disruption that Western officials say Russia is carrying out across Europe.

That has involved setting fires, attacking water facilities and power stations, and sending drones for sabotage into European Union airspace. Finland's border with Russia stretches more than 1,300 km from the Baltic Sea up to the Arctic Circle.

In 2024, along with Sweden, Finland joined NATO, following Russian President Vladimir Putin's full-scale invasion of Ukraine. Until then, Finns were prepared to defend themselves against Russia largely alone.

Finland's defence, said retired Army Colonel Asko Muhkanen, relies not only on the military but on the "mindset" of ordinary Finns who are ready to take responsibility for their country's security. Muhkanen said that comes partly from the system of conscription which continued in Finland, even after the collapse of the Soviet Union.

Not everyone is happy about doing national service but "it's our duty to serve and protect this country like people have before us. That's why we have our independence," said Jyry Pietikainen, who was taught to run the Kuopio shelter overnight. AP

China sacks 4 professors for 'academic misconduct'

K J M Varma
Beijing, September 3

FOUR PROMINENT Chinese academics have lost their posts, and more than 40 researchers at universities and hospitals are facing investigations as China has launched its largest-ever public crackdown on academic misconduct.

On August 26, the National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC) published details of 31 new misconduct cases at universities and hospi-

tals across China, involving more than 40 researchers, the Hong Kong-based South China Morning Post reported on Thursday.

The NSFC announcement came nearly two months after Chinese President Xi Jinping called for a crackdown on academic misconduct.

Four prominent academics lost their posts at leading universities after Student Geng, a high-profile blogger and PhD dropout, publicly identified them in April and flagged their

research for alleged misconduct, the report said.

All of the four academics had been recognised by the National Science Fund for Distinguished Young Scholars, an honour that frequently serves as a stepping stone to admission to China's top science and engineering academies, it said.

Three of them had served as deans or associate deans of their respective schools. Geng's revelations on social media triggered the NSFC's largest-ever investigation into aca-

demic misconduct.

Naming the four academics in its August notice, the foundation revoked their funding and titles, ordered them to return more than 10 million yuan (USD 1.49 million) in previously awarded grants, and barred them from reapplying for funding for three to seven years.

Within China's research community, the move is widely seen as a "death sentence" for an academic career, the Post report said. PTI

• { GLORIA STEINEM • 1934-2026 } •

A feminist who fought for women's civil and reproductive rights for over 5 decades

Patricia Reaney
September 3

GLORIA STEINEM, the American writer, lecturer, activist and organiser who fought for gender equality and women's civil and reproductive rights for more than five decades, has died, her foundation said. She was 92 years old.

The co-founder and consulting editor of Ms. Magazine championed the feminist movement from the late 1960s onwards and inspired generations of women.

She died on Wednesday, her foundation said in an Instagram post on Thursday.

"From reluctant spokesper-

son to a beacon of positive change, hers is a singular journey - an American leader who can speak to us all," film and theater director Julie Taymor said of Steinem in a 2017 New York Times interview.

Taymor directed the 2020 film "The Glorias," depicting Steinem's life across the years and based on her 2015 best-selling autobiography "My Life on the Road." She was also the subject of a 2018 play, "Gloria: A Life," and a 2011 HBO documentary "Gloria: In Her Own Words."

Steinem said she considered herself "an entrepreneur of social change."

"I want to do justice to the women I meet, to tell their

stories," she told the New Yorker magazine in 2015. "It's making connections, and using myself to listen, because we can't empower women without listening to their stories."

Steinem founded the National Women's Political Caucus in 1971 with former US Representative Bella Abzug and Shirley Chisholm and writer Betty Friedan, whose 1963 book "The Feminine Mystique" ushered in the second wave of feminism.

Among other groups, she also created the Coalition of Labor Union Women, the Women's Media Center, Voters for Choice, and the Ms. Foundation for Women.

In 2013 then-President Ba-



Gloria Steinem at a rally of welfare demonstrators at the Washington Monument grounds. FILE/AP

rack Obama awarded her the Presidential Medal of Freedom, the highest US civilian honor.

With her signature long, blonde-streaked, center-parted hair and aviator glasses, Steinem

was the glamorous, hip symbol of the feminist movement, which she emphasized should embrace women of every race.

"If you've suffered discrimination, you're sensitive to it on every level. I learned feminism largely from Black women. Women of color basically invented feminism," she told the New Yorker.

Steinem was born on March 25, 1934, in Toledo, Ohio, the younger of two daughters. Her father was a traveling antique dealer. Because the family moved frequently she did not attend school regularly until about seventh grade.

Her parents separated when she was 11, following which Stei-

nem lived with and took care of her mother, who had a mental breakdown and suffered from depression.

The experience impacted Steinem's views on social injustice and marriage, which she believed robbed women of choices and many of their civil rights.

"I'd already been the very small parent of a very big child, my mother. I didn't want to end up taking care of someone else," she was quoted as saying.

After graduating from Smith College, Steinem began freelancing as a journalist. In 1963, she worked as a Playboy bunny for 11 days for a story for Show magazine. Her two-part groundbreaking expose, "A Bunny's Tale," de-

tailed the poor pay and sexist treatment Playboy bunnies — originally waitstaff — endured. The story was made into a 1985 TV movie starring Kirstie Alley. Steinem was often critical of the limitations of marriage. "Women are not going to be equal outside the home until men are equal in it," she said.

She wrote numerous books, including 1986's "Marilyn: Norma Jean" about Marilyn Monroe, "Revolution from Within: A Book of Self-Esteem" about personal development, and books of essays. Author Carolyn Heilbrun described her as "the epitome of female beauty and the quintessence of female revolution." REUTERS

NO TRANSHIPMENT SHOULD HAPPEN IN INDIA: GOYAL

‘India should avoid becoming a conduit for unethical trade’

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 3

COMMERCE MINISTER Piyush Goyal on Thursday said that India should not become a trade conduit for goods originating from another country and should aim for genuine value addition.

Goyal said that India’s “country of origin” certificates should carry weight.

“No transshipment should happen in India. We should not become a conduit for anything unethical. We should be trusted partners of the world. We don’t want to become like Vietnam, which brings goods from one country and exports to another country after marginal value addition,” Goyal said.

The statement comes on the heels of a US report accusing over 40 countries, including India, of acting as a “shadow transshipment network” designed to hide the true economic origin of goods produced in China.

The White House, as per the report, on August 14 categorised the “shadow network” into three tiers, with countries such as India, Mexico, Canada, and the European Union forming tier 1 where illegal transshipment risk is “embedded” within massive legitimate trade flows. While “closely integrated” countries with China such as Vietnam, Malaysia, and Thailand were categorised as tier 2, smaller economies such as Cambodia, Panama, and the UAE with “weak customs enforcement” were classified as tier 3.

The report claimed that tariff revenue is the most obvious loss from illegal transshipment and that when China-linked goods enter the US through



India should aim for genuine, not marginal, value addition, according to Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal. ANI

third countries, they widen the effective trade deficit, displace domestic production, reduce GDP growth, and lower associated federal tax receipts.

The US has imposed an additional 10% tariff on several countries, including India, from July 24.

Goyal will visit the US in late September to attend the G-20 Trade Ministerial in Milwaukee and hold bilateral talks with USTR Jamieson Greer.

Goyal also said that the details of the Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) with the US will be announced once Washington offers preferential terms compared to the country’s competitors.

He also said that India’s nine free trade agreements (FTAs), spanning economies representing about \$60 trillion of GDP, would provide preferential access to nearly two-thirds of global trade.

He said the other FTAs that India would conclude over the next few months and couple of years, including those with Canada, Mexico, Chile, Mercosur,

SACU (South Africa Customs Union), GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council) and Israel, together with efforts to review ASEAN, Korea and Japan trade deals would give India access to 75% of global trade at a rate lower than its competitors.

India has implemented trade pacts with the UK, Mauritius, Oman, UAE, and Australia.

“(Trade pact with) New Zealand will go live soon and thereafter (FTA with) EU, the 27-nation bloc, will go live. And as soon as the US can give us the preferential rate, in comparison to our competition, we will finalise the BTA and announce the final details,” he said at a workshop on free trade agreements, organised by the commerce ministry.

In February, India and the US announced finalisation of the framework for the first phase of the pact, but changes in the tariff landscape in the US have led to further negotiations between the two countries on the pact.

FULL REPORT ON
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After slow start, IPO mkt comes back to life

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 3

THE INDIAN IPO market has heated up again, with some major issues such as Jio Platforms and National Stock Exchange in the pipeline. After a slowdown earlier in the year, July and August saw many companies finally enter the market, easing some of the “pent-up” demand as market conditions improved.

Companies raised nearly Rs 29,000 crore in August and around Rs 26,500 crore in July through mainboard IPOs, which together accounted for around 73% of the around Rs 75,518 crore raised so far in 2026, according to data compiled from the National Stock Exchange.

Companies scramble as approvals near expiry

The fundraising approvals of many of the companies that had delayed their IPO plans were nearing their expiry, which led to a lot of these companies finally opening their public issues. Experts cited this factor as among the biggest factors behind this renewed vigor seen in the primary market. Notably,

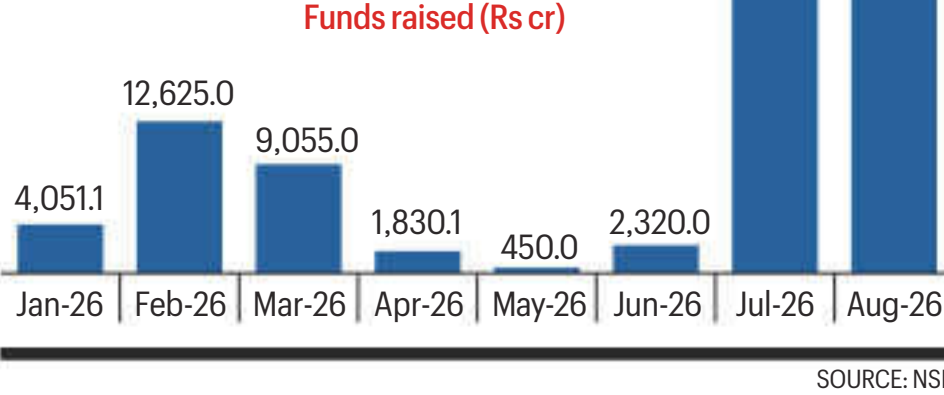
fundraising approvals granted by regulators like SEBI typically last for a period of 12 months.

“The pipeline has always been strong; it’s just that market conditions remain uncertain. But many companies have finally launched their IPOs as approvals near expiry, which is a big factor behind this recent boom,” the head of capital markets at a domestic broking firm said. For example, big issues like Symbiotic Pharmed, dairy company Milkymist, and logistics firm Shiprocket’s approvals were between 8-10 months old when they finally completed their fundraising in August.

In fact, market regulator SEBI had extended the validity of IPO and rights issue approvals expiring between April and September to September 30 in the wake of the West Asia crisis. The relief, which came through back in April, benefited companies like Shiprocket and Symbiotec.

Many such companies had delayed their IPO plans due to the torrid market conditions domestically as the war in West Asia stretched on. Big names like Zepto and PhonePe were among the companies that indefinitely paused their fundrais-

• Mainboard IPOs have picked up over the past couple of months



SOURCE: NSE

ing plans. Companies usually wait for favorable market conditions while raising funds as it maximizes valuations, and such an environment is also likely to provide investors with solid listing-day gains.

However, SBI Funds Management, which completed its public issue in July, saw very high interest from investors due to attractive valuations.

“There has been a huge pent-up supply of issues with companies holding SEBI approval following a wait-and-watch approach for the first half of the year to see how the geopolitical situation plays out. With the added pressure of approvals lapsing, you started seeing companies launching IPOs from July

onwards. Good response and listings have subsequently encouraged more issuers to come forward,” said Pranav Haldea, MD at Prime Database.

Market conditions improve

The benchmark Nifty 50 and Sensex indices had fallen around 14% at their lowest this year, as high crude oil prices, foreign outflows, and a weaker rupee as a result had decimated the Indian market.

However, things have stabilized a bit since then as negative developments from West Asia have become increasingly few and far between, with market participants now focusing more on factors like earnings growth,

inflation, and macroeconomic parameters rather than a longer-term truce between Iran and the US. The Indian stock market had thus recovered 10-11% from its lows and was down just around 5% for the year in early August before another downturn since mid-August minimized the gains. However, the much more stable conditions have encouraged more companies in the pipeline to launch their fundraising plans.

In fact, with the increased momentum over the last couple of months, funds raised through mainboard IPOs so far this year have crossed the Rs 59,360 crore raised by Indian corporates till the same time last year. Notably, 2025 saw record fundraising through IPOs in the Indian market, with most of the momentum coming in the final few months of the year.

While mainboard IPOs have gained pace, IPOs in the small and medium enterprise (SME) segment have remained sluggish as SEBI has consistently tightened the fundraising mechanism for smaller companies for increased investor protection.

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Govt to roll out Bharat NCAP 2.0 from Oct 2027, says Gadkari

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 3

THE GOVERNMENT is planning to roll out a new version of the Bharat NCAP programme from October 2027, which will assess the complete safety framework and address the severe challenge of road accidents in the country, Union Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Thursday.

Addressing the 66th SIAM Annual Convention 2026, the Minister for Road, Transport and Highways also announced another scheme to control emissions from BS IV-compliant vehicles.

The installation of a rare emission control device reduces PM (particulate matter) and NOx significantly, and the cost of the device is Rs 4,000-5,000. “I am going to announce a new scheme for a rare emission

control device. Trials are completed for the device. Emissions after retrofitment on BS 4 vehicles same as BS 6. So this option is there,” he said.

Launched in 2023, Bharat NCAP (Bharat New Car Assessment Program) is India’s official, independent vehicle safety rating system that crash-tests passenger cars and assigns them a rating from 1 to 5 stars. It evaluates how well cars protect adult and child occupants during collisions.

Highlighting the urgency of addressing road accident problem, Gadkari said, “We are moving forward with Bharat NCAP 2. This is a very important programme wherein, from October 2027, the entire safety chain will be evaluated. This is very important because road accidents are a big problem... we are number one in the world”.

• BRIEFLY

Prioritise asset quality over loan growth: RBI DG Murmu to NBFCs

Mumbai: RBI Deputy Governor S C Murmu on Thursday asked non-bank finance companies (NBFCs) to ensure that the acceleration in loan growth does not come at the cost of asset quality concerns. Addressing an event by industry grouping CII here, Murmu asked the non-bank lenders to also focus on other aspects including liquidity management, fair conduct, grievance redressal and responsible lending. “As credit growth speeds up, so does the risk to asset quality... Let me be clear, growth must never come at the cost of underwriting standards,” Murmu said. PTI

Be ready for end of EV subsidies: Heavy Industries Secretary

New Delhi: Government subsidies for electric vehicles will end in the

coming years, and companies need to be prepared for the challenge, a top official said on Thursday. The Indian automobile industry must collaborate to set up charging infrastructure to promote electrification on a larger scale, Kamran Rizvi, Secretary in the Heavy Industries Ministry, said while addressing the annual convention of the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) here. PTI

India’s services activity expands in Aug; PMI

New Delhi: India’s services activity expanded in August, supported by stronger output and new business, even as the overall pace of growth was the second-slowest recorded since March 2022, a monthly survey said on Thursday. The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index rose from 53.3 in July to 54.1 in August, as demand conditions remained supportive and new business inflows continued to rise. PTI

FLY91 orders 40 ATR planes amid govt push for regional connectivity

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 3

GOA-BASED REGIONAL airline FLY91 on Thursday inked an agreement with European turboprop aircraft manufacturer ATR for 40 ATR 72-600 planes. The order, valued at close to \$1 billion at list price, is the largest-ever order for ATR planes from a regional airline anywhere in the world, and its third-largest order overall.

India’s largest airline IndiGo is currently the biggest ATR operator in India, with an operational fleet of 44 turboprops to cater to its regional network. State-owned Alliance Air also operates ATR planes. Speaking at the FLY91-ATR deal signing event, Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu called FLY91 a “success story”, expressing hope that regional aviation in India would pick up notably in the foreseeable future.

FLY91, which started operations about two-and-a-half years ago, currently has a fleet of six aircraft, and this order will be pivotal for the airline to achieve its aim of having over 60 planes in the next few years. Aircraft deliveries from this order are expected to start in



FLY91, which started operations about two-and-a-half years ago, currently has a fleet of six aircraft. FLY91.IN

late-2027, and go up to 2032. The actual order value couldn’t be immediately ascertained; aircraft manufacturers usually offer discounts on large orders.

At present, FLY91 operates about 280 flights a week and has a network of 12 cities. The carrier, which calls itself a pure-play regional airline, expects to ramp up operations significantly to density as well as expand its regional flight network as it inducts more aircraft. The ATR 72-600 seats 70 to 78 passengers, and has a range of about 1,500-1,650 km.

FLY91 has been a bit of an exception in the Indian aviation market that has seen subdued interest in the regional segment with most large carriers focussed on narrow-body

jet operations. A number of regional airlines have fallen by the wayside in India over the years, even as the government has been pushing for enhancing regional air connectivity through initiatives like UDAN. “I see this landmark that we are having today as a very confident message that we are sending to people across stakeholders, across civil aviation (sector) that India’s regional civil aviation is only in the beginning (stage) and we are just starting to grow with great potential,” Naidu said, adding that the next phase of the UDAN scheme will see India adding 100 new airports, a vast majority of which will be in tier 2 and 3 cities.

FULL REPORT ON
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SEBI to review derivatives settlement methodology

Bengaluru: Market regulator the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) said on Thursday it would review the methodology for determining settlement prices of derivatives contracts after receiving feedback on the closing auction session in the equity cash market.

The SEBI had launched the closing auction session on August 3 to determine the closing prices of securities.

But the rollout highlighted issues such as divergent index closing levels across exchanges, volatile options pricing, and concerns over potential manipulation, particularly on days when benchmark derivatives contracts expire.

The regulator said it has received feedback from various stakeholders, and would propose certain changes in the methodology for determining settlement prices of derivative contracts. SEBI would also issue a discussion paper outlining the proposed changes within a week.

Indian equities have seen sharp moves during the newly launched closing auction session, particularly on derivatives expiry days. REUTERS

Why top scientist wants India to move early to thorium fuels

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 3

ONE OF India’s top nuclear scientists, Anil Kakodkar, has advocated introducing thorium-based fuel into the country’s indigenous pressurised heavy water reactor (PHWR) fleet alongside the ongoing three-stage nuclear programme, arguing that this could accelerate the utilisation of India’s abundant thorium reserves and help the country become self-reliant in nuclear fuel.

The commercial acceptability of indigenous PHWRs and plans to deploy around half of India’s targeted 100 gigawatts-electric (GWe) of nuclear capacity through the technology create an opportunity to intro-

duce thorium at an earlier stage, Kakodkar said at the 6th International Climate Summit on Wednesday.

While India’s three-stage nuclear programme remains the preferred route for deploying thorium, the former chairman of Atomic Energy Commission said the key question was whether it could match the pace of the country’s rapidly growing energy requirements over the next 15-25 years.

The three stages

India is following a three-stage nuclear power programme aimed at achieving long-term fuel self-reliance. The first stage is based on PHWRs using natural uranium as

fuel. The plutonium generated in the spent fuel from these reactors is then used in the second stage, comprising fast breeder reactors (FBRs). FBRs initially use plutonium plus depleted uranium to obtain Uranium-233 (U-233) from the Thorium-232 (Th-232), which is used as a blanket in such reactors.

In the third stage, it is Th-232 that will get converted into U-233, which would be fuel for the advanced reactors.

FBRs represent a crucial intermediate step between the first and third stages of India’s nuclear programme, enabling the country to utilise its abundant thorium resources and move towards greater

self-reliance in nuclear fuel.

In April, India’s first indigenous fast breeder reactor at Kalpakkam attained criticality, meaning the reactor fuel can now sustain a fission chain reaction. This marks a major milestone in the country’s civil nuclear programme as it is a step further towards the second stage.

Kakodkar, the Chancellor of the Homi Bhabha National Institute, said thorium was initially envisaged for use in fast breeder reactors because India’s thermal reactor capacity was too small and was not enough to convert enough quantities of uranium. The strategy therefore shifted towards fast breeder reactors, which could eventually scale to hundreds of gigawatts and pro-

vide a much larger platform for irradiating thorium and producing Uranium-233 and to get into large scale energy from thorium, he said.

“Now PHWRs are going up to 50, 60 gigawatts. So I think there is an opportunity to introduce thorium right here,” Kakodkar added. Kakodkar also addressed the question of cost involved in introducing thorium into PHWRs as thorium is a stronger neutron absorber than uranium. “The question is, if we incur a cost, there must be a payback,” he said, adding that thorium should be irradiated in a way that does not increase the cost of electricity from PHWRs or raise their uranium needs.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

32001/786/2627

- Type of Work : Canal & structure Work
- Total No. of Works : 05 Nos.
- Approximate value of work : Rs. 154.48.47 lakhs to Rs 253.72 Lakhs (Excluding GST)
- Tender Paper Cost : Rs. 10,000/- (Online)
- Bid Security/E.M.D : Rs. 2,53,71,791.98 (up to 5.00 PM) (Excluding GST)
- Period of completion : 11 (Eleven Calendar months).
- Class of Contractor : B & A Class

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA DIST: KALAHANDI ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceup1987@gmail.com/loujibbsr@gmail.com

Procurement Officer	e-procurement Notice No.	Bid Amount	Availability of online viewing of Tender prior to Bidding		Period for seeking tender clarification	Submission & Availability of opening bid on-line	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid
			From	To			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT, AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA, DIST: KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN-766026.	CCE, UIP-04(05)/2026-27, Dt. 29.08.2026	Rs. 1,54,48,304.14 To Rs. 2,53,71,791.98 (Excluding GST)	08.09.2026 (10.00 AM)	23.09.2026 (up to 5.00 PM)	17.09.2026 to 19.09.2026 during office hours.	08.09.2026 (10.00 AM) to 23.09.2026 (up to 5.00PM)	

Date of opening of technical bid - Dt. 24.09.2026 at 11.00 AM in the O/O the Chief Construction Engineer, UIP Mukhiguda, Kalahandi, Odisha, PIN-766026
Date of opening of financial bid - To be decided after finalization of Technical Bid.
For details can be seen from the Govt. Website www.tendersorissa.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda
OIPR-32001/32352/1/26-27/0066

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• ECONOMICS

Perils of comparing GDP from different base years



UDIT MISRA

ON MONDAY, the last day of August as is the norm, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the data for India's economic output in the first quarter of the current financial year (or Q1, covering April, May and June).

At the beginning of this quarter, the world was in the middle of the West Asia war. Its disruptive effects across the world prompted analysts to dial down growth expectations.

India's growth, in particular, was expected to slow down because of its heavy dependence on imports from West Asia for its energy needs.

As the weeks went by, however, data from different sectors showed that the Indian economy continued to grow at a faster than expected rate. By the time the first quarter ended in June, most economists expected a growth rate of around 7.5%. That is, the total economic output produced in the country in these three months was expected to grow by 7.5% over what it was in the same three months in 2025. Some expected the growth rate to be even higher, around 7.8%.

Last week, we explained why the Q1 growth rate was likely to be 7.8% — far better than most expectations at the start of the quarter. It also provided reasons for caution before leaping to any conclusion that India has yet again entered a “Goldilocks” (optimal) phase.

As it turned out, the official data for Q1 showed that India's gross domestic product (GDP) indeed grew by 7.8% in real terms and 10.3% in nominal terms; the difference between the two types of GDP is the effect of inflation.

Base year change

It is crucial to understand that on February 27 this year — and this date is important to note — MoSPI had unveiled a new series of GDP data after changing the “base

• ECONOMY'S SIZE AS PER OLD AND NEW BASE YEARS

Table 1: Nominal GDP in Q1

PERIOD	GDP	DATE	NOTE
2025-26 Q1 (old series)	₹86.1 trillion	Aug 29, 2025	Quarterly GDP
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹80.3 trillion	Feb 27, 2026	Second advance estimates for the full financial year
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹80.4 trillion	Jun 5, 2026	Provisional estimates of the full financial year
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹80.0 trillion	Aug 31, 2026	Quarterly GDP
2026-27 Q1 (new series)	₹88.3 trillion	Aug 31, 2026	Quarterly GDP

Nominal GDP growth rate (derived from the last two rows): **10.3%**

Table 2: Real GDP in Q1

PERIOD	GDP	DATE	NOTE
2025-26 Q1 (old series)	₹47.9 trillion	Aug 29, 2025	Quarterly GDP
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹75.3 trillion	Feb 27, 2026	Second advance estimates for the full financial year
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹75.4 trillion	Jun 5, 2026	Provisional estimates of the full financial year
2025-26 Q1 (new series)	₹75.5 trillion	Aug 31, 2026	Quarterly GDP
2026-27 Q1 (new series)	₹81.4 trillion	Aug 31, 2026	Quarterly GDP

Real GDP growth rate (derived from the last two rows): **7.80%**

NOTES: NOMINAL GDP IS NOT ADJUSTED FOR INFLATION. REAL GDP IS DERIVED AFTER REMOVING THE EFFECT OF INFLATION. Q1 REFERS TO THE FIRST QUARTER OF THE FINANCIAL YEAR (APRIL-JUNE); OLD SERIES REFERS TO THE 2011-12 BASE YEAR AND NEW SERIES REFERS TO THE 2022-23 BASE YEAR

year” from 2011-12 to 2022-23. Every economy undergoes base year revisions regularly. It is mostly done once every five years. But in the recent past, the revision was long-pending. In fact, the lack of a base year revision was one big reason why India's GDP was losing credibility.

A base year provides an opportunity for the government to incorporate new data sources, improve methodology and capture data more accurately about an economy that can change substantially over time.

When the base year was changed, MoSPI rolled back the GDP in a significant manner. For instance, the nominal GDP for 2025-26 was revised from Rs 357 trillion (in the old series with the base year of 2011-12) to Rs 345 trillion (in the new series with the base year of 2022-23).

The controversy

The latest GDP growth rate has sparked controversy after former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg claimed that the GDP for Q1 of 2025 had been revised downward in order to show a good growth rate in

Q1 of 2026.

In fact, he singled out the nominal GDP growth rate of 10.3% and said that if the growth rate was calculated on the basis of the Q1 GDP based on the old series (with the base year of 2011-12) then it would be just 2.6% growth.

This is not the first time someone who has held a senior position in this government has questioned the GDP calculations. Nor is it the first that GDP estimates have been criticised. In the past, even the International Monetary Fund has raised issues with India's national income estimates.

Garg's claim raises two central queries:

- One, did the government revise down the Q1 estimates of 2025 just to show that Q1 estimates of 2026 look impressive?
- Two, is it correct to calculate the growth rate by taking the GDP for Q1 of 2026 from one data series and that of Q1 of 2025 from another data series?

The answer

The short answer to both the questions is no. But here's the explanation.

Why base years are revised

Every economy undergoes regular base year revisions.

- A base year provides an opportunity for the government to incorporate new data sources, improve methodology and capture data more accurately.

• SCIENCE

How Roman telescope can help decode universe's mysteries

Anjali Marar

Bengaluru, September 3

NASA ON Sunday (August 30) launched a powerful, next-generation space telescope that can search for clues for some of the universe's deepest mysteries, including mysterious phenomena such as dark matter and dark energy. The telescope, launched on a SpaceX rocket, is named after the late Nancy Grace Roman — known as the “mother of Hubble” owing to her role in the creation of the Hubble Space Telescope, which has been operating since 1990.

What will the telescope do?

In terms of scientific capabilities, the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope lies between the Hubble Space Telescope and the James Webb Telescope, which was launched in 2021. It will be able to scan vast swathes of the cosmos and may provide new insights about exoplanets, dark matter and dark energy.

EXOPLANETS: These are planets located outside our solar system and are often found orbiting a star or a “remnant star” (the remains of a star that has burnt out).

So far, more than 6,000 exoplanets have been identified. The Roman Space Telescope may be able to identify many more. This search for exoplanets could eventually

help us answer that tantalising question: Are we alone in the universe?

DARK MATTER AND DARK ENERGY: Scientists estimate that ordinary matter makes up only about 5% of the universe. The rest is composed of little-understood phenomena called dark matter and dark energy.

Scientists believe that dark matter, which makes up about 27% of the universe, is an invisible glue that holds galaxies together. On the other hand, dark energy, estimated to make up around 68% of the universe, is believed to be a repulsive force that has expedited the universe's expansion since the Big Bang. This telescope will conduct the most detailed dark matter studies ever, potentially helping map how it is structured and distributed throughout the cosmos, especially during the process of early star birth.

Besides this, this telescope will help measure how gravity subtly bends the path of light across vast distances (a phenomenon known as gravitational lensing).

The Roman telescope will, therefore, provide a three-dimensional map of the distribution of galaxies and galaxy clusters across the universe.

How does it work?

The Roman Space Telescope, weighing about 8,000 kgs and about the size of a tour bus, will operate from the Lagrange Point

Who was Nancy Grace Roman?

● Born in 1925, Roman was NASA's first chief astronomer and made key contributions to space-based telescopes at a time when ground-based ones were preferred. She died in 2018.

● Roman was deeply involved in NASA's Great Observatories programme: Hubble Space Telescope, Chandra X-ray Observatory, Compton Gamma Ray Observatory, Spitzer Space Telescope. All these took astronomy to new heights



A SpaceX rocket carries the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope. NASA/X

2 — a vantage point between Earth and Sun located 1.2 million km from Earth.

At this point, the gravity from the Sun and Earth works together with an object's motion around the Sun. This can help the Roman telescope remain steady. Lagrange Point 2 also offers stable optical performance and an unobstructed view of the universe for imaging. The James Webb Telescope operates from this zone.

It has two major instruments on board: **WIDE FIELD INSTRUMENT:** This is a 300-megapixel infrared camera that can capture a patch of the sky about 1.5 times bigger

than the apparent size of a full Moon. The telescope can also process images 1,000 times faster than the Hubble telescope.

CORONAGRAPH: Just like humans cannot look directly into the sun but can see its rounded rim with the help of goggles/protective shields, astronomers use coronagraphs to mask the extreme bright light emitted by celestial bodies to study their surroundings. The Roman Telescope will deploy one of the most advanced coronagraphs that will block the glare from stars and help scientists to see the faint reflected light from planets around them.

• POLICY

Inside Jharkhand & Bihar's 25-year Sone river dispute

Santosh Singh

Patna, September 3

THE 25-YEAR-OLD dispute between Bihar and Jharkhand over the sharing of Sone river water was resolved on Monday with the signing of an inter-state memorandum of understanding under which Bihar will receive 5.75 million acre-feet (MAF) and Jharkhand 2 MAF of water. The agreement is expected to pave the way for long-delayed irrigation, reservoir and river-linking projects in drought-prone regions of both states.

What is the history of the Sone river dispute?

The Sone flows generally northward from its upper catchments in Madhya Pradesh, passing through Uttar Pradesh and along the Jharkhand-Bihar boundary before joining the Ganga in Bihar (*see map*). In November 2000, when Jharkhand was carved out of Bihar, the new state inherited the major upper catchment areas and tributaries while lower riparian agricultural hubs remained in Bihar.

But the core of the dispute traces back to the 1973 Ban-sagar Agreement, a tripartite agreement involving Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, under which undivided Bihar was allocated 7.75 MAF of Sone water out of the total basin yield. After Bihar's division, no binding formula existed to split that 7.75 MAF allocation between Bihar and the newly formed state of Jharkhand.

While various committees attempted mediation over the last two decades, talks repeatedly stalled over reservoir height, land submergence, and volumetric splits.

How did the two states arrive at a consensus?

Under the pact, the two states agreed that Bihar will receive 5.75 MAF of Sone water while Jharkhand will receive 2 MAF. The agreement clears the path for the full operation of the Indrapuri Barrage (also called the Indrapuri Dam or Sone Barrage, *see map below*) across the Sone river in Rohtas district. Built in the late 1960s, the barrage serves as a primary diversion structure supplying water to the extensive Sone canal network, which irrigates the surrounding Shahabad agricultural belt (Rohtas, Bhojpur, Buxar, and Kaimur districts). Following the pact, Bihar will receive additional water from the barrage to irrigate local farmland. In turn, Jharkhand agreed to specified reservoir water levels to minimise land submergence, backed by clear rehabilitation provisions.

The pact guarantees critical irrigation supplies to the Magadh belt in south Bihar (Rohtas, Bhojpur, and Auran-gabad) while enabling new canal networks in the drought-prone Palamu and Garhwa districts of Jharkhand.

Did the dispute create political tensions?

While there were no major state-level confrontations, the water dispute frequently surfaced as a political issue during election seasons — particularly in Bihar's Shahabad region and Jharkhand's Palamu region. Leaders across party lines in Bihar's Shahabad and Magadh belts routinely targeted the state government over water shortages in the Sone canal system during the summer sowing season. Meanwhile, Jharkhand leaders from the Palamu and Garhwa regions raised concerns over displacement, fearing that increasing the Indrapuri Dam's height would submerge local agricultural land and displace thousands without fair compensation.



• HISTORY

In Gloria Steinem's legacy, the debate over many waves of feminist movements

Rishika Singh

New Delhi, September 3

GLORIA STEINEM, among the most well-known feminist activists of the 20th century, died on Thursday at 92.

Steinem was a pioneering figure of the Second Wave of the Feminist Movement of the 1960s and '70s, which saw women fight for rights in the workplace and in making reproductive choices. It followed First Wave feminists of the late 19th century who waged the struggle for voting rights — a key step towards being considered full citizens. The Second Wave broadened the fight to areas seen as strictly part of private life until then, such as reproduction and jobs.

Coming from humble beginnings, Steinem went on to work as a journalist and even went undercover as a *Playboy* employee to reveal the exploitative inner workings of clubs run by the men's entertainment enterprise. She also visited India in 1957 in her early 20s as part of a fellowship at Miranda House, the women's college in Delhi University, Dr Bijayalaxmi

Nanda, principal at Miranda House and a professor of political science, told *The Indian Express*: “She brought out the first women's magazine in the US on her own, and she remains an iconic figure for her work. Steinem was grounded and committed to causes such as anti-child trafficking in India and her feminist criticism of pornography — all of that is still relevant.”

Waves of feminism

Steinem grew up when women in the US lacked legal safeguards in public life. By the 1960s, however, the tide was turning, and civil rights movements — including for women and Black Americans — emerged.

One prominent figure was Betty Friedan, who wrote *The Feminine Mystique* in 1963, identifying women's desire to go beyond the domestic sphere: “We can no longer ignore that voice within women that says: ‘I want something more than my husband and my children and my home.’”

Nanda said: “Steinem and her longtime collaborator in India, Devaki Jain, were openly Second-Wave feminists. Their focus



A 1970 photograph of Gloria Steinem. AP

was on women gaining rights in the public sphere, and they would question the public-private divide to stress the value of reproductive rights and other concerns.”

Women's associations led by the likes of Steinem, and writings such as those of Friedan's, helped shift the momentum. The decade saw landmark laws, such as the Equal Pay Act of 1963, which banned discrimination based on sex for doing the same work. The Civil Rights Act of 1964 prohibited employment discrimination based on race, colour, religion, sex and national origin.

Later court rulings also focused on rights such as access to contraception, allowing women to better plan their careers. The US Supreme Court's *Roe v. Wade* judgment of 1973 gave women the constitutional right to abortion.

Steinem was a vocal advocate for women in public life, challenging gender-based stereotypes. In a satirical article for her Ms. magazine titled ‘If Men Could Menstruate’, she wrote: “What would happen, for instance, if suddenly, magically, men could menstruate and women could not? The answer is clear — menstruation would become an enviable, boast-worthy, masculine event.”

Her larger argument was that “charac-

teristics of the powerful, whatever they may be, are thought to be better than the characteristics of the powerless — and logic has nothing to do with it”.

Criticism and legacy

Not everyone agreed with Second-Wave feminists' approach. As the movement arose at a time when Black women were fighting for more basic rights, they faced a double burden that the white women-led movement was not acknowledging.

These gaps became the focus of the Third Wave of Feminism in the '90s. Lawyer and scholar Kimberlé Crenshaw developed the concept of “intersectionality”, which explored how overlapping identities, such as race, class, gender, sexuality, or caste in the case of India, influence people's social experiences. This led to broader awareness about harassment in the workplace. The Fourth Wave, in the 2010s, built on these gains (the #MeToo movement being a major example) and widened the scope to LGBTQ+ identities.

Steinem visited India again in the early

2010s. In an interview, she recognised the role caste played alongside gender, comparing it to race in the US, and reflecting an evolving understanding of intersectionality. “A major reason that women of the powerful group are restricted and women of the less powerful group exploited is to keep the visible differences of race or caste alive. They can only be uprooted together,” she said.

Second Wave feminists also often put gender in binary terms — man and woman. “Steinem felt the binary was important in order to be able to speak for women. It's like a strategic essentialism. While she was open to understanding intersectionality, I think she said that to bring about an understanding of reproductive rights and policy change, we have to look at gender as a critical category,” Nanda said.

This approach was later criticised for leaving out transgender women. “Feminists have always disagreed with each other. New issues may have emerged, like on LGBTQ+ rights, but while agreeing to be more dynamic, it is important to recognise what we have built on,” Nanda said.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vicky Taank S/o Dinesh Taank R/o H.No. WZ-369, 1st Floor, 80 Gaj Harijan Colony, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 80053716/2024, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vicky Taank** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vicky Taank** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Vicky Taank** the said accused of **FIR No. 80053716/2024, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
(West), Court No. 289,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12459/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Mohd. Sahil S/o Mohd. Zahid R/o H. No. E-84/146, Chitra Vihar, Preet Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 266/2025, U/s 115(2)/126(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sahil** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sahil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sahil** of case **FIR No. 266/2025, U/s 115(2)/126(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **17.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
2nd Floor, Room No. 07
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12398/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sumit @ Kallu S/o Virender R/o OBC Bank Wali Gali, Village-Khera Kalan, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 167/18, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sumit @ Kallu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sumit @ Kallu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sumit @ Kallu** the said accused of **FIR No. 167/18, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
(North), Court No. 06, Ground Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12491/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT, ROAD DIVISION, GUMLA

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

e-Tender Reference No. RCD/GUMLA/665 Date :- 02.09.2026

1. Name of the work	Widening & Strengthening of Ghaghra to Jokari Road via Ran he, Kundo, Rukighat (Bishunpur) (Total Length-19.10 KM) Under Road Division Gumla.
2. Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs.-81,59,65,897.00 (Rs. Eighty One Crore Fifty Nine lakh Sixty five thousand Eight hundred Ninety Seven) Only.
3. Bid Security (Rs in Lakh)	81.60 Lakh
4. Time of Completion	16 Months
5. Date of Publication of Tender on website	11.09.2026 From 10:30 A.M.
6. Date, Time and Place of Pre-Bid meeting	15.09.2026 at 11:00 AM Chief Engineer (Com) cum-Nodal Officer, e-Procurement Cell, RCD,Jharkhand,1 st Floor, Engineer's, Hostel No.-02,Dhurwa,Ranchi-834004
7. Start Date/Time for receipt of bids	16.09.2026 From 10:30 AM
8. Last Date/Time for receipt of bids	14.10.2026 Up to 12:00 Noon
9. Opening Date of Tender	16.10.2026 From 12.30 PM
10. Place of Opening Tender	Chairman, e-Procurement Cell, RCD, Jharkhand, 3 rd Floor, Project Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
11. Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Road Construction Department, Road Division, Gumla.
12. E-mail	eeecdgmula-jhr@nic.in
13. Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	0651-2401010

1. Tender amount can be increased or decreased.
2. Details can be seen on website <https://jhrkhandtenders.gov.in>
By Order
Executive Engineer,
RCD, Road Division, Gumla.

PR 388975 (Road) 26-27 (D)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Jitender Kumar, S/o- Sompal, R/o-T-563/CA5, Gali No.-3, Baljeet Nagar, Delhi Also At: T-318, 1st Floor, Balmiki Mandir, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar, Delhi**. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 651/16 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitender Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jitender Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 651/16 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Pooja Talwar
ASJ (FTC)-01, Room No 313,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12501/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Salman, S/o Saleem, R/o 20/24, Okhla Vihar, Johri Farm, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 222/16, U/s 356/379 IPC, P.S. Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Salman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Salman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Salman** accused of **FIR No. 222/16, U/s 356/379 IPC, P.S. Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Divyam Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, South-East
DP/12429/SE/2026 Room No. 508, Saket Courts, New Delhi

Directorate of Agriculture, Jharkhand
Department of Agriculture, Animal Husbandry & Cooperative, Government of Jharkhand
Krishi Bhawan, Kanke Road, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834008
Email:directoragriculturejh@gmail.com
Phone No. -0651-2230691

Tender- Notice
e-Tender No/ RFP No.-3559 Ranchi, Date :02.09.2026
E-tender in two parts Part-I (Technical and Commercial) and Part-II (Price part) is invited from the Tenderers.

Sl.No.	Particular	Details
1.	Name of the Department	Department of Agriculture, Animal Husbandry and Co-operative, Government of Jharkhand
2.	Name of Service	Notice Inviting Request for Empancment (RFE) for Rate Contract for the Supply of DNM/IPM Inputs for Augmenting the Production and Productivity of Various: Agricultural Crops, viz. Cereals, Pulses, and Oilseeds, for a Period of Two (02) Years (2026-2028).
3.	Method of Selection	Empancment through the Least Cost Selection (LCS) Method under a Two-Packet Bid System for Package- 2,3,4 &5. Empancment through the Least Cost Selection (LCS) Method with Reverse Auction under a Two-Packet Bid System for Package-1.
4.	Name of Package & Estimated Value (Package 1-5)	Package-1 Dolomite 5 crore Package-2 Micronutrients 5 crore Package-3 Bio-Fertilizers 4 crore Package-4 Organic Fertilizer, Urea & DAP 4 crore Package-5 IPM Inputs 6 crore
5.	NIT Publication & RFP Availability	Newspaper: 08.09.2026; e-Procurement Portal & sameti.org website: 08.09.2026
6.	Pre-Bid Query Closing Date	Email:directoragriculturejh@gmail.com; Deadline: As per Portal
7.	Pre-Bid Meeting Date (Hybrid)	16-09-2026 & Link: at sameti.org; Meeting Time 3:00 PM
8.	Last Date for submission of Bid	26-09-2026 or as per e-procurement portal & sameti.org
9.	Technical Bid Opening Date	28-09-2026 or as per e-procurement portal & sameti.org
10.	Financial Bid Opening Date	30-09-2026 or as per e-procurement portal & sameti.org
11.	Bid Processing Fee	Not Applicable.
12.	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Refundable)	2% of the estimated cost of the respective package, e-Procurement Portal (https://jhrkhandtenders.gov.in)
13.	Electronic- Performance Bank Guarantee (E-PBG) (Refundable)	5% of the estimated value of the items awarded to selected bidder.
14.	Tender Inviting Authority & Address for Communication	Director, Directorate of Agriculture, Krishi Bhawan, Kanke, Ranchi Jharkhand, 834008
15.	Mode of Submission of Proposal	Online through portal https://jhrkhandtenders.gov.in only
16.	Duration of Contract	Two years from the date of contract
17.	Contact Details	Shri Prem Bhagat, Section officer, Ph.no. 9973228776

- The Bid Inviting Authority reserves the right to adopt either empanelment or selection of the Lowest Responsive Bidder (LI), as approved by the Competent Authority.
- The Department of Agriculture, Jharkhand reserves the right to cancel this RFP and/or invite fresh bids, with or without amendments, without assigning any reason or liability.
- No minimum quantity is guaranteed under this RFP/Rate Contract.
- All corrigenda, amendments, and notifications, if any, shall be published only on the Jharkhand e-Procurement Portal and the SAMETI website.

PR 388943 Agriculture (26-27)_D Bidyanand Sharma Pankaj, IAS
Director Agriculture, Jharkhand, Ranchi



The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
 (OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)



TENDER NOTICE
E-tenders are Re-invited for the supply of following item.
 (1) 82101 - 11KV/415 VOLTS, 2000 KVA and 2500 KVA Single Ratio, Synthetic Ester Oil Filled, KNAN Type Distribution Transformers, (2) 82116 - Tender for Supply of 250 kVA & 500 kVA Truck Mounted Diesel Generator Sets along with Accessories and 5 years Non-Comprehensive AMC.

Note: For more details, log on to website <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

PRO/AAM(M)/62/2026 GENERAL MANAGER

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Jasmeet Singh S/o Manjeet Singh R/o H.No. 09, 4th Avenue Band Road, Gadaipur, Delhi**, (2) **Maninder Dhingra S/o Raghur Singh R/o M-5, New Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi**, (3) **Jatin Dhingra S/o Lt. Sh. Manish Kumar Dhingra R/o 46, L-Block, Saraswati Garden,Flamesh Nagar, Delhi**, (4) **Saurabh Dhingra S/o Lt. Sh. Manish Kumar Dhingra R/o E-21, 3rd Floor, Kirti Nagar, Delhi** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 128/2026 U/S 74/75/76/46/351(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita at Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the **above said accused** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the **above said accused** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the (1) **Jasmeet Singh** (2) **Maninder Dhingra** (3) **Jatin Dhingra** (4) **Saurabh Dhingra** of **FIR No. 128/2026 U/S 74/75/76/46/351(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita at Hari Nagar, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Moksha Bains,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II (West),
Court No. 31,
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi.

DP/12450/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Himanshu Sharma S/o Jitender Sharma R/o J-317, JJ Colony, Shakurpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 202/2020 U/s 188 IPC PS Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Himanshu Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Himanshu Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Himanshu Sharma** accused of **FIR No. 202/2020 U/s 188 IPC PS Subhash Place, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Upasana Satija
CJM, Room No. 108 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12389/NW/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Dated: 01.09.2026

Senior Divisional Commercial, North Central Railway, Prayagraj in terms of Railway Board letter no.2022/TC(FM)/10/04, Date 13.06.2022 (FM No. 11 of 2022) invites bids through E-Auction module of IREPS for leasing contract 02 years for leasing of parcel space (SLRs & VPs) in the following trains originating from various station of Prayagraj Division.

Parking		Period	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time			
Parking Stand at Prayagraj Junction Railway Station (City Side).		03 Months	PRYJ-MX-PRKG-26	09.09.2026 at 11.00 hrs			
Pay&Use Toilet		Period	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time			
Pay& Use Toilet Block (O&M Basis) at 2nd Class Waiting Hall of Aligarh Railway Station.		03 Years	PNU-ALJN-TOI26	15.09.2026 at 12.00 hrs			
S. N.	Comptt.	Train No.	CC (In tones)	From-To	Frequency (In a week)	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1	FSLR	12275	3.9	PRYJ-NDLS	03 days	PRYJ-PRCL-26-08	09.09.2026 at 11.30 hrs
2	FSLR	20433	3.9	SFG-SVDK	07 days	PRYJ-PRCL-26-08	09.09.2026 at 11.30 hrs
3	FSLR	12033	3.9	CNB-NDLS	03 days	PRYJ-PRCL-26-08	09.09.2026 at 11.30 hrs

Interested bidders may please visit official website for e-auctioning i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for further details and participating in e-Aucti on to be held during 09 August 2026 to 15 August 2026. **Important note: 1.** Bidders, who wish to participate in the e-auction module should have valid Digital Signing Certificate (DSC) and same may be procured form any of certifying authority of controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA) Government of India, details of same may be obtained from www.cca.gov.in 2. Prospective bidders will be required to get themselves registered online at IREPS(Commercial Auction Module) 3.One time registration fee of Rs. 10000.00/- and applicable GST(non-refundable) will be required to be paid online by the entity before participating in any commercial auction. 4.For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding this e-Auction, Interested bidders are advised to visit <http://www.ireps.gov.in/epsn/jsp/common/learningCenter.jsp> 5. Earning Money Deposit (EMD): 5% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction. EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. 6. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute right to short terminate these contracts any point of time (or for taking any decision) depending upon the continuation/discontinuation of these trains or commencement of new train services. 7. The successful bidder may have to pay applicable terminal Development Charges and any other charges levied by the Railway Administration over and above the lump sum leased freight for parcel space. 8. The successful bidder will also have to pay applicable GST as imposed from time to time for transportation of goods/parcels over and above the lump sum leased freight for parcel space and applicable Terminal Development Charge 2015/26 (D)

 North central railways
  @ CPONCR
  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
 (A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
 Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358
 Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwal Road, Dehradun-248001
 Telephone-0135-2763672-76, Fax No.0135-2760289 Website: www.uktdenders.gov.in

No. 686/EE(CM)/UPCLA-2 Date :- 03.09.2026

CORRIGENDUM TO E-TENDER NOTICE
Following e-tenders invited previously by this office is hereby extended due to unavoidable reason as under: -

Tender Specification No.	Name of Item/Work	Last Date of submission of tender in online & off line mode	Date of opening of Part-4 of tender in online, & off line mode
CCP-II/4/2026-2027	Design, fabrication, supply, erection, testing and commissioning of 33kV D/C overhead Line using lattice towers from Sonprayag to Sri Kedarnath JI (15 Km.)	15.09.2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	16.09.2026 at 15:30hrs.
CCP-II/9/2026-2027	33/4kV, 1000KVA, BIS Mark EEL-2 (New) Copper Wound Distribution Transformer	15.09.2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	16.09.2026 at 15:45hrs.

Other terms and conditions will remain same as per original tender notice. For further details, please visit our website www.uktdenders.gov.in.

Superintending Engineer
Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)

"Save Electricity in the Interest of the Nation" Use LED Bulb to save Electricity. (Toll Free -1912) "Pay Electricity bill online 24 x 7 from www.upcl.org." (For information on Electricity Theft, informer may report to Toll Free No. 1800 180 4185/Fax : 0135-2760911)



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF PHARMACY PERMITTER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	02.09.2026 24.09.2026	3,50,000/-	www.hemcd.org.in	0925299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF PHARMACY PERMITTER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	02.09.2026 24.09.2026	7,00,00,000/-	www.hemcd.org.in	0925299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48925/HR



Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location : Replacement of G-Jumper & PG Clamps in GZB-SRE & SPR section.
2	Approx. Cost of work : Rs. 49.96,730.00/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit : Rs. 99,900/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period : 14.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 28.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time : 28.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation : 07041032
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in

No.: 24A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 01.09.2026 3036/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रॉंची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-नीलिमा लकड़ा, उम्र-17 वर्ष, उँचाई-4 फीट 6 ईंच, रंग-गोरा, पहनावा-काला रंग का नाईट ड्रेस एवं हाफ ट्राउजर पहनी हुई है। उपरोक्त लापता लड़की नीलिमा लकड़ा, उम्र-17 वर्ष, पिता-थोमस लकड़ा, पता-चतमा टोली, हेसला, बेडा, थाना-अनगड़ा, जिला-रॉंची जो दिनांक-25.08.2026 को अपने घर से बरीर बताए कहीं चली गईं जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिसके संबंध में जगरनाथपुर थाना काण्ड सं0-248 / 2026, दिनांक-26.08.2026, धारा-137(2) बी0एन0एस0 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता लड़की कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolic.gov.in)
पुलिस उपअधीक्षक, हटिया, रॉंची। -9431706143
थाना प्रभारी, जगरनाथपुर, रॉंची। -9431706169
आवेदक थोमस लकड़ा। -7488100725

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, रॉंची

PR 389058 Police(26-27)#D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rekha W/o Akbar R/o Near Wine Shop Shastri Park, Delhi Also at: Raj Nagar, PS-Behrampur, Distt.-Maidan, Kolkata, West Bengal**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 10/2014, U/S 4/5/8 ITP Act, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rekha** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rekha** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Rekha** the said accused of **FIR No. 10/2014, U/S 4/5/8 ITP Act, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
DP/12523/SHD/2026 Shahdara Distt., Room No.-54, 2nd Floor,
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

IN THE COURT OF THE CIVIL JUDGE (Sr. Div.) No. 2, KAMRUP (M), GUWAHATI
Title Suit No. 282 of 2023
C NINE FOOD PRODUCTS PVT.LTD. ...Plaintiff
-Versus-
M/s. Collectivo Oils Pvt. Ltd. ...Defendant

To, M/s. Collectivo Oils Pvt. Ltd., A Private Limited company incorporated under in Companies Act, having its Registered office at 2703, Gali Pattey Wali, Gopal Bhawan, Naya Bazar, New Delhi-110006 and working office at CSP No.409, Fourth Floor, Block-3, DLF Capital, Greens Shivaji Marg, New Delhi-110015.



PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/liquidation notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **01 October 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful, and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrowers for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of Deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. Auction Center No.	CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No. of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 01-09-2026	Weight (grams)
1	Shyam Nagar- New Delhi	Sangeeta Babbar	07861896	003	76,79,029.34	734.41

For more details/account wise information borrowers/interested bidders may contact respective branches and for participating in the auction

NCT OF DELHI | 04.09.2026

Sd/- Authorized Officer, CSB Bank



PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/liquidation notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **15 September 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful, and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrowers for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. Auction Center No.	CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No. of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 01.09.2026	Weight (grams)
1	Bhajanpura- New Delhi	Lalit	10167435	001	2,59,402.26	30.47

For more details/account wise information borrowers/interested bidders may contact respective branches and for participating in the auction

NCT OF DELHI | 04.09.2026

Sd/- AUTHORIZED OFFICER, CSB BANK



Information Security Department, State Bank of India, Global IT-Centre, Sec-11, CBD Belpur, Navi Mumbai-400 614

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Ref: SBI/GITC/SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTRE/2026/2027/1488

Dated: 04.09.2026

State Bank of India (SBI) has issued Request for Proposal (RFP) notice for Annual Maintenance Contract for SOC Tools & Services. For details, please visit "Procurement News" at <https://sbi.bank.in> and e-tender portal (<https://etender.sbi/sbi>). Eligible bidders, based on the criteria in the RFP notice, may obtain the full RFP upon payment of the tender fees from 04.09.2026 to 21.09.2026, 03:00PM.

Last date and time for bid submission by the eligible bidders: 25.09.2026, 05:00PM.

Place: Navi Mumbai

Dy. General Manager (SOC)
Information Security Department

Date: 04.09.2026

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
P.M.G.S.Y. CIRCLE, P.W.D., BAREILLY

Letter no: 3213/34 चवन (Non EPC)/2026

Dated: 25.08.2026

E-Tender Notice Inviting Notice/Short Term Tender

On behalf of Her excellency the Governor of Uttar Pradesh, the Superintending Engineer, PMGSY Circle, Public Works Department (PWD), Bareilly, invites online tenders (via <http://etender.up.nic.in>) for the following work on a Percentage Rate basis. These tenders are to be submitted between 10.09.2026, and 12.00 PM on 25.09.2026 as per condition of Comprehensive Bidding Document (C.B.D.) with the prevailing CBD norms by contractors registered in 'Class A' for building construction works within the Uttar Pradesh Public Works Department, or by contractors registered for building construction works with any State Government/Central Government Department or any Semi-Government/Public Sector Undertaking. The Technical Bid for the work will be opened on 25.09.2026, at 12:30 PM. In the event that the office remains closed on the scheduled date for opening tenders for any reason, said tenders shall be opened online on the next working day; the time of opening and the validity period of the tenders shall remain unchanged. The time and date for opening the online Financial Bids will be notified on the website at a later stage.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Document (in Rs.)	Period of completion (in days including rainy season)	Eligible Registration Category of Contractor/ Firm	Name of Division
1	Construction of Residential/ Non-residential Buildings for fire station (02-unit) in Bisauli Tehsil, Budaun District (including civil and electrical /mechanical works).	1110.00	21.10	Tender Fee – Rs. 2,354.00 (Rs. 2,000.00 Stationery Fee + Rs. 300.00 Tender Form Fee + Rs. 54.00 GST)	18 Month	A (Building only)	Executive Engineer, C.D. Building, PWD, Bareilly

1. Payment of the Earnest Money Deposit and the Tender Document Fee must be made via Internet Banking.

2. The terms, conditions, and details related to the tender will be available on the website <http://etender.up.nic.in>.

3. All terms and conditions of the CBD (Comprehensive Bidding Document) shall be applicable to the Bidder.

(ABDUL SATTAR)
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
CONSTRUCTION
DIVISION, BUILDING,
PWD, BAREILLY

UPID-255314 Dt. 02.09.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(MEGH PRAKASH)
SUPERINTENDING
ENGINEER P.M.G.S.Y.
CIRCLE, PWD,
BAREILLY

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
बरेली वृत्त लोन्निंवि०, बरेली

पत्रांक: 7925/141सी० (ई० टेण्डर)-३/26

दिनांक: 25.08.2026

ऑन-लाइन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

1-महागिरि रायगढ़, उ०प्र० की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, बरेली वृत्त, लोन्निंवि०, बरेली के अंतर्गत निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार ऑन लाइन ई-निविदा दिनांक 07.09.2026 से दिनांक 15.09.2026 की अपरान्ह 12:00 बजे तक आमंत्रित कर दिनांक 15.09.2026 की ही अपरान्ह 12.30 बजे खोला जाना प्रस्तावित किया गया है:-

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	खाइ का नाम	लागत	05 वर्ष अनुक्षण की लागत (रु० लाख में)	कुल लागत (रु० लाख में)	धरोहर धराशि (रु० लाख में)	निविदा पर का मूल्य (निविदा शुल्क-स्टेशनरी-जीएसटी० (रु० में)	एवं पूर्ण पानता करने की अवधि	टेंडरकारों की पानता श्रेणी (मांग कार्य हेतु)
1	ग्राम भौखंडा बुजुर्ग (भौखंडा जगिनगा) के पश्चिम बाईसाह सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)	ग्रामीय खण्ड, लोन्निंवि०, शाहजहापुर	111.30	2.69	113.99	7.70	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
2	मोहदनीपुर से जवलीया होते हुये र्दिवृती तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		214.37	12.65	227.02	13.35	2725.00	08 माह	"ए" (मांग कार्य)
3	ढका कुम्हरा मांग से कल्याणपुर भारती सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		135.63	3.28	138.91	8.95	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
4	पिनामपुर गौटिया मुख्य मांग से जूनिवर हाईस्कूल तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		104.91	2.53	107.44	7.37	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
5	जुहालपुर से प्राचीन संतराबाबा होते हुये लखनापुर तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		167.43	11.60	179.03	10.95	2725.00	07 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
6	निगोरी मांग से मधवायई आर०आर०सी० सेंटर होते हुये भटेल मुख्य मांग तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		114.58	2.77	117.35	7.87	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
7	मुझिया पमार कोटावारी मांग से विजयनगर होते हुए रामताल सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		122.31	2.96	125.27	8.26	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
8	महासिर से नाला सरंग तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		95.98	2.32	98.30	6.91	2725.00	04 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
9	ग्राम ढड़िया मेन रोड से राणीपुर चकुरिया तक सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		159.20	3.85	163.06	10.15	2725.00	07 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
10	मोहम्मदी मांग से जयनपुर सम्पक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		197.93	4.79	202.72	12.14	2725.00	08 माह	"ए" (मांग कार्य)
11	शाहजहापुर रेलवे ब्रॉसिंग से भजन सिंह के फार्म हुए रजजनगर जगदीश खेत तिराहा मुख्य मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		155.25	3.76	159.01	9.95	2725.00	07 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
12	गुरवां मेन हाइवे से जोगा सिंह के झाले से होते हुए सिद्धिया तक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		121.33	2.94	124.27	8.21	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
13	जयालपुर में रमेश प्रधान के घर से मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		116.58	8.46	125.05	8.25	2725.00	06 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)
14	विकारखण्ड तिलहर में कोरामपुर मैनना सम्पक मांग से मोरानपुर कटरा तक मांग का नवनिर्माण कार्य। (वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27)		142.11	10.32	152.43	9.62	2725.00	07 माह	"ए" की "बी" (मांग कार्य)

2-निविदा दस्तावेज एवं निविदा हेतु आमंत्रण के विस्तृत विवरण एवं शर्तों हेतु वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर लॉग ऑन किया जा सकता है।

(महेन्द्र कुमार पाल)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

(प्रकाश चन्द्र)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

बरेली वृत्त, लोन्निंवि०, बरेली

UPID-255343 Date 02/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in



UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. D. "UJJWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GHS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248008, CIN No. U0110UC0615022396
Tels: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No. 762

Date : 03.09.2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No: 12/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27:Annual Preventive Maintenance of Generator of Unit No. 2 & 3 at Khodri Power Station
Estimated cost: ₹ 24,86,190/-GST extra
Date of availability of bid document on website:04.09.2026, 10:00 hrs. Last date for submission of tender:24.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs. For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"
Executive Engineer (Generation)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"



म.प्र. पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम

कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, इंदौर संभाग क्रमांक-02

जी-13, प्रथम 'तल' एम.आई.जी. कॉलोनी, एम.आई.जी. थाने के पीछे, इंदौर (म.प्र.), मो. नं.- 9425601512

E-mail Id :- mpphidclindore2@gmail.com

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना - 11/2026-27

म.प्र.पु.आ.एवं अधो.वि.नि., इंदौर संभाग क्र.- 02, इंदौर द्वारा क्रमशः पुलिस लाइन खंडवा में 4 Go's, 24 NGO एवं 96 OR, पातुंडा पुलिस लाइन बुरहानपुर में 16 आरक्षक एवं पुलिस लाइन चूनाभट्टी, बड़वानी में 4 Go's आवास गृहों के निर्माण कार्यों हेतु निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक **22.09.2026 तक** खरीदे जा सकते हैं, जिसकी विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/127849/2026

परियोजना यंत्री



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING OF STORM WATER LINE FROM ENGLISH WERE SHOP TO NATHURA ROAD NAGAR IN WARD NO.32, FARIDABAD - 131005	31.08.2026 07.09.2026	1,64,34,390/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0126411640 etenders@hry.nic.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 48920/HR



AXIS FINANCE LIMITED
(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)

E-Auction Notice of 30 days for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the below mentioned Borrower and/ Co- Borrower, or their legal heirs/representatives (Borrowers) that the below described immovable property mortgaged to Axis Finance Ltd. (AFL), the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AFL, will be sold on **09-10-2026** on "As is where is" & "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" and without any recourse basis" for recovery of outstanding dues from below mentioned Borrower and Co-Borrowers. The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit is mentioned below. Notice is hereby given that, in the absence of any postponement/discontinuance of the sale, the said secured asset / property shall be sold by E- Auction from 11:00 AM on the said **09-10-2026**. The sealed envelope containing Demand Draft of EMD for participating in E- Auction shall be submitted to the Authorised Officer of the AFL on or before **08-10-2026** till 4:00 PM.

The sale of the Secured Asset/ Immoveable Property will be on "as is where condition is" as per brief particulars described herein below;

Sr. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Type of possession	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 04.06.2026
1.	RD DRESSES, SANJAY JAIN, MEENU JAIN & HIMANSHU JAIN 0456MMA00011180	17.06.2026 INR 75,02,634/- (Rupees Seventy Five Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred And Thirty Four Only) due as on 04 June, 2026	Symbolic Possession	INR. 1,23,93,000/- (Rupees One Crore Twenty Three Lakhs Ninety Three Thousand Only)	INR 75,02,634/- (Rupees Seventy Five Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred And Thirty Four Only) due as on 04 June, 2026

ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF ENTIRE BUILD UP THIRD FLOOR WITH ROOF RIGHTS, LAND AREA MEASURING 80 SQ. YDS., I.E. 66.88 SQ. MTRS., HAVING ITS PLINTH/COVERED AREA MEASURING 66.88 SQ. MTRS., ALONGWITH ITS WHOLE OF STRUCTURE ACCORDING TO THE SITE THEREIN, CONSISTING OF ONE HALL THEREIN, FITTED WITH ELECTRICITY & WATER TAP CONNECTIONS WITH THEIR SEPARATE METERS, COMMON ENTRANCE, PASSAGE & STAIRCASE, WITH THE RIGHTS TO INSTALL/MAINTAIN THE WATER TANK & TV. ANTENNA ON THE ROOF OF TOP FLOOR, A PART OF PROPERTY BEARING NO. X/138 (CONSTRUCTED ON OLD PLOT NO.15 & 16), OUT OF KHASRA NO.588/45773/8, SITUATED IN THE ABADI OF GANESHI DASS BUILDING, RAGHUBER PURA NO.1, GANDHI NAGAR, IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE SEELAMPUR, ILLAQA SHAHDARA, DELHI-110031, ALONGWITH PROPORTIONATE, UNDIVIDED, INDIVISIBLE & IMPARTABLE OWNERSHIP RIGHTS IN THE LAND UNDERNEATH AND BOUNDED AS- EAST- GALLI, WEST- GALLI, NORTH- OTHER'S PROPERTY, SOUTH- OTHER'S PROPERTY.

Note :- The bidders are advised to conduct due diligence before submitting the bid. The auction shall be subject to the outcome of the litigation, Dispute if any.

At the Auction, the public generally is invited to submit their bid(s) personally. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the Immoveable Property sold.

The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and the terms and conditions prescribed:

The E-auction of the properties will take place through portal <https://sarfaes.auctiontiger.net/EEPROC/> on **09.10.2026 11:00 a.m. onwards**. For further details please refer to the notice published in the newspapers and at website: www.axisfinance.com.

Contact Person Details & Mob. Nos.: Mr. Aryan Bhattacharya: 9811710558

Place:- Delhi

Sd/-
Authorised Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.

Registered Address: At C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025.
CIN No. U65921MH1995PLC212675.



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KURUKSHETRA	CONSTRUCTION OF WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING AMBALA HISSAR ROAD (OLD NH-65 INTERNAL ROAD ISMAILABAD) FROM RD KM. 29.94 TO 34.24 (ROAD ID 12588) IN DISTRICT KURUKSHETRA (CM ANNOUNCEMENT CODE NO. 26040 DATED 06.04.2022).	01.09.2026 10.09.2026	164.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01744297271 pwd-eeed2- kurukshetra@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	REPAIR OF ROADS BY WDG. AND STG ON VARIOUS ROADS UNDER JAG. PROVINCIAL DIVISION PWD B AND R BR YAMUNA NAGAR UNDER WORK PROGRAM-2026-27 (ID 636, 402, 403, 422 AND 440) (GROUP-1) + 3 WORKS	02.09.2026 12.09.2026	1842.60 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01732237834 pwd-eeed- yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	REPAIR OF ROADS BY WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING ON VARIOUS ROADS UNDER PROVINCIAL DIVISION PWD B AND R BR YAMUNA NAGAR UNDER WORK PROGRAM-2026-27 (ID 432, 578, 567, 545, 582, 580, 537, 12551, 505 AND 450) (GROUP-2) WORK OF 6 NOS ROADS (1 STG.WITH WBM PLUS 80MM IPB ON HB KALSI KHALSA ID7396 KM 0 TO 0.14+2 STG. WBM PLUS RLY OF CCB ON NKD TO BHUKHAPURI ID7419 KM 0 TO 0.92+3 STG.WITHWBM PLUS RLY OF CCB ON DERA RAISON ID 7427 KM 0 TO 2 (4 STG.WBM PLUS 50M BM PLUS 20M PC PLUS 80MM IPB ON NKD TO BIRBALDAWIA ID 7441 KM 0 TO 0.90+5 STG.WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC RLY 80MM IPB RAMBA SHAMGARH ID 8886 KM 0 TO 3.24 (6 WDG.STG.WBM PLUS 50M BM PLUS 20M PC GUNIANA BASTLI JHAL ID 11129 KM 0 TO 2.25 NKD CONSTITUENCY IN KARNAL DIST. WP 2026-27. + 1 WORKS	02.09.2026 15.09.2026	732.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eeep-karnal@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, KURUKSHETRA	WIDENING WITH HARD SHOULDERING AND STRENGTHENING OF 03 NOS. ROAD (I) MAHUA KHERI TO SANGHORE (ROAD ID 7933) (II) SAHARANPUR KURUKSHETRA ROAD TO BAN-1 ROAD ID 3753 (TRANSFER OF HSAMB ROADS) (III) LADWA RAIPUR ROAD TO JAIPUR ROAD ID 7907 UNDER LADWA CONSTITUENCY, IN DISTRICT KURUKSHETRA. (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27)	31.08.2026 09.09.2026	311.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01744297271 pwd-eeed2- kurukshetra@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, KARNAL	SPECIAL REPAIR JUDICIAL COURT IN DISTRICT KATHAL (PDG. ELECTRICAL APPLIANCES) + 3 WORKS	03.09.2026 10.09.2026	113.83 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01842265696 pwd-eeed-karnal@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, KARNAL	UP-GRADATION OF CHC TO 50 BEDDED HOSPITAL AT TARAORI DISTT. KARNAL (PDG. HVAC ONLY)	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	138.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01842265696 pwd-eeed-karnal@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R,SIRSA	RE-CONSTRUCTION OF GOVERNMENT VETERINARY HOSPITAL (GVH) AT VILLAGE DESUJODHA AND RE-CONSTRUCTION OF GOVERNMENT VETERINARY HOSPITAL (GVH) AT VILLAGE KALANWALI IN SIRSA DISTRICT	02.09.2026 11.09.2026	67.08 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in
9	PWD B&R,SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR OF TRAUMA CENTER IN CAMPUS IN CIVIL HOSPITAL AT SIRSA DISTT. (BALANCE WORK).	03.09.2026 09.09.2026	20.99 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ,PINJORE	COMPLETION OF VYAMSHALA AT VILLAGE PAPOHA BLOCK PINJORE	01.09.2026 08.09.2026	7.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466110204 sdoprinjore@gmail.com
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ, AMBALA	DPLAN CONST. OF ONE ROOM IN ANGAWADI AT VILL. RASIDPUR AND CONST. OF ONE ROOM FOR NEW ANGAWADI AT VILL. KARASAN AND CONST. OF ONE ROOM IN ANGAWADI AT VILL. BANOUDI BLOCK SHAHZADPUR	02.09.2026 08.09.2026	14.27 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171-2551368 prexeeng.amb@hry.nic.in
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	RECONSTRUCTION / CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS STRUCTURES FROM RD 124000 TO 156014 OF BHALAUT SUB BRANCH	CLOSING DATE 15.09.2026	1635.66 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xensdsnrkt@gmail.com
13	CIVIL SURGEON, FARIDABAD	SUPPLY OF FOOD ARTICLES IN DISTRICT CIVIL HOSPITAL FARIDABAD	07.09.2026 23.09.2026	0.18 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292415623 civilhospitalfbd@gmail.com
14	FOREST DEPARTMENT, HISAR	1 TENDER FLOATED BY HISAR FOREST DIVISION FOR AIR PORT HISAR PLANTATION WORKS IN HISAR RANGE UNDER JURISDICTION OF HISAR FOREST DIVISION.	02.09.2026 14.09.2026	453.82 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	999222537 dfohisar.t@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No.48947/HR

कार्यालय संचालक

राज्य वन अनुसंधान संस्थान, पोलीपाथर, जबलपुर (म.प्र.)
Phone-0761-2666529, E-mail: mpsfri@gmail.com, mpsfri@mp.gov.in

ई-निविदा सूचना (e-Tender Notice)

No/NIT/SFRI/Store/ 2561

Date 02/9/2026

राज्य वन अनुसंधान संस्थान, जबलपुर हेतु (1) कम्प्यूटर सामग्री (2) विद्युत सामग्री (3) लेखन सामग्री एवं (4) पकी गोबर खाद, कापू मिट्टी, वर्मी कम्पोस्ट एवं कोकोपिट आदि सामग्री प्रदाय हेतु दर अनुबंध करने हेतु ई-निविदा <https://mptenders.gov.in> के माध्यम से पंजीकृत विक्रेताओं एवं प्रदायकताओं से तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा अभिलेख दिनांक 04/09/2026 से रु. 1000/- भुगतान कर <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर उपलब्ध रहेगी। विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु संस्थान की वेबसाईट <https://mpsfri.org> एवं म.प्र. वन विभाग की वेबसाईट <https://mpforest.gov.in> से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं। किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन /सुधार/परिवर्तन होने की सूचना <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर उपलब्ध रहेगी।

संचालक

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Raj Kumar, S/o: Pyare Lal, R/o: H.No. A-64, MCD Flat, New Usmanpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in FIR No. 36/2024, U/s: 420/120B/34 IPC, Police Station Cyber West, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raj Kumar of Police Station Cyber West, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
MM-08, West, Room No. 30,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12483/WD/2026

U.P. RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED

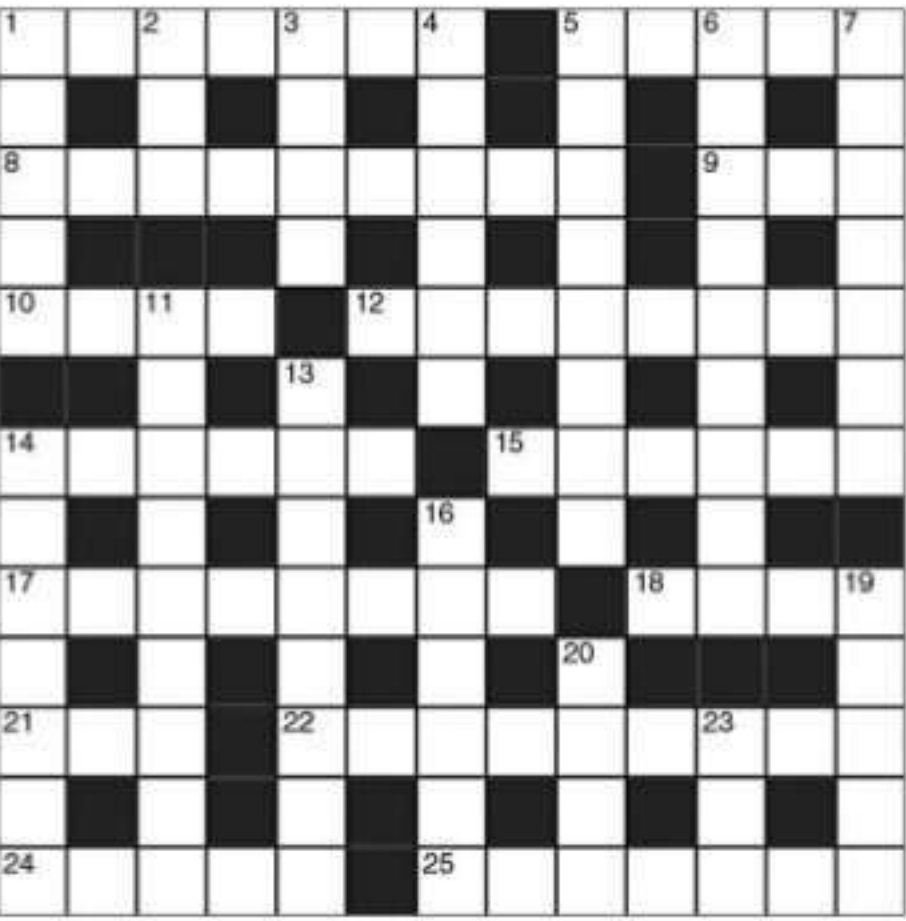
OBRA - SONEBHADRA

E-Tender Notice

1. E-Tender No. 08/BMD-I/CTPS/OBRA/2026, Urgent Removal of Stuck P91 Scrap Material from Separator of Unit-2, CTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 11,800.00 (10,000.00+1,800.00 GST), EMD-Rs. 1,00,000.00, Amount:-Rs. 95,00,000.00,

CROSSWORD

6085



- ACROSS
- 1 Assume noble identity and repel people (4,3)
- 5 Accumulate a great amount (5)
- 8 Mysteries of the variable sound wind? (9)
- 9 The whole lot - though it sounds only a little (3)
- 10 Lines of argument? (4)
- 12 It sounds highly unnatural (8)
- 14 It is involved with a plan that is flexible (6)
- 15 Warning a worker is about to fight (6)
- 17 Changing integral formation (8)
- 18 When one gains a vast area of land (4)
- 21 A tavern in point (3)
- 22 Rendered intoxicated (9)
- 24 Back a favourite I'd found not so hot (5)
- 25 Clear round I had briefly in sporting competition (7)
- DOWN
- 1 Shady place for one on the fiddle? (5)
- 2 An attempt made in the past (3)
- 3 The responsibility is evidently ours (4)
- 4 Man loyally helpful on just one day a week (6)
- 5 Estimated tax liability? (8)
- 6 Dogs give assailant trouble (9)
- 7 Undistinguished character (7)
- 11 Just jotted down? Quite the opposite! (7,2)
- 13 Courageous Pinter play I'd taken to heart (8)
- 14 A key player (7)
- 16 Squirring eel can get entangled (6)
- 19 Examination on book work (5)
- 20 The case for a little more tuition (4)
- 23 One type of corn spirit (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6084 ACROSS: 1 Fireside, 5 Abbe, 9 Width, 10 Closure, 11 Second fiddle, 13 Lustre, 14 Almost, 17 Film producer, 20 Inferno, 21 Video, 22 Goya, 23 Very well DOWN: 1 Fawn, 2 Redress, 3 School report, 4 Decide, 6 Bound, 7 Elements, 8 Social survey, 12 Fluffing, 15 Overdue, 16 Coyote, 18 Lofty, 19 Foil

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

What we call 'Progress' is the exchange of one __ for another __. - Havelock Ellis (8,...,8) (same word twice)

DLYAE

ADILNN

HOTIS

HMMYCU

SOLUTIONS: Delay, Hoist, Inland, Chummy

ANSWER: What we call 'Progress' is the exchange of one **nulsance** for another **nulsance**. - Havelock Ellis

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL

4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6430

		3	5					
					2			8
	6				1		7	
9		5	7			4		
4	7						9	2
		2			5	6		7
	4		9				3	
6			2					
					8	7		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6429

7	5	6	9	3	8	1	2	4
9	4	2	7	1	5	8	3	6
1	3	8	2	4	6	9	5	7
3	8	9	5	6	1	4	7	2
2	7	5	8	9	4	6	1	3
6	1	4	3	7	2	5	8	9
5	9	7	6	8	3	2	4	1
8	6	1	4	2	7	3	9	5
4	2	3	1	5	9	7	6	8

CORPORATE BRIEFS

CORRIGENDUM: The news of Anandita Medicare Ltd published in our newspaper on 03-09-2026. Please read the revenue as Rs.13,741.57 lacs, EBITDA as Rs.5,150.85 lacs and net profit as Rs.3,429.65 lacs.

NHPC held its 50th AGM on recently,through video conferencing. Bhupender Gupta, CMD, addressed the shareholders at the AGM. Shareholders considered a final dividend of Rs.0.21 per equity share for FY26, in addition to the Rs.1.40 interim dividend. NHPC added a record 1,850 MW during FY26, taking consolidated installed capacity beyond 9,333 MW. The company recorded consolidated net profit of Rs.4,220.46 crore and standalone profit of Rs.3,617.80 crore. NHPC also advanced hydropower, pumped storage and renewable projects, with a long-term target of reaching 50,000 MW installed capacity by 2047.

PNB signed an MoU with Oriental Insurance Company Ltd. on recently, to offer salary package benefits to OICL employees. The package includes enhanced insurance coverage, preferential banking services, concessional retail loans and family banking benefits. Employees can access zero-balance family accounts, salary-linked overdraft facilities, preferential locker rentals, complimentary credit cards and concessions on home, education and vehicle loan processing charges. The package also includes education and marriage-related coverage for children, Hospicash benefits, and other value-added services.

LIC recently marked its 70th anniversary, commemorating seven decades of service since its establishment in 1956. LIC retained its leadership in FY26 with a 65.16% market share in policies and 56.66% in First Year Premium Income, while AUM rose 5.08% to Rs.57.29 lakh crore. Its Golden Jubilee Foundation, established in 2006, has disbursed Rs.303 crore across 1,045 projects and provided 41,776 scholarships worth Rs.105.27 crore. LIC has also expanded digital services, including the My LIC App, while focusing on customer service, governance and transparency.

OGEI, a wholly owned subsidiary of Oil India Ltd., signed MoUs with municipalities in Gurugram, Faridabad, Hisar, and Ambala to develop integrated CBG and Waste-to-Energy projects. The four facilities will process 5,000 TPD of municipal waste and are expected to produce 70-75 TPD of CBG and 50 MW of green power. The projects will recover recyclables, convert biodegradable waste into CBG, and use non-recyclable waste for electricity generation. The initiative supports scientific waste management, the circular economy, and the national Waste-to-Wealth and GOI's GOBARdhan objectives.

INDIAN COAST GUARD and Vietnam Coast Guard held their 7th High-Level Meeting in Chennai under the 2015 MoU on Coast Guard Cooperation. Discussions focused on Maritime Search and Rescue, law enforcement, marine pollution response and capacity building. Both sides reviewed professional exchanges, ship visits and ongoing cooperation, while stressing training, knowledge sharing and interoperability. The meeting reaffirmed their commitment to maritime safety, security and environmental sustainability. The India-Vietnam Coast Guard Joint Exercise, SAHYOG-HOPTAC, was scheduled at sea on August 27, 2026, to strengthen operational coordination.



PNB organised the PNB AI Summit 2026, bringing together policymakers, regulators, industry leaders, academia, technology experts, fintech firms and cybersecurity professionals. The two-day summit examined the role of AI, Quantum Technologies and Cybersecurity in shaping the BFSI sector. Discussions focused on AI, Generative AI and Agentic AI for customer service, operational efficiency, risk management and financial inclusion. The summit also highlighted quantum-safe banking, future-ready cybersecurity architectures, collaborative innovation and cyber resilience. The event reinforced PNB's focus on technology-led, secure and future-ready banking.

UGB organised an Inter-Regional Badminton Tournament as part of its UGB Champions League on National Sports Day. Six teams participated in the event, which was organised as part of UGB Chamak Sports Club's HR initiative. The tournament promoted fitness, teamwork and employee engagement. The Pauni-Prayag team emerged as the winner after a series of competitive matches. The initiative reflects UGB's efforts to promote sports and strengthen a healthy, collaborative workplace culture.

CORPORATE BRIEFS



SCOPE launched the 2nd edition of its Advanced Global Leadership Program in collaboration with IIM Calcutta. The programme brings together 27 senior executives from CPSEs across sectors. The initiative aims to develop future-ready leaders capable of balancing business performance, public purpose and national priorities. AGLP 2.0 features a three-week immersive programme comprising workshops at IIM Calcutta and SCOPE, New Delhi, followed by an international industry study tour. The initiative seeks to strengthen the leadership pipeline and broaden strategic thinking and global business understanding among CPSE executives.



NBCC and NHPC signed an MoU for pan-India execution of NHPC infrastructure projects, including buildings, structures and allied works. It was formalised on August 28, 2026. Under the agreement, NBCC will provide PMC services and undertake projects on a deposit-work basis. Its scope covers design, engineering, procurement, construction, quality control, commissioning and statutory compliance. The partnership combines NHPC's clean-energy expertise with NBCC's infrastructure execution capabilities. Projects will include residential and commercial facilities and office complexes, with a focus on cost, time efficiency and quality.



REC held its 57th Annual General Meeting through video conferencing, highlighting its FY26 performance and role in India's energy transition. It recorded its highest-ever annual disbursements of Rs. 2.11 lakh crore, sanctions of Rs. 4.09 lakh crore, net worth above Rs. 84,000 crore, loan assets of Rs. 5.84 lakh crore and net profit of Rs. 16,282 crore. Addressing the shareholders, Jitendra Srivastava, CMD, stated, "The year marked strong performance and strategic progress for REC amid a rapidly evolving global environment, with the Company continuing to focus on growth, resilience, sustainability, transparency and strong corporate governance." REC Ltd. highlighted the Company's strong financial and operational performance. REC sanctioned 58 renewable energy projects with over 13,000 MW capacity and loan assistance exceeding Rs. 85,000 crore. The 3rd edition of REC's ESG Report was also unveiled, outlining its focus on sustainability, inclusion and responsible development.

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your communication skills are so excellent today, it's a great day for those of you who teach, write, market or act, because your words will be like gold. You'll be creative and optimistic about the future. Tonight: Discussions.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a strong money day for you. You have practical ideas and you're willing to work hard. Meanwhile, a family connection might boost your income. Tonight: Check your money.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today the Moon is in your sign dancing with both Saturn and Jupiter, which gives a lovely balance to your energy. Someone more experienced might have wise advice for you. Meanwhile, your enthusiasm and big ideas will carry the day. Tonight: You're strong.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a busy time for you. You might be redecorating at home and entertaining. Physical exercise is important while fiery Mars is in your sign. Research will go very well today. Listen to hidden ideas that might boost your income. Tonight: Privacy.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Your interaction with a friend could be meaningful today. They will likely benefit you and encourage you. Why not share your moneymaking ideas? Tonight: Friendships.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): The Sun and Mercury are in your sign, and today the Moon is at the top of your chart, which means someone might help you today. If so, this will be obvious to others, because whatever you do today is noticed. Accept the help of someone more experienced. It might be beneficial financially. Tonight: You're noticed.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): In one way, you want to be low-key today. But another part of you wants to do something different so you can have an adventure. Go someplace you've never been before — a coffee shop or restaurant. Check out a different neighbourhood. Tonight: Explore.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): The wealth and resources of your partner or someone else might benefit you today. Someone might help you because you're creating a good impression on your world. Tonight: Check your finances.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Be cooperative with others today. Someone might have advice about raising or educating kids, performing a sport or honing your art. Tonight: Be cooperative.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You're in a practical frame of mind today, which is why you'll be productive at work. You also might research information related to your health or a pet. Or perhaps you will help an older family member? Tonight: Be productive.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is a playful day. It's the perfect day to use your creative talents. You're willing to hone your skills, which is necessary if you want to improve your ability to do something creatively. Tonight: Socialise.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Whatever happens at home today or perhaps within your family will probably benefit you. Someone might have advice for you. They might help you. Tonight: Relax.

NBCC organised the 20th edition of SAMVAAD at its Convention Centre in East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi. The two-day programme was attended by Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy, CMB, Dr. Suman Kumar, Director (Commercial), Anjeev Kumar Jain, Director (Finance), Ritu Pande, CVO, alongside senior management, RBG/SBG heads, project heads, and employees. It focused on project execution, business development, financial performance, technology, HR and organisational growth. Sessions covered cyber hygiene, technical examination, contract management and new construction technologies. As part of a three-month campaign ahead of Vigilance Awareness Week, discussions focused on the theme "Probity for Prosperity", including pending cases, complaints, capacity building and digital initiatives. The NBCC Shram Sewa Portal was also inaugurated. Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswa stressed upon technology adoption, accountability, and faster execution.

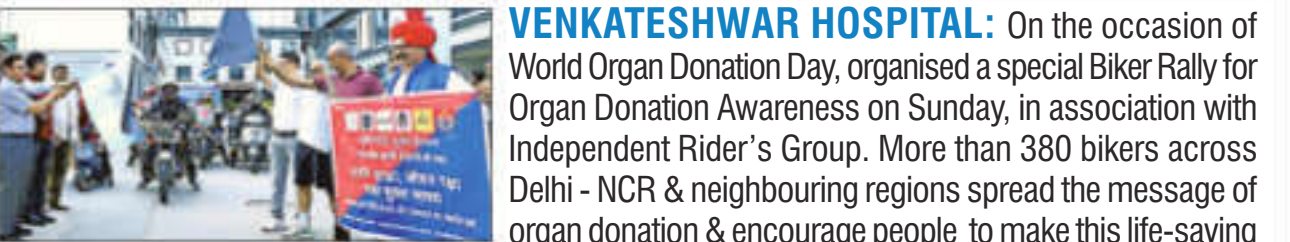
PVNL, Managing Director Ravish Gupta, IAS, reviewed the resolution of electricity bill-related issues of farmers' PTW connections in Hapur and directed officials to ensure a simple, transparent and time-bound mechanism. The portal for submitting applications will open in two phases—September 15 to 30, 2026, and October 15 to 30, 2026. Special counters will be established at the concerned division offices to assist farmers in submitting applications and uploading required documents. The Managing Director said that time-bound and transparent resolution of farmers' grievances is a priority of the discom, and directed officials to ensure prompt resolution of eligible cases as per rules.

RAILTEL organised an Akhil Bhartiya Kavi Sammelan in Kolkata, bringing together poetry, songs, ghazals, and humour. Poets including Dr. Vishnu Saxena, Dinesh Raghuvanshi, Khushboo Sharma, Vinod Pal, and Vivek Kumar Gupta performed before the audience. The programme was conducted by Manoj Tandon, Director, POM, RailTel, who also presented his ghazals and poetry. RailTel employees participated virtually and recited original poems, adding to the event's interactive character. The programme highlighted diverse literary forms while combining emotional, humorous and entertaining performances.

MOHFW: Punya Salila Srivastava, Secretary, MoHFW, reviewed TB services at Nehru Nagar Chest Clinic under the TB Mukht Bharat Abhiyaan, assessing screening, diagnostics, treatment and patient care. The visit highlighted Delhi's progress in strengthening TB services and providing timely, quality care. The Central TB Division continues to monitor the programme, while Delhi's health teams are working to expand community participation. Under the guidance of Health Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh, efforts include encouraging citizens and organisations to become Nikshay Mitras and support patients during treatment. The visit reaffirmed the focus on providing accessible and uninterrupted TB services towards a TB-Mukt Bharat.



JUBILANT BHARTIA FOUNDATION and Schwab Foundation for Social Entrepreneurship honoured Nidhi Pant, Co-Founder of S4S Technologies, with the 17th Social Entrepreneur of the Year Award India 2026. Pant was recognised for developing biotechnology solutions that convert waste into bio-based products and sustainable agricultural inputs. S4S Technologies also establishes farm factories at farmers' fields and supports smallholder women farmers through sustainable practices and improved economic opportunities. The award brought together representatives from government, business, academia, philanthropy and civil society to recognise scalable social innovations across sectors including agriculture, livelihoods, healthcare, education and climate resilience.



VENKATESHWAR HOSPITAL: On the occasion of World Organ Donation Day, organised a special Biker Rally for Organ Donation Awareness on Sunday, in association with Independent Rider's Group. More than 380 bikers across Delhi - NCR & neighbouring regions spread the message of organ donation & encourage people to make this life-saving commitment. The rally was held under the campaign #OneRideManyLives, commenced from Venkateshwar Hospital, Dwarka, and brought together biking enthusiasts from Delhi, Faridabad, Gurugram and Haridwar. The event witnessed active participation & support from NOTTO Delhi Police Traffic Police and Traffic Tau. Dr. Anil Kumar, Director, NOTTO, and Dr. Harshmat Singh, NOTTO, also participated in the event. Through initiatives such as these, Venkateshwar Hospital continues to promote awareness, compassion & responsible community participation in organ donation.

Laxman named coach for 2026 Asian Games



VVS Laxman. FILE

Express News Service
Chennai, September 3

BCCI'S HEAD of cricket VVS Laxman will be the coach of India men's team at the Asian Games set to take place in Aichi-Nagoya. Since the continental event is overlapping with India's bilateral series against the West Indies at home, the Gautam Gambhir-led support staff won't be able to join the men's team at the Asian Games.

Apart from Laxman, India men's coaching staff at the Asian Games will comprise Hrishikesh Kanitkar, Sunil Joshi and Subhadeep Ghosh, who recently took over as the fielding coach.

Ghosh will not be part of the ODI set up for the series against West Indies alone. While the regular support staff won't be around for the men's team, the case is different with the women's team.

After the completion of the ongoing Asia Cup in the UAE, the team women's team will head to Japan with their regular support staff that includes head coach Amol Muzumdar, bowling coach Avishkar Salvi and fielding coach Munish Bali.

That India men's team would have different support staff is well known as the FTP clashes with the Asian Games. Even four years ago, when India clinched the gold medal in Hangzhou, Laxman was the chief coach. This time, India's home series against the West Indies starts on September 27 and ends on October 3.

Overlap with Asiad

While the series is short, it overlaps with the Asian Games schedule, where India have received a first-round bye and will play the quarterfinals straight up. India's first game is on September 28 and should they make the gold medal match, the final is slated for October 3. While India had send a second-string squad led by Ruturaj Gaikwad for the previous edition of the Asian Games in 2022. However, this time they have sent their first-choice team that will be led by Shreyas Iyer and includes premier pacer Jasprit Bumrah and young batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and a host of other players who were part of the squad that won the T20 World Cup earlier this year.

Apart from Laxman, India men's coaching staff at the Asian Games will comprise Hrishikesh Kanitkar, Sunil Joshi and Subhadeep Ghosh

REVIEW MEETING

BCCI promises a kinder FTP cycle, ample rest, and tour games

Choc-a-block cricket schedule has taken a toll on health of the India players, says Board secretary Devajit Saikia

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, February 3

WITH AN eye on managing players' workload, providing them adequate rest and recovery time between series, and thus limiting the possibility of picking up injuries, the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) has promised a better-planned Future Tour Programme from the next cycle. Some of the proposed measures include chalking out the calendar in such a way that the players get more rest between series, and sufficient time to get acclimatised to conditions, more so in SENA (SA, Eng, NZ and Aus) countries, including warm-up games before the series.

"We have instructed our FTP persons who will be meeting very soon in various international forums that our FTP should be in such a way that there is proper rest for the players as well as some kind of acclimatisation or friendly matches before any major series in SENA countries," BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia told media after a meeting with captains Shubman Gill (Test and ODIs), Shreyas Iyer (T20Is), coach Gautam Gambhir and head of Centre of Excellence (COE) VVS Laxman.

Ajit Agarkar, the chairman of selectors, couldn't attend the meeting due to prior commitments.

In the review meeting held in the board headquarters here to discuss the roadmap of Indian cricket in an important season, they discoursed the frequent incidence of injuries, possibly due to a packed calendar. Saikia admitted: "Individ-

ual players are having injuries because they have to play a lot of matches. If you look at their schedule, in England, three-four players of the 15-member ODI squad got injured. We have to think that they have played two months of IPL before that. All this takes a toll on the health of the players."

The schedule is not getting kinder, with India set to feature in seven Tests, 14 ODIs, and 16 T20Is, apart from the Asian Games, until the next IPL in late March.

The board, though, has assured the team management and its captains that they will plan better so that players get sufficient rest.

"To avoid those kinds of situations under the present FTP, we are trying to find some ways out. We have a protocol in place for how a player can come back to international matches after injury. We are taking feedback from the captains and head coach to chalk up a proper strategy to avoid these unwanted situations," the secretary assured.

He also asserted that, "everybody is on the same page."

"BCCI is working very well, like a well oiled engine. There is proper coordination amongst all the wings of BCCI, whether it is women's teams committees or their technical staff or their coaches, vis-a-vis the COE, vis-a-vis the Indian men's team's coaching staff and the head coach. There is no difficulty in the coordination, everything is moving in the right direction," Saikia said.

"The only challenge we are facing is that there are too many matches in the year and



India will play seven Tests, 14 ODIs and 16 T20Is, apart from the Asian Games, until the next IPL. CREIMAS

that is why in the next FTP, we will do certain things. We will take certain measures," he added.

Rohit's future

The board secretary defused speculation on former captain Rohit Sharma's future. "He is playing superbly in all matches. So what more do you want? Last match he scored 138 runs so why is there speculation? I do not want to give some fodder for the speculators," he said, stubbing rumours that he was not in the selectors' scheme for the World Cup in southern Africa later next year.

He also said they didn't discuss the future of Agarkar, and clarified that the talks revolved only around the roadmap for the 2027 World Cup.

"Today he was out of station. He could not be a part of the meeting because this meeting was called at a very short notice, and our head of the selection



“ Last match he (Rohit) scored 138 runs so why is there speculation? I do not want to give some fodder for the speculators.”

DEVAJIT SAIKIA,
ON ROHIT SHARMA'S FUTURE

committee was not in town, so he could not join it. He was in such an area that he could not join online also, in spite of all these efforts," he said.

Asiad accomodation

Regarding concerns on facilities and accommodation in Asian Games, Saikia said: "We are not going to have any difficulties in Japan."

Room sizes are believed to be too small for two people to share, along with their individual kitbags and luggage. There is also a question mark on the quality of the pitch.

But the secretary said: "If any kind of situation arises, we'll take an appropriate call at the right time, so that we ensure that our players and the support star will get the best of facilities in Asian Games, whether it is from their organisers or us. If required, BCCI will have its own system in place to provide the best facilities to our players," he replied.

Meanwhile, three pacers — Rasikh Salam, Kartik Tyagi and Vicky Ostwal — will travel with the Indian team as net bowlers to the Asian Games.

Centurion Smriti makes light work of Hong Kong

Shuvaditya Bose

New Delhi, September 3

THE CELEBRATION in Dubai bore no resemblance to the one in Nottingham.

Questions had been raised after the 2024 T20 World Cup. A strike rate of 94.93 demanded scrutiny. Only a discernible change in batting approach would have been a convincing response.

The change arrived a few months later, next June in Nottingham. Mandhana scored her maiden T20I century — 112 off 62 balls against England. Her arms reached for the sky as a load lifted off her shoulders.

The helmet stayed in place this time. The bat raise was half-hearted, almost apologetic. After all, this was only Hong Kong China. Perhaps, modesty got the better of the Indian opener. Mandhana's second T20I century — a 64-ball 124 at the Women's Asia Cup on Thursday — came against humble opposition, a team that, in their only previous (unofficial) T20 outing against



Smriti Mandhana made 124 from just 64 balls. CREIMAS

India in 2012, had mustered a total of 24.

Courtesy Mandhana's century, India secured a 137-run triumph and secured their passage to the semifinals. Scoring 195/3 after being asked to bat first, India bowled Hong Kong out for 56.

The result didn't have an iota of surprise, nor did Mandhana's batting approach.

India's score does not offer an accurate portrayal of the wicket's true nature. Indian captain Harmanpreet Kaur, at the toss, called it 'very tricky.' Caution governed the opening overs — 18 balls, 18 runs from Mandhana.

Then, caution was thrown to the wind. Three boundaries bled from the fifth over, all fashioned by the left-hander's blade. Opening partner Shafali Verma hit two sixes and as many fours in the next over, before Ruchika Venkatesh dismissed her for 28.

India added another 119 runs after her departure. Mandhana made 80 of them. Anything short was pulled with disdain. Anything sweepable was swept with conviction. Her drives held caress; her cuts — like the one that brought up the century — held surgical precision.

Mandhana scored two runs short of a century from just boundaries — 14 fours and

seven sixes. It was an innings in perfect synchronisation with the steadily climbing graph of her T20I strike rate. What was 126.53 in 2024 became 135.85 in 2025, and 145.84 this year, going into this match. In a couple of years, her strike rate at the T20 World Cup has gone from 94.93 to 140.4.

If one is to present a qualm about India's batting, it could be the lack of runs from anyone not named Smriti Mandhana or Shafali Verma. Pratika Rawal, with a 12-ball 10, did little to justify her selection. Richa Ghosh wasn't too effective either. It has now been over eight months since she recorded a 35+ score in T20Is.

Hong Kong's primary goal in the chase — if it could be called that — was to bat through the 20 overs.

At one stage, it seemed that they would be successful in that endeavour. The first eight overs yielded only 26 runs, but saw just a solitary wicket, taken by Nandani Sharma. The stone-walling effort, however, was no match against India's spin trio

of Deepti Sharma, Prema Rawat and Sree Charani, who combined to take seven wickets for 37 runs. Nine wickets fell in a span of 47 deliveries, ensuring a comfortable victory for the most successful team in the tournament's history.

India will now face Pakistan on Saturday, at the same venue. As for the fixture against Hong Kong China, Mandhana may not have known much about them, but Thursday will be remembered less for India's victory than for what she did to bring it about.

During the game, she became the leading run-scorer in women's international cricket, became the first woman to score 18 international centuries, and recorded the highest score in the T20 version of this competition. If only, there were some spectators to witness the spectacle.

BRIEF SCORES: India 195/3 (Smriti Mandhana 124; Marina Lamplough 2/46) beat Hong Kong 56 all out (Natasha Miles 15; Deepti Sharma 3/9) by 137 runs.

• BRIEFLY



Yashvir Singh won a bronze medal at the CWG. EXPRESS

Yashvir Singh takes injured Neeraj's spot in Asiad squad

Commonwealth Games bronze medallist javelin thrower Yashvir Singh has replaced injured Neeraj Chopra in the Indian athletics team for the upcoming Asian Games in Japan, while long distance runner Abhishek Pal has been dropped after he was served notice for an alleged doping offence by NADA. The Athletics Federation of India (AFI) on Thursday announced a 77-member Indian track and field team for the September 19-October 4 Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games at a press conference in Ludhiana which is hosting the National Youth Championships. Men's 110m hurdler Tejas Shirse has also been omitted from the team after he sustained an injury during the recent Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. PTI

Anahat upsets World No.11 in quarterfinals

World No. 20 Anahat Singh advanced to the quarterfinals of the London Squash Classic with a 2-1 win over 11th-ranked Nele Gilis here on Thursday. Reigning world junior champion Anahat beat Gilis 13-11, 4-11, 11-8 in 39 minutes in the second round of the PSA Gold event in what was their first meeting on the tour. Anahat will next meet the winner of the match between Malaysian Sivasangari Subramaniam and world No. 32 Nardine Garas. PTI

Multinational camp for boxers at NIS Patiala

Indian boxers are sharpening their skills at NIS in Patiala ahead of this month's Asian Games, before leaving for a preparatory stint in Nagoya, Japan, on September 8. The camp features boxers from Iran and the Dominican Republic, including Paris Olympics bronze medallists Junior Alcantara (51kg) and Cristian Pinales (80kg). The national campers will leave for a training camp in Nagoya Japan, starting from September 9. PTI

Real's Asencio cleared of sex tape charge

Real Madrid defender Raúl Asencio was acquitted on Thursday of charges he revealed a sex video without consent. The court decision came hours after coach José Mourinho said the club opened a disciplinary proceeding against Asencio following a DUI conviction. He was cleared of charges that he showed a sex video to another person without the consent of those involved in the video. One of the women in the 2023 video was underage. AP

Naqvi hits back at critics of Pakistan team

Livid with the criticism that Pakistan's cricket team has faced after its heavy Test losses to England, PCB Chairman Mohsin Naqvi said the side is being lambasted by those "who have never achieved anything in their lives". Speaking to the media in London, Naqvi cited other teams' losses to weaker opponents, including India's recent T20 defeats at the hands of Ireland, to assert that a few setbacks do not define an outfit. PTI

After 19 years, Bosnia's Dzeko calls time

Edin Dzeko will play a 152nd and final match for Bosnia-Herzegovina next month before ending his 19-year international career. In an emotional post on Instagram, the 40-year-old striker wrote he would be retiring from national team duty after a Nations League qualifier against Sweden in the Bosnian city of Zenica on October 2. "Now I feel the time has come to step aside," wrote Dzeko, who played for Bosnia at this year's World Cup. AP

Antonelli says penalty takes pressure off

F1 championship leader Kimi Antonelli looked forward to his home Italian Grand Prix and said grid penalties had taken the pressure off while he also had less to prove than last year. The 20-year-old Mercedes driver is set to start from the back of the grid as he becomes the first Italian in 73 years to lead the standings at Monza. "I think in some ways it helps to release pressure, although I'd very much rather fight for pole," REUTERS

• HOPING TO HIT THE BULL'S EYE

Vidarsa's journey: From a college NCC trial to Asian Games shooting squad

Shashank Nair

New Delhi, September 3

ALL VIDARSA K Vinod wanted to do was hold a rifle. When an NCC trial was held at her college in 2018, the Kozhikode native turned up just so she'd have something to tell her friends, the novelty of picking a rifle up.

She ended up getting a shot instead, one that changed her life and has led to a place in the Indian shooting contingent heading to Aichi-Nagoya for the 2026 Asian Games. Vidarsa will compete in the women's 10m air rifle and the women's 50m three-position events.

Without any formal training, Vidarsa shot well enough that day to be picked for the NCC team. She soon moved to

the Kerala state team, but kept struggling. Shooting remains a prohibitively expensive sport for beginners, rifles run into the lakhs before jackets and ammunition even enter the picture, and when Covid hit, she considered leaving the sport rather than take a loan to buy her own equipment.

It didn't help that friends kept questioning her choice. "There were a lot of questions asked, some positive and some negative. There was also the issue of attendance in college, which was causing problems," Vidarsa said.

For a year, she practised yoga and exercised at home, but stayed off the range entirely. Once the pandemic's threat eased, she felt ready to give the sport another chance.

By then she had risen to the top of Kerala's rankings without ever owning a personal rifle, relying instead on NCC or borrowed weapons, and that gap made the idea of walking away feel harder to justify, not easier.

It was at a shooting range that she met her husband, who asked her, plainly, how she could call herself a professional shooter without owning her own rifle.

"I was speechless. I was improving my average and I became the Kerala No. 1 without any rifle or jacket at that time. I was delaying taking that plunge. So, that question actually made me think a lot. Then I discussed it with my parents and decided to get a new rifle. I took a loan for that," Vidarsa said.



Vidarsa will compete in the 10m air rifle and 50m 3-position. EXPRESS

Slow grind

Competition for a place in India's national shooting setup is intense, and getting more so. The number of shooters coming through state programmes has grown sharply in recent years, and a sport long dominated by the northern states has started finding its footing in the south too.

Kerala was never known for producing shooters, but Vidarsa goes into these Asian Games as one of its newer faces, carrying real responsibility for a squad that looks very different from the one that went to Hangzhou.

She is part of a newer generation trying to displace an established one, and a strong showing here matters.

India won 22 medals at

Hangzhou, a haul that surprised at the time and helped push the country toward its target of 100 medals. Matching or beating that this time will need top-level performances from exactly the newer faces Vidarsa represents.

To make the team, Vidarsa knew she needed specialised coaching.

That's where Manoj Kumar, a SAI high-performance coach, came in, working with her over short stints to rebuild her technique.

"Vidarsa was quick to learn and was accepting of the changes I wanted to make. For every athlete, the level of trust with their coach is different. But Vidarsa bought into the technical changes I wanted to make," Kumar said. The two

have worked together for several years now, and the partnership has only deepened.

When Vidarsa struggled with the weight of her rifle, Kumar suggested she try a lighter model he'd bought for his own daughter. She felt the difference immediately.

"My daughter has a similar build to Vidarsa, and both struggle to work with heavier rifles. So I imported a lightweight rifle for my daughter. But she was more interested in studying, so I gave the rifle to Vidarsa to test out. Initially she refused to take it, since the weapon was for my daughter. She was convinced when I asked her to just try it, and import one for herself later if she liked it. After a few days, I told her to keep it," Kumar said.



Argentina to pay tribute to Messi with a 10th-min pause during weekend games



Lionel Messi, FILE

Reuters
September 3

ALL FOOTBALL matches in Argentina this weekend will be paused in the 10th minute for a 60-second round of applause to honor superstar Lionel Messi, the Argentine Football Association announced.

The tribute follows Messi announcing his retirement from the national team on Monday. Messi, 39, has worn the No. 10 jersey most often while representing Argentina. "For the upcoming match-day across all men's and women's divisions and disciplines, matches will be paused in the 10th minute of the first half for a minute of applause in recognition of Lionel Messi's career with the Argentina national team," the AFA announced late Wednesday. "Furthermore, stadiums equipped with screens must broadcast the Association's institutional video prior to the start of the matches."

The Inter Miami star led Argentina to a runner-up finish in this summer's World Cup. In eight matches, he had eight goals to bring his final tally to 125 career international goals (21 in World Cups).

"After the time that passed since the final, thinking about it a lot, I want to communicate to everyone that I am retiring from the national team," Messi wrote Monday on Instagram. "It was a decision that hurt and hurts in a soul, but I understand that this is the moment. I swear to you that I always gave everything, not just in the last few years when we won everything but before as well and I always fought and left everything on the field for this shirt, to give you all joys and make you feel proud to be Argentines through soccer."

It's a second retirement for Messi, who originally said he was done with international play after a 2016 Copa America final loss to Chile. But he opted to return and led Argentina to the World Cup championship in 2022 and Copa America titles in 2021 and 2024.

"I leave with the peace of mind and pride of having given you -- along with my teammates -- moments we once only dreamed of. Experiencing this with you was incredible. I love you all," he said.

Sabalenka hits back at lifestyle jibe after a big win in the second round

Reuters
New York, September 3

DOUBLE DEFENDING champion Aryna Sabalenka bristled at a reporter's suggestion the events and appearances surrounding the U.S. Open had included "parties and fun" after she cruised past Polina Iatcenko 6-1 6-1 on Wednesday.

The Belarusian, who had faced a similar line of questioning after her first-round win, fired back that her off-court appearances had not come at the expense of her preparations for the Grand Slam.

"You guys are, like, a joke. Parties, fun... like, why would you even say that? Why would you even think about that? What kind of question is that?" the world number one said.

"Just because I posted, like, some activities with brands, and you think that I've been partying, not training?" she added, cutting the exchange short. Turning to her performance on Wednesday, the four-times Grand Slam winner said she was pleased with both her

'Treesa's smashes are amazing.. My aim is to create openings'

Bronze medallists at Delhi Worlds on what it took to finish on the podium despite an injury curveball

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 3

TREESA JOLLY-Gayatri Gopichand are back to training after their successful World Championships with a bronze medal, though they are itching to put lessons learnt from semis loss to good use at the upcoming Asian Games.

The pair of 23-year-olds, in an interview to The Indian Express, look back at the magical week in Delhi where they scalped World Nos 4 and 7, and brought an unexpected bronze. Swapping roles at net and back was central to the plan. *Excerpts*

How did you two use the net-game to win the World Championships bronze medal?

Gayatri: It had been a few challenging weeks coming into the World Championships. But practice was about simple things, and rotation as well. Because Treesa was injured, I was ready to cover the back court. Throughout the tournament and in pre-quarters (vs Japanese World No.7) and quarters (vs Chinese World No.4), our steady mid-court and net helped us.

I didn't expect Treesa to rush the net and implement the plan so well. Opponents, including (Chinese No.4) Jia Yifan were taken aback and were hesitant to lift, so getting confused.

Treesa: We were pretty confident at the net and in practice we really started rotating. Opponents weren't expecting me to rush, but I was trying to create chances for Gayatri to attack.

She is absolutely talented in her net skills, and sometimes I'm like 'Oh, how did she play that' and I get jealous at times, and ask her, "Bro, how're you doing that?!" But then she explains the whole thing to me to learn.

And can you talk about each other's smashes?

Gayatri: Treesa's smashes are amazing, they've always been known for strength and power. So my main aim always is to create openings for her (to unleash the smash). But at the World Championships, she had a very good blend of half smashes, drops and mixing the pace that was effective.

Treesa: I'm a hard attacking smasher, but Gayatri relies on angles on her smashes that help me intercept on the next shot. Her cross court slice drop is also very good.



Treesa Jolly (R) and Gayatri Gopichand took India's medal-winning streak at the World Championships to 15 years. EXPRESS PHOTO



TREESA JOLLY, GAYATRI GOPICHAND
WORLD CHSIPS MEDALLIST

How did you manage your emotions after beating No.7 Rin Iwanaga-Kie Nakanishi in pre-quarters, heading into the medal-securing quarters match against No.4 Jia Yifan and Zhang Shu Xian?

Gayatri: Winning pre-quarters where we beat the Japanese whom we had lost previously to, was a major confidence booster. Delhi crowd added to that optimism. When getting on court against World No.4s, we weren't expecting anything but we knew it would not be easy points, so we came prepared for a long match and also tricky (drift) conditions. We just wanted to win, no matter what and that showed in Treesa's emotions later. I don't express much though I feel pressure too, but that's just how I am.

Most I can do is 'Come on!' or a Thumbs-up after the match. Some people get energy from being pumped up. I've realised if I stay calmer, I think more clearly.

Treesa: Before entering the court we knew it wouldn't be easy. And Jia Yifan has so much experience of those pressure situations. But what helped I guess was sticking to the plan. Sometimes you just get this feeling, "Today's my Day." And I can get this match. So that day the shuttle kept going inside, and Gopi Sir told me to just stay calm. After getting each point, I would go into that calm zone.

How did you deal with Treesa's injury in April, in terms of not getting

“For a few weeks after the injury, I couldn't even walk, and I thought, 'what to do.' But I would train on my abs.”

TREESA JOLLY,
ON HER COMEBACK AFTER INJURY

bogged down?

Treesa: For a few weeks after the injury, I couldn't even walk, and I thought, 'what to do.'. But I would train on my abs. Stand on the box, sit on a bench (on court) or even on my bed and dribble for hours. Rather than moping that this happened, and thinking of injury I got into a zone that was peaceful.

I motivated myself with positive talk. I was in a happy zone thinking just about the game and what to play.

Gayatri: Injuries are tricky because one moment everything is going well and suddenly rhythm is disrupted. I've got injured lots of times, so all I thought of was I should stay fit for when Treesa is back. I knew it's not easy for her to start playing at same old top level again.

But actually, I didn't need to cover for her at all. We came out of it stronger through the Philippines Open and then the Worlds.

Talk about one thing you've learnt from your dad, mom and sibling.

Gayatri: My mother's (PVV Lakshmi) also an Olympian. And because of my father (Pullela Gopichand), I've always had access to knowledge, so I'm grateful for that. But I'd not know what I'd do without Vishnu (her

“Winning pre-quarters where we beat the Japanese whom we had lost previously to, was a major confidence booster.”

GAYATRI GOPICHAND,
ON CONFIDENCE DURING WORLDS

brother). He has stopped playing badminton now. But the way he plays at the net, is tremendous. He has the best spinning serve.

Treesa: My parents (mother Daisy Jolly and father Jolly Matthew) have been the biggest support in my life. When I was younger I played doubles juniors with my sister (Maria Jolly).

From her I learnt to stand up and speak for myself. And fight on the court always. No matter what the situation, she always looks at it positively. I want to be optimistic like her.

What memories of the Delhi crowd?

Gayatri: It was crazy. It's the first time I've experienced something like this. On semifinals day, when we were walking in, it was a different experience knowing a full stadium is rooting for you.

When you hear so many people cheering, you just want to deliver a win for them. I hope we give them many occasions to support us.

Treesa: From Day 1, Round of 64 for all 5 matches, they cheered. I was really shocked that stadium was fully packed for our semis. I thought, 'Oh my god, this much crowd....' as Delhi turned up.

What will you tell

upcoming shuttlers conflicted about playing doubles or singles?

Gayatri: I was a singles player before. Both are amazing. But pick what suits your game. I knew this was a better option for me so I didn't think too much. Do what you love.

Treesa: Personally, by Under-17, Under-19, I understood my game was more suitable for doubles. Once you know your game, it's easy.

What were the messages, celebrations like?

Gayatri: Nothing too crazy. I usually have something (ice-cream sundaes) from Nirula's when in Delhi, but this time I couldn't get time. But when we returned to Hyderabad, just seeing family and friends at airport was great.

Treesa: Ya, when we landed at Hyderabad. But also when my parents called me after the medal, and they said, "We're so proud of you." That meant everything.

What's on the Treesa-Gayatri shopping list after the medal?

Gayatri: If in Korea, then makeup and skincare products. Clothes.

Treesa: New speakers. Clothes.

● MAJOR MEDALS

● Bronze: 2026 World Championships (Women's doubles)

● Gold: 2024 Asian Team Championships (Women's team)

● Bronze: 2023 Asian Team Championships (Mixed Team)

● Bronze: 2022 Commonwealth Games (Women's doubles)

Srikanth stuns No. 9 Lai at China Masters

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 3

KIDAMBI SRIKANTH rarely gets top billing or broadcaster's attention these days, while he plays his own game on some Court 3. He is 33 years old and his world ranking languishes close to his age, at 34. Canadian Victor Lai, at No.9 and fresh from his second World Championships bronze, would not have expected the veteran to push him the way he did at the China Masters Super 750.

The 21-18, 21-19 win for the Indian was particularly impressive because he trailed 11-15, 9-14 in each game.

But what was noticeable, given Lai has inflicted defeats on top Indian names, was that the Canadian's frenzied game, with the ability to push the pace, fazed Srikanth. The 21-year-old was gobsmacked and exhausted at the disruption of his own rhythm, even if the match was wrapped up in 44 minutes. "I was not really thinking too much about the score. I was only thinking about what I have been doing throughout the match. What I need to do going forward. Victor's been playing really well for the last 12-14 months. But I just feel like it's a new day and if I can play my best, I still have my chances," Srikanth told the Badminton Association of India. Batches of Boys' Singles Worlds medallists from 2018, 2021 and '23: Be aware of the incoming 15-point system in 2027. With stamina fading out of the frame, Srikanth has the game to resurrect himself. For the moment, he bolsters India's hopes for the Asian Games team gold.

It's not that Srikanth has hit top gear; just that his existing skillset, with a sharp net charge, will suffice to pick him for the third singles (fifth tubber) in every tie, so one can never write India off. It doesn't hurt that he can be alternated with the other wily fox, HS Prannoy, for the rearguard, something that has brought India two Thomas Cup medals.

On Thursday in Shenzhen, busybody Victor was flummoxed. It's uncharacteristic for him to rush towards his towel and water bottle every third point, but that's exactly what he was driven to after Srikanth took the fight to him with his net rushes. Both traded down-the-line smashes but it was Srikanth's follow-up stomp to the net that put Victor in a quandary.

Modus operandi

The Canadian is an ace retriever. He is a montage of nightmares for Lakshya Sen after the All England because India's No.1 loses patience quickly. How Srikanth handled Victor was instructive. For all his retrieving prowess and kill shot, Victor is still a tall player prone to being hassled when he's made to twist and turn chasing shuttles on alternate flanks.



Kidambi Srikanth entered his first Super 750 quarterfinal in three years. BADMINTON PHOTO

Srikanth can manipulate not just placement but pace and the sheer axis of a rally and he is formidable because he attacks the net with ferocity while maintaining a monk's face. What he did best though was take the pace off every acceleration Victor unleashed from the backcourt. So by the time Srikanth fetched up at the net, Victor was completely deoxygenated, being starved of speed.

A fresher and fit Srikanth, showing up scantily on the circuit, is dangerous. When he's not desperate and looking for the lines as the last resort, he has plenty of time to scramble opponents' brains. He calmly shrugged off Victor's lead, denying him the rhythm of urgency he so badly needs to out-hustle opponents.

While the first game was pocketed 21-18 with crisp shot quality, the Canadian might've fancied pushing for a decider. But the new Srikanth, since the Malaysia Masters last season, constructs creatively, defends with anticipation and kills with class. He pushed Victor back with a smash, and then turned the knife with deep aggressive kills from the net, sowing the doubt seeds with deft dribbles to make the quarters.

Thursday's win had no indication of its arrival from his last match. Beating the World No.9 is no guarantee that he could out-run Lee Cheuk-Yiu on Friday. But the Indian sorcerer has the game that can counter Lee's speed, Kodai Naraoka's ennuui-inducing in-trepidness and Christo Popov's steadiness.

It's Srikanth's first quarterfinal at a Super 750 or above since June 2023. Victor might not be the last opponent to underestimate him.

Sat-Chi win

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty were 21-17, 18-15 up against the Popovs, Toma Jr and Christo and proceeded to take 2 match points. But returning to wonky ways, they got dragged into a decider before eventually swatting the French 21-17, 22-24, 21-9 to keep their unblemished record.

Tanvi Sharma put up one hell of a fight, but lacked the finishing nous against World No.9 Tomoka Miyazaki, losing 17-21, 21-18, 16-21.

'We are out playing 40 weeks': Alcaraz on packed tours

● BRUTAL SCHEDULING

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 3

AFTER COASTING through his US Open opener against Roman Safiullin, Carlos Alcaraz started the same way against Jaime Faria. Moving well and hitting the ball fluently, he earned a break point at 3-2 in the first set. He missed a regulation forehand and squandered it.

The next game, serving to save a break point, he netted another forehand and was broken. Alcaraz rarely misses shots like that. They're what make him a destructive force on tour. He erred this time not because of his recent wrist injury, but because he was hurrying to close out the points.

"I was in a rush. I didn't take time. I wasn't patient," Alcaraz later told former world No. 4 James Blake in his on-court interview. "That cost me the break." Faria consolidated with two strong service games to take the first set 6-4. Alcaraz, who dropped just one set across his entire 2025 Flushing Meadows title run, had already

dropped one at the start of his second match this year.

Why was he in such a rush? Plain impatience, or a desire to make up for more than four months of inactivity? It could well be the latter, given how packed the calendar has become. Of the nine Masters 1000 events, seven have swelled from the traditional one week to 12 days. A lengthy injury layoff has pushed Alcaraz, a seven-time Grand Slam champion, down to No. 3 in the rankings, and he must be eager to climb back.

"Seeing how tight is the calendar, I don't want to have this lengthy break because of an injury," he said at the post-match press conference. "But in the future, I'm going to take some long breaks. Maybe not four months, but one, two months, missing some tournaments, because it's impossible to play them all.

The ATP has said in the past that players can pick and choose their tournaments, but Alcaraz pointed out that the reality is different. "They are adding more important tourna-



Carlos Alcaraz reached the third round of the US Open. REUTERS

ments. In a way they are making us play," he said. "You can skip one or two and decide your calendar, but there are some Masters 1000s, some Grand Slams, and we are out playing 40 weeks if we have to play every mandatory tournament that the ATP requires us to play."

The strain is showing, in burnout and a rising injury count. Alcaraz missed the French Open and Wimbledon this year; his rival Jannik

Sinner, along with Jack Draper, Holger Rune and João Fonseca, were all forced to withdraw from the season's last major.

"We are seeing a lot of players getting injured and tired. If they don't do anything about it, we are going to see it even more in the future," Alcaraz added.

"Got to feel normal"

On Thursday, though, the two-time US Open champion

shook off the first-set setback easily. He realised he needed to be more composed with his shot-making, and never looked back.

After saving two break points in the first game of the second set, Alcaraz bagelled the 23-year-old Faria and went on to win 4-6, 6-0, 6-3, 6-2 at Arthur Ashe Stadium. As in the first round against Safiullin, he didn't shy away from his wrist-heavy topspin groundstrokes; the inside-out forehand was in full flow, as though the injury had never happened.

"I know once I step on the court, I've just got to go for it every time. I've got to feel normal," Alcaraz said. "I have to hit like I was hitting before the injury. I'm feeling great. There is no reason to be afraid and not hitting normal."

Though he'd initially wanted to close the match out in straight sets, Alcaraz came to see the extra work Faria gave him as useful. "At the end, I realised that playing four sets was really good for me, to test everything physically, to test my body, how I feel, and how

I'm going to feel tomorrow after this match."

He next faces China's world No.113, Wu Yibing, in the round of 32. Alexander Bublik, Ben Shelton, Daniil Medvedev and Alexander Zverev could await him in the rounds after that.

Alcaraz is on a 16-match winning streak at majors, dating back to last August in New York. Since 2025, he has lost only two of his 33 Grand Slam matches, one each to Sinner and Novak Djokovic. With both already out of his way in this campaign, it may take something unusual to stop his title defence.

● KEY RESULTS

MEN'S SINGLES:

2-Carlos Alcaraz (ESP) bt Jaime Faria (POR) 4-6, 6-0, 6-3, 6-2; 8-Ben Shelton (USA) bt Hubert Hurkacz (POL) 6-3, 5-7, 7-6 (7/3), 7-5

WOMEN'S SINGLES:

8-Iga Swiatek (POL) bt Nadia Podoroska (ARG) 6-3, 6-2; 1-Aryna Sabalenka (BLR) bt Polina Iatcenko (RUS) 6-1, 6-1